

The VantaPsy Chronology

A Compendium of Aerisu



Compiled from the lore of
VantaPsy: Soul Snatcher

Generated: 20 July 2026

"To lack; To want a soul."

—
VantaPsy

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Introduction

Aerisu breathes in loops.

Time folds back on itself.

The VantaPsy Chronology maps every turn of that breath.

Vanta is the name for lack and longing, the hollow that knows itself hollow.

The Curse is what happens when Vanta festers.

You do not need this document to play the game.

But for anyone who wants the full weight of Aerisu beneath their feet, the Chronology waits..

Events

The Shattering

Age of Men · Events

[Placeholder] Centuries before Soul Snatcher begins, the moon Lunarkos fell from the sky and the planetary serpent Bahamut rose to meet it. Their collision is remembered as the Shattering, and it is the origin point of the Curse and of magic itself.

Related: Bahamut, Lunarkos, The Curse

The Nightjar Incident

Age of Men · Events

[Placeholder] Nine years before Soul Snatcher begins, the airship Nightjar crashed into Sengetsuki. The years since are known locally as the Eternal Night.

Related: The Shattering

Age of Men

Age of Men · Events

In the Age of Men, Aerisu drifted alone.

There was no Moon to govern its tides, no steady rhythm to anchor its seasons. Nights stretched deep and untamed, the stars sharp as glass and yet strangely restless. Storms came without warning. Summers burned too long. Winters, when they came at all, lingered only as fragile memories.

The land itself mirrored this unease. Mountains rose like fractured ribs, deserts swallowed cities, and valleys bloomed with impossible abundance. Aerisu was beautiful, but never merciful.

The Nations during the Age of Men

Solmara

Solmara was the seat of the Autarchs. A rising empire of scholars, rulers, and soldiers who believed order could be perfected. Their councils ruled with ritual precision. Their armies advanced with merciless efficiency. Their academies burned with ambition honed to a blade.

They did not waste lives lightly. They simply did not hesitate. Sacrifice was a currency, and they spent it cleanly, without blood on their own cuffs. When their mechs first strode through the mountains, gleaming in the mist like iron-winged seraphs, the people of Hoshimira named them Angels. That reverence became a bond. Solmara was no longer only an ally. It was something higher. In time, Hoshimira bent the knee as vassal, and empire and mountain learned to walk as one.

Hoshimira

Hoshimira was a mountain realm of wind, lanterns, and stillness. Breath was sacred there, and every echo was said to remember the ancestors. Once, some of their kin dug too greedily. Drawn by hunger for the Golden Heart buried deep within the mountain, they split stone against the will of the elders. To the wise, this was desecration. A

rupture of balance itself.

With the aid of Solmaran mechs, those who dug were cast out. The people believed the Angels had judged them. Harmony was preserved. Still, exile carries its own echo. It never truly fades.

Sahran

Sahran was born from that exile. The outcast kin of Hoshimira were driven into the scorching deserts, where survival meant learning the language of flame and stone. Once miners and engineers, they became masters of craft through hardship. Their faith bent toward reconciliation. They prayed to the gods to return them to Aokusa, their birth mountain, from which they had been severed.

Sahrani societies were built on endurance and penitence. Their lives became a long act of atonement. Some clung to quiet perseverance, hoping the Angels would one day forgive. Others burned hotter.

They called themselves the Luminaries. They did not ask for return alone. They demanded reckoning.

The Whisper of the Curse

Even then, in that uneasy peace, there were whispers.

People spoke of a creeping affliction. The Curse. Black rain falling on fields. Glyphs burning into flesh. Echoes lingering in water. Signs without causes anyone could name. It did not spread through blood or touch. It moved through resonance. Through memory and consequence. Through awareness itself. Dreams bled into waking. Stories repeated too often. Fear passed from one voice to another.

The afflicted forgot names, then faces, then themselves. Some warped in form. Others dissolved into silence. Most rulers dismissed these tales as superstition. But the common folk carried fear in their prayers. They could feel it. Something beneath the world had begun to stir.

Related: Geode Rebellion, Ik-Rasul Incident, Operation C.a.R

Geode Rebellion

Age of Men · Events

Life Under Autarch Control

The exiled kin of Aokusa were driven into those depths as expendable labour. Identity was stripped away. Family followed. Dignity did not survive long. Children vanished into the Orphan Tiers, where memory was replaced with ritual and obedience carved into young bones.

Silence was demanded. Fear was enforced.

The Curse whispered through the caverns in shadows and distortions and sudden disappearances, but to speak of it was treason. Still, the Sahrani endured. They shaped stone and steel beneath the watchful eyes of mechs once called Angels.

The Red Orphan Tier

In one of those tiers, a girl grew up in shadow, Zharael. Death revealed itself to her at six. Indoctrination followed by ten. Anger was buried beneath ritual silence. Some like her learned defiance quietly. Tools became weapons. Sabotage became prayer. The Autarchs named them Saboteurs and burned them in public squares, but each death only fed the resistance.

The Rebellion of the Tiers

By twelve, she witnessed revolt. Tunnels exploded. Patrols vanished. Flames answered flames. The Autarchs struck back with mechs and stormfire, but the rebels fought like people who had already lost everything.

They forced the oppressors upward, reclaiming tier by tier. Councils formed again. Shrines were rebuilt. Prayers were spoken aloud without permission. The Geode became the heart of its people. No longer exiles. Sahrani, in truth.

Still, she understood what freedom really was. The Autarchs had not vanished. They had only repositioned. Peace was never the absence of war. It was the rearrangement of power.

Related: [Geode Expedition](#), [Sahran](#)

Geode Expedition

Age of Men · Events

The Geode Expedition

After the rebellion, the Geode breathed again. Its upper tiers thrummed with reclamation. Miners moved in steel shells. Pneumatics gasped. Picks chimed against crystal. Councils governed in the open light.

Below the worked stone, something else gathered. In the deep places where the world grew strange, a silence took shape. It listened. A fissure called the Mouth drank light and bent signals into something that sounded like lament.

They descended. A chosen few. Drawn by a hum felt in bone and marrow, by a pull from a wound that refused to close. The descent felt like pilgrimage, fragile and unsteady, into the throat of the earth.

The air thickened into violet miasma. Stone softened, taking on the weight of memory and flesh. Shapes emerged from the dark. The Cursed, their humanity folded inward into terrible forms. VantaBats clung to fossilised ribs. Shadowlings moved through quartz like bad dreams. Tinnin watched in stillness, guarding a truth too heavy for light to hold. From above, watchers observed in silence. Their attention carried reverence. The expedition became something ritualistic. Each loss settled like a hymn spoken too quietly to interrupt.

Then the Deep revealed itself.

It was no simple formation. It pulsed slowly, conscious, ancient, dreaming in geothermal blood. To stand before it was to feel the planet remembering itself. And it felt them in return.

When catastrophe came, it arrived as understanding. Faced with an ending that would consume all, one chose mercy that could not be undone. A great mech, Siba, born for war and protection, was given over as a vessel. It was ruptured through love that understood letting go.

Light tore upward through the Geode's central seam. For a moment, every tunnel and crystal facet glowed. Every face was washed in brilliance that felt terrible and holy all at once. It looked like dawn, but it was born from a single human will.

Then the light faded.

The instrument was gone. The one who guided it was simply absent.

The survivors climbed carrying two weights. Grief that crushed the chest. Truth that burned to hold. The Curse slept, but it dreamed. The Heart was real. It was awake. The wound had no bottom.

Above, life found its rhythm again. Still, the light was remembered. It lingered in crystal memory and in the quiet reverence of those who lived because someone else chose to vanish.

The world had shifted. The balance between those who walked the crust and the sentience beneath it had changed, shaped by sacrifice rather than decree. And even now, the echo asks its question.

Was this clarity a gift, or only delay. Did it serve the truth, or teach the darkness that it had been seen.

The Second Descent

Years passed. Another team descended through reinforced scaffolds and scorched, collapsed walls. The deeper they went, the more alive [the Geode](#) seemed. Stone pulsed. Walls shifted. Violet miasma thickened until understanding itself felt fragile. Few survived.

At the heart, a vast cavern beat like a living organism, drawing creatures toward it and overwhelming all who approached. [The Geode](#) proved semi sentient, defended by its own spawn, incomprehensible and uncontainable.

Rapture

It erupted.

Walls breathed. Mists devoured. Creatures of stone, fire, and shadow swept through miners, soldiers, and engineers alike. Resistance was brief. Meaningless. Above, watchers clutched charms, names striking their tongues like cold pins. Analysts murmured over readings, blind to the lie of stability. Elsewhere, survivors ran for lifts, dragging the wounded, carrying children.

A scavenged plane roared to life, weaving through crystalline pillars and swarming darkness. It carried a couple into the open sky. At the heart of it all, a figure stood above the main shaft, arms raised, commanding the tide with awe and certainty. [The Geode](#) had become a crucible. A womb of power and destruction.

Those who escaped bore witness. The cries of the lost followed them like shadows. Choices weighed heavy on their backs. Outside, [the sun](#) struck the world without mercy. Endless desert stretched beyond the wound. Freedom had come.

And it had cost everything.

[The Geode's](#) influence did not end at its walls.

Related: [Geode Rebellion](#), [Sahran](#)

Sanctum Verge

Age of Men · Events

Sanctum Verge - Ori'sol

During the [Ori'sol](#) War, a Hoshimiran squad descended into the ruined city. Streets choked with black rain, ash, and the remnants of collapsed buildings guided their march. Signs of Sahrani occupation were everywhere: makeshift fortifications, traces of ritual, and the whispers of [the Curse](#) in hollow halls.

A young apprentice was taken in an early skirmish. Cruel experiments tried to turn [the Curse](#) into a weapon. Retaliation came swiftly. The outpost was stormed. Defenders, including children and the desperate, were executed. Survivors burned what remained.

Even after the battle, the squad saw how fragile control had been. The checkpoint they had defended lay destroyed in their absence. Only ruin remained, along with the echo of choices made under duress. Survivors bore the weight of what had been done and what had been left undone, learning that [the Curse](#) was more than a threat of flesh. It was a threat to faith, to obedience, and to the shadow of human will itself.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Ori'sol](#)

Ik-Rasul Incident

Age of Men · Events

The Ik-Rasul Incident - Aokusa, Hoshimira

They call it the Ik-Rasul Incident now.

When the Ik-Rasul fell into Aokusa, the basin shuddered. Not like an earthquake. More like something heavy settling where it did not belong. The mountains felt it first. Then the water.

Solmaran broadcasts named it a cross-border bio-threat. Clean words. Useful words. They spoke of containment and monitoring while the highlands fractured quietly, and the rivers and springs answered in ways no one wanted to explain.

In the southern cities, people began to hear things.

Hallucinations, they said. Night terrors. Whispering voices that carried the cadence of old Hoshimiran chants, half-remembered prayers slipping into waking thought. Black Blood Syndrome received its name long before it was understood.

Drones were sent into aquifers and fields. They recorded animals behaving incorrectly, soil that responded as if it were listening. The Angels were redeployed. The Autarchs had built them to protect Aokusa, and so they returned to the basin as they always had.

Some came back changed.

Their sensors flickered with patterns no operator had written. No command acknowledged them. Beneath the basin, the echo fields began to hum. Not loudly. Just enough to suggest that something unseen had stirred, and that the mountains were no longer dormant.

Ori'sol became a place of fear, fascination, and silence gathered together. The Curse was never named in policy, but it moved anyway. Not through blood alone. Through thought. Through perception. Through the quiet spaces people used to feel safe in.

The fall of the Ik-Rasul reshaped the mountains. It unsettled the Angels. It left Solmara listening, even as it pretended not to hear.

Related: ik-rasul, Aokusa

Operation C.a.R

Age of Men · Events

Operation C.a.R: Containment and Restoration

Operation C.a.R was named in the wake of too many fractures to ignore. Sahrán, Hoshimira, Ylvara. All of them destabilised after the Ik-Rasul fell in Aokusa. I remember how quickly the language hardened. Crisis. Cascade. Necessity.

By then, Tayran's northern coast was already burning quietly. Luminary doctrine had seeped into governance, tightening its grip, pushing the province toward collapse. Beneath it all lay the Geode, still alive in its own way, its deep tunnels a long-forged crucible of Sahrani rebellion. As the Curse spread and belief sharpened into escalation, Solmara answered with authorisation.

Project DAEDALUS was deployed. Private forces. Bipedal mechs. Rapid response units that moved faster than law and spoke with the voice of stabilisation. Insurgency was suppressed. Territory was secured. Civilians were extracted in clean, methodical waves. Hoshimiran orphans were prioritised, relocated to Isvara, an island city wrapped in surveillance and procedure. It was called refuge and containment in the same breath. Every child logged. Every movement traced. Control made efficient.

Alongside this, quieter operations reached outward. Survivors from distant incidents, including those touched by Ik-Rasul, were gathered and redirected into Isvara's narrow corridors. Displacement became policy. Care became

management.

Across [Sahran](#), the responses diverged. [Tayran](#) burned with conviction. [Najmara](#) and [Zaristan](#) accepted intervention to keep their streets intact. [Panjara](#) stayed distant, watching the tide without stepping into it.

[Operation C.a.R](#) was framed as restoration. I think it was more like a hand pressed firmly over a wound, holding it closed long enough for the bleeding to slow. Whether anything beneath it healed is another question.

Related: [Ik-Rasul Incident](#), [Isvara](#)

Vaelmiric War

Age of Men · Events

The Vaelmiric War

They were filed alongside the [Calm Accords](#), which tells you something about the kind of peace the Accords actually were.

The Regulations emerged from the wreckage of the [Vaelmiric War](#), which itself emerged from something the Solmaran Council had been doing quietly for years beneath the administrative language of research and stabilisation. Black Blood subjects. Orphaned children, mostly, processed through the same channels that had always processed displaced children, logged and scheduled and made available to programs that required living subjects and preferred ones without families to ask questions.

[Norrvektstan](#) and [Silealyros](#) disagreed about almost everything. Their coastlines, their values, their understanding of what a person was worth and to whom. The one thing that pulled them into alignment, briefly and violently, was this. [Norrvektstan](#) called it slavery and meant it with the full weight of communal obligation, the sense that a community which permits this has failed its most basic function. [Silealyros](#) called it the same thing and meant something different, bodily autonomy as the last sovereign territory, the self as the one asset no institution had the right to extract without contract.

The [Vaelmiric War](#) was fought on the water and in the coastal provinces and in the administrative chambers of Ylvara simultaneously. When it ended, the Regulations were written into the Accords as a condition of settlement. Black Blood research under direct Council sanction was prohibited. Existing subjects were to be released and remanded to humanitarian care. Language that sounded like resolution and functioned like reclassification.

[Isvara](#) was built shortly after.

The children went from one kind of supervised enclosure to another, and the paperwork described both as protection. The Regulations remained on record, cited in governance documents for decades afterward, proof that the Council had answered the question.

What the Council had actually done was change the name of the room.

Related: [Calm Accords](#), [Black Blood Regulations](#), [Isvara](#)

Calm Accords

Age of Men · Events

The Calm Accords

The [Calm Accords](#) were signed after decades of naval and coastal ruin, when North and [South Solmara](#) could no longer afford the weight of open war. [Vaelmir](#) was divided in careful language. Central waters were stripped of

fleets. Patrols were reduced to symbols. Authority was split along old fault lines: [Norrvektstan](#) claimed stewardship of the inland ocean, while the southern provinces retained the ports, trade routes, and chokepoints that fed them both. Disputed isles were placed under joint oversight, a solution neither side trusted.

Weapons of reach and spectacle were forbidden. Alchemical payloads. Arcane artillery. Long-range platforms capable of turning sea into grave. Neutral mediators were appointed to inspect compliance, their reports precise and incomplete. Violations followed quietly, most often in the North, buried beneath logistics, experimental clauses, and storms that swallowed evidence.

Economic terms followed. Shared tariffs. Reparations framed as stabilisation. Trade resumed, slower and heavier, carrying resentment alongside goods. Corruption took root where oversight thinned. Non-interference clauses were signed, archived, and ignored when opportunity outweighed risk.

No one called it peace for long.

Veterans named it the Silent Curse. In the North, it was remembered as surrender dressed in civility. In the South, as restraint enforced by law and leverage. Songs and pamphlets preserved it as a pause rather than an end, a held breath stretched too far. The [Calm Accords](#) did not still [Vaelmir](#). They taught it to wait and prepare for the inevitable storm.

Related: [Vaelmiric War](#), [Black Blood Regulations](#)

Black Blood Regulations

Age of Men · Events

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Related: [Vaelmiric War](#), [Calm Accords](#)

Vireliax Expedition

Age of Men · Events

The Vireliax Expedition

The [Vireliax](#) departed from Velmora Port as a thing of legend even before it vanished beneath the waves. A submersible dreadnought, part warship and part ritual object. Her hull was obsidian-reinforced steel woven with living polymers. Sigils flickered faintly under emergency lights, not decorative, but attentive. She was built to cross oceans, yes, but also to move through the metaphysical currents of [Aerisu](#) itself.

She was commanded by a seasoned captain. His crew were scholars, warriors, and technicians who knew better than to pretend those roles were separate. The expedition followed reports of [the Curse](#), a psychic and spiritual affliction rising from the planet's depths. Yet as [the Vireliax](#) descended into the [Vaelmir](#) Rift, the Maw, the mandate began to feel small. Incomplete.

Some aboard believed [the Curse](#) was not an illness at all. They suspected a forming planetary intelligence, later called [Bahamut](#). Something that observed. Something that reacted. Something that might judge.

Life aboard settled into a careful rhythm of duty and ritual. Laughter echoed through corridors. Private rites were performed in silence. Small pilgrimages traced familiar paths through the ship. These moments softened the tension, but never erased it.

Threats came from outside and from within.

Pirate fleets attacked with conventional weapons and perception-altering nanoviruses. [The Curse](#) manifested aboard the vessel itself, warping trust and blurring the boundary between ally and enemy. Decisions became heavy. Moral certainty eroded quickly in the dark.

The expedition reached the Eye of the Maw, a living storm wrapped around a calm, sentient void. Crew and vessel moved as one as [the Vireliax](#) pierced [the abyss](#). Bioluminescent life drifted through the depths. Light patterns shifted with intent. Symbols emerged that no one had taught, yet many recognised.

It was clear then that the Maw was aware.

Survival carried a terrible cost. Psychological fracture spread. [The Curse](#) deepened. The nanovirus unravelled cohesion. Key figures faced choices that could not be justified cleanly, weighing survival against pre-emptive containment.

When it ended, [the Vireliax](#) was crippled. The crew was shattered. What remained were fragments of hope, damaged data, and accounts that refused to align.

Tactically, the expedition failed.

But it remains a study in what happens when military force, scientific inquiry, and metaphysical curiosity converge. A record of resilience and folly. A warning about confronting intelligence that does not need to explain itself.

[Aerisu](#)'s depths are alive.

They remember being watched.

Related: [Vaelmir](#), [Bahamut](#)

Phantom Rescue

Operation Phantom Rescue

People still call it a rescue. That is the clean word. I think it was closer to a haunting.

After the Vireliax was broken, the survivors did not vanish. They were paraded. At Thalgrith Port they were displayed like proof of ownership, marched beneath stormlight and neon, sorted into corridors of bidding and locked rooms with polite names. Stormriven captains broadcast their demands with theatrical restraint. Ylvara was to abandon its Black-Blood work, or the prisoners would be consumed piece by piece. Solmara could not answer without igniting the sea.

So they chose absence instead.

A phantom was commissioned. Not a fleet, not a declaration. Just a shape moving through gaps. The official targets were few. A scholar who knew too much. A researcher whose mind still mattered to the Council. Symbols worth recovering. The rest were classified as noise, unless deniability could be preserved. That is how the order was written. I have seen how language sharpens itself when it wants to cut without blood.

Two figures moved through Thalgrith that night, though history pretends there was only one.

One was a ghost from Shinkiri. She treated the city like a puzzle laid flat beneath her feet. Guards, habits, rhythms, blind spots. She slipped between identities as easily as breath. To her, the mission was geometry. Enter. Extract. Leave nothing behind. People were coordinates. Mercy was inefficiency. When she moved, even the cameras seemed unsure of what they had seen.

The other moved like a wound that refused to close.

They say a Hoshimiran swordsman walked the port alone, carrying guilt heavier than any blade. He had already killed to spare suffering, and it had not been enough. The survivors of the Vireliax were his responsibility now, even if the world had written them off. He fought for credits in pits that cheered pain. He bartered favours with syndicates that smiled while they measured organs. Every step deeper into Silealyros demanded that he participate in the thing he hated. Freedom there has a price, and it is always paid in pieces of yourself.

Their paths crossed briefly. A bargain was struck in the dark. If he could gather the scattered souls before the ghost finished her work, she would take them too. If not, they would remain where the city had placed them. She gave him a list and a deadline. Three days. After that, she would be gone. Some he reached. Some were already reduced to inventory, or worse. One was beyond him entirely, sealed behind glass and instruments, a child treated as a question instead of a life.

And then there was the Spiral.

I do not like speaking of the Gilt Spiral. Even remembering it leaves a residue. It was a place where Silealyros dressed its philosophy in soft colours and music, where degradation was made cute and rebellion was stitched into uniforms. Animal masks. Branded personas. Smiles trained to sell comfort while erasing the person underneath. They called it companionship. It was a factory for obedience that pretended to be play.

One of the survivors was there, renamed, repackaged. Cleverness sold as allure. Resistance turned into an accessory. To reach her, the swordsman had to become a patron. Had to ask for her by name. Had to validate the system's investment. Each step deeper was another compromise, another quiet apology swallowed. Rescue was planned in fragments between performances, whispered through practised affection while the walls listened. I hate that place. I hate how easily it learned how to smile.

The ghost saw all of this. She did not intervene. It was outside her parameters.

Until it wasn't.

At the edge of the operation, something shifted. A child no one had ordered her to save. A plea that did not fit into any schema. I do not know what she felt in that moment. I only know the pattern broke. One extra life vanished with the others. A deviation small enough to hide, large enough to matter. By morning, the primary targets were gone. The storm did not notice. No alarms rang that could be traced. Children touched by Black Blood were transferred to

Isvara, a place of fences and soft words, where protection and observation shared the same walls. Thalgrith continued to trade in flesh. Silealyros called it freedom. Solmara denied everything.

Operation Phantom Rescue returned to rumour, which was the point. Historians later praised its elegance. Deniable statecraft. Extraction without spectacle. They say it preserved reputation.

What they do not write is this: something lingered afterward. Not just the rescued, but the cost. The compromises. The small fracture where a ghost chose to be seen, and a guilty man paid for mercy with himself.

Phantoms do not haunt places. They haunt decisions. And Thalgrith still listens for footsteps that are no longer there.

Related: Vireliax Expedition, Isvara, silealyros

The Shattering

Age of Men · Events

The Era of Shattered Walls

It was almost forty years after Ik-Rasul, after Phantom Rescue and Operation C.a.R., after the children were ferried to Isvara and told it was for their own good. By then Solmara had hardened into something brittle. A state built on scanners and checkpoints, on watching first and asking never. The Curse existed only in whispers. Officially it was contained. Officially it was rare. Officially it was not a person. They hid the afflicted behind quarantine lines and careful language. Aberration. Anomaly. Necessary removal. Humanity was the first thing stripped away.

But silence does not last forever.

The Curse spread too far. Its signs were too visible. Its echoes travelled faster than patrols. Knowledge itself became contagious. Once enough people knew, there was no unknowing it. What had lived in sealed archives and survivor memories stepped into daylight. That moment became the Era of Shattered Walls.

It began in the streets. Riots against the Cursed Laws. Protests that turned into clashes. Barricades burning under surveillance lights. Broadcasts filled with masked figures standing their ground and armoured patrols in mechs, the same mechs they once called Angels, pushing back. Solmaran leaders spoke in careful tones and promised change while the ground shifted beneath them.

Councillor Retha Nuur appeared everywhere. Calm voice. Steady hands. Structural Restoration, she called it. She said the Council was listening. Executions slowed. Checkpoints loosened. Segregation walls came down piece by piece.

Instead of healing the city, the cracks widened. The Council was exposed as divided and afraid. Reform felt less like a plan and more like stalling the fall.

For the first time, the Cursed walked openly through Solmara's streets. Research received state funding. Every discovery brought hope and fear in equal measure. Universities taught the history they once buried. Children who had grown up behind fences now sat in classrooms beside the unmarked. Still, people wore masks. Not only for safety. Sometimes to avoid seeing each other.

From the fractures, new beliefs emerged. The Vantari rose quietly and then all at once. Devotees of the Vanta, preaching surrender to death and rebirth. Half philosophy, half religion. But what's the difference? They welcomed the afflicted and the terrified alike. Their processions moved through the cities like unanswered questions, rivalling Solmara's authority without ever asking permission.

Beyond Solmara, the world adjusted its stance. Elysium sealed itself beneath Cryotech glass, choosing preservation over engagement. Survival became stratified. Other nations watched Solmara with unease. Not as a superpower, but as a warning. A state held together by habit, surveillance, and the fear of what would happen if it

finally broke.

That was the shift. [Solmara](#) stepped out of secrecy and into exposure. The walls fell. The truths showed themselves. Nothing was whole anymore. The world did not end.

But it stopped pretending it wasn't already cracked.

Related: [Ik-Rasul Incident](#), [Phantom Rescue](#), [Operation C.a.R](#)

Discovery of Magic

Age of Men · Events

The [Discovery of Magic](#)

Zephyr was one of the first to see the shape of it. To take the fraying edges of a soul and... tune them. What others would later call Magic, Zephyr saw as a science. A deliberate bending of soul resonance, using anchors from the outside to conduct a will from within. His tools were the remnants of his failures. Those Heart Crystals, born from experiments that didn't take... they weren't just stone. They were prisons of concentrated feeling. Anguish. Desire. Will, frozen solid. You could plug a formula into that frozen scream and make it sing. Or scream something new. He wrote it all down. Grimoires, cold and precise. He gave them to the right people, built a web of collaborators, founded an organisation that grew in the city's shadow. He didn't conquer [Elysium](#). He made it need him. He offered solutions to impossible problems, power to the powerless. All he asked for was loyalty. And silence. In a decade, he wasn't just in the city. He was the foundation it stood on. The real throne was a chair in a hidden lab. But his work... it needed fuel. Subjects. And there were always more. The Cursed. The displaced. The orphans war had already broken. His labs hid beneath the clean, bright districts, places where stone drank the sound. His own people spoke of him with a mix of awe and fear. He was the man who had stared into [the Curse's](#) heart and come back with an instruction manual. And among all the faces that passed through his hands... there was one. A woman. Just another subject, then. He didn't know she was the flaw in his perfect design. The equation he couldn't solve. She would be the one to unravel him.

Related: [heart-crystals](#), [zephyr](#), [Veyra's Descent](#)

Veyra's Descent

Age of Men · Events

[Veyra's Descent](#)

She finished her father's work. The Doctrine of Becoming. It spread through the underground like a quiet pulse, passed among the Cursed as something between a philosophy and a prayer. She became a voice for them. A scholar, a prophet, a woman who stood in the light and said transformation wasn't a punishment. It was just... change. But even before she spoke for them, before her words would echo across centuries, she was changing too. She was carrying a child. The father... his name was Ash. I think. A partner in every sense, in life and in belief. They had dreamed of a gentler world together. But Veyra had [the Curse](#). And the pregnancy... it tangled everything. It crept through her, slow and cold. Her memory frayed first. His name slipped away. Then his face. Then the feeling of being loved at all. It just... evaporated. In the fog of that loss, she grasped for an anchor. Rumours reached her. Whispers of a man in [Elysium](#), Zephyr, who knew things about [the Curse](#) no one else did. Talk of cures. Stabilization. Reversal. Hope is a desperate compass. She went to [Elysium](#), carrying the life inside her, looking for a way to save them both. What she found there... it wasn't salvation. It was a different kind of horror.

Related: zephyr, [Elysium Atrocities](#), [Soul's First Cry](#)

Elysium Atrocities

Age of Men · Events

The Atrocities of [Elysium](#)

Zephyr's laboratories were sanctuaries of suffering. I remember that. Veyra saw children strapped to tables, their chests opened while they still breathed. Hearts extracted, not cleanly, not quickly. She watched the crystallisation process. Essence drawn through alchemical apparatus, condensed into glowing shards, catalogued like grain or iron. The screams were muffled but constant, echoing through white tile and black steel. And she understood. Heart Crystals weren't simply tools. They were tombs. Each one held a soul, compressed, its anguish frozen into something that could be wielded. Magic, as Zephyr practised it, wasn't transcendence. It was cannibalism of the spirit. [The Curse](#) consumed more of Veyra's memory. More of her identity. Yet one emotion survived, sharp and absolute. Rage.

Related: zephyr, heart-crystals, [Veyra's Descent](#)

Soul's First Cry

Age of Men · Events

The Cell

Veyra was kept in a cell beneath [Elysium](#). Anger pressed against her ribs, but she couldn't flee. The pregnancy had already turned catastrophic, though she didn't know it yet. A friend lay dying beside her. Someone who had cared for Veyra when Zephyr held her, who had tried to protect her in small ways that mattered. Eventually they took the body away, dragging it across the floor. A trail of synthetic white blood followed, pale and gleaming against the stone. Veyra looked through the Heart Crystal she'd stolen from one of Zephyr's experiments. Through its fractured surface, she saw the trail. Saw something written on the wall. Instructions, maybe. Or a name. She couldn't be sure. She practised. Days blurred together in the dark. She spoke to the crystal, felt its resonance, learned the shape of its anguish. And eventually, she cast the spell. The explosion tore the cell apart.

The First Spell

The Heart Crystal was Maura's. Zephyr's daughter. Veyra had spent time with her when Zephyr kept her in his house, controlled by Synthetic White Blood, kept placid and obedient. That was where she'd met Sophie too. The maid who would later save her. The crystal pulsed in her palm, warm and alive, whispering the name of the child who had died to make it. Veyra understood exactly what she held. Not a tool, but a prisoner. And she understood what she must do. She spoke a word. Not from any language, but a command drawn from the resonance of her own anguish. The crystal responded, flaring with violet light. Ignis. Fire erupted from her hand, but it wasn't the red-gold flame of hearth or forge. It was Vanta Fire, a purple-black blaze that burned without heat, consuming not matter but essence. The explosion blew open other cells. She led the charge to escape the lab, Cursed prisoners stumbling behind her through smoke and broken stone. Many died in the process. The guards. The panic. The collapse of corridors not meant to break. Veyra had cast the first true spell. And in doing so, she had become the first mage of [Aerisu](#). She fled into the frozen waters. The lab sat on a small island off the coast of the city. The cold bit through her skin, through her clothes, but she swam. She made it to a sewer tunnel and crawled inside, shaking, bleeding. That's where she discovered her baby had died.

The Soul's First Cry

Her scream tore through [Elysium](#) like a blade through paper. Not merely sound but resonance. A psychic shockwave that rippled across the city, the continent, the world. Every soul attuned to [the Curse](#) felt it. A moment of absolute, unbearable anguish. Mothers clutched their children. Soldiers dropped their weapons. Scholars looked up from their texts, trembling. Technology glitched and flickered, lights stuttering in rhythm with grief. In the centuries to come, this moment would be remembered as [The Soul's First Cry](#). It was the sound of a world breaking.

Related: [Veyra's Descent](#), heart-crystals, zephyr

Cursed Prophecy

Age of Men · Events

The Prophet of the Cursed

Veyra stumbled deeper into the sewers. She found a large open section there, in the dark. The homeless Cursed huddled in the shadows, their bodies marked by Black or White Blood, their faces hollow with despair. She didn't speak. She simply lit a fire into a metal drum, using a piece of Maura's Heart Crystal. Vanta Fire bloomed, purple-black and steady. A beacon in the dark. That flame still burns. Even to this day. A woman approached her through the firelight. She spoke a prophecy about Veyra's baby. Despite everything, despite the loss still fresh and bleeding, this woman insisted Veyra was still pregnant. That the child would come. Some of the Cursed ushered the woman away, muttering about madness. Others praised Veyra, defended her, led her through the tunnels toward a way out. She followed, numb and stumbling. Eventually she found the subway. Tomenos was there. The psychopomp, quiet and patient. He guided her through the underground rails to her home district. That's where she met Ash again. Slowly, piece by piece, she began to remember. His face. His voice. The memories she had lost. The life they had tried to build together. She vowed to finish her father's work. And to expose Zephyr.

Related: [Veyra's Descent](#), [Soul's First Cry](#), tomenos

Zephyr's Ascension

Age of Men · Events

Zephyr's Ascension

Veyra's writings spread through [Elysium](#) like smoke through cracks. The Doctrine of Becoming reached hands that had been waiting for it. Testimonies surfaced. Evidence mounted. Zephyr was outed. He fled the city. But he did not stop. He rebuilt his work in the shadows, spreading his research among collaborators who understood what power looked like. Scientists, politicians, corporations hungry for leverage. He codified his findings into grimoires and sold them carefully, building a network that didn't need his presence to function. Where Veyra had discovered fire, Zephyr discovered control. His followers refined Synthetic White Blood into weapons. They worked on bioweapons using Black Blood, experimented with White Blood's explosive properties, combined Curse research with economics and strategy. They formed what would become some of the first Mages and Sorcerers, organisations that moved like corporations, cold and efficient. Within a decade, Zephyr returned to [Elysium](#). Not as a fugitive, but as a force the city could no longer refuse. His influence had woven itself into infrastructure, policy, research. He didn't conquer the city. He became its foundation. His magic wasn't fire or fury but inevitability. A slow, creeping transformation that reshaped society from within. And he continued his experiments on children. For every truth Veyra exposed, Zephyr built ten new lies. For every spell she discovered, he devised a counter. He was

her shadow, her inversion, her nemesis.

Related: [Veyra's Descent](#), [Elysium Atrocities](#), synthetic-white-blood

Hell of Elysium

Age of Men · Events

The Hell of Elysium

The breaking point came during an experiment meant to stabilise Synthetic White Blood for mass production. Zephyr's collaborators had constructed a massive alchemical reactor beneath [Elysium's](#) core. Autarch technology fused with arcane circuitry, designed to synthesise the substance on an industrial scale. The reactor failed. The explosion tore through the city's foundations, rupturing containment chambers and releasing decades of stored bioweapons, experimental Cursed, and concentrated Vanta. Black Blood flooded the streets. White Blood clung to buildings, puffing and expanding until structures buckled under the weight. Synthetic White Blood poured into the water system, transforming thousands into hollow, obedient shells. [Elysium](#) became Hell. Creatures born of failed experiments crawled from the depths. Amalgamations of flesh and crystal, beings whose bodies wept acidic tears, things that screamed with voices stolen from the dead. The Vanta itself seemed to awaken, spreading across the city in a creeping fog that distorted perception and memory. Citizens fled. Soldiers fired into the chaos. The Council issued evacuation orders, then rescinded them, then issued them again. [Elysium](#), the jewel of Ylvara, was dying. And at the centre of it all stood Zephyr. He hadn't wanted the explosion. The failure was a setback, a loss of control he'd spent decades building. But he was already calculating. Already adjusting. He would make the best of it anyway.

Related: [Zephyr's Ascension](#), synthetic-white-blood

Fight for Hell

Age of Men · Events

The Fight for Hell

Veyra was captured. Not through heroism or grand defiance. Just an unfortunate accident, the kind that happens when you're caught between forces larger than yourself. She wasn't a hero. She wasn't even really a mage, not in the way the stories would later claim. She'd cast one spell. One explosion. The rest was survival and fury, not mastery. [Elysium](#) had become a hellscape. Zephyr's compatriots had turned the city into a testing ground, each district warped by different experiments, different applications of [the Curse](#). The streets twisted. The air tasted wrong. Reality bent in places where it shouldn't. Ash came for her. He fought his way through that hell, not alone but close to it. A mech pilot joined him, someone who'd lost her patriotism toward [Solmara](#), who'd seen what the state had become and couldn't carry that weight anymore. Together they cut through Zephyr's forces, through his collaborators and their twisted defences. And in the shadows, in the gutters of that hell, Sophie was still alive. The maid who had saved Veyra all those years ago. She'd never stopped. She worked quietly, desperately, saving as many lives as she could while the city collapsed around her. Eventually she made her way into Zephyr's tower. She helped Ash, as well Veyra who was already present via her capture, make progress. She opened doors that shouldn't have opened, disabled systems no one knew she could reach. No one knew what she was doing. No one even knew she existed. She died in the tower. Alone. Forgotten. At least, until I remembered her.

Related: [Hell of Elysium](#), [Zephyr's Ascension](#), [The Crystallization](#)

The Crystallization

Age of Men · Events

The Final Broadcast

Veyra had made her way to the epicentre of Zephyr's tower with the secret help of Sophie and Ash. She knew what she had to do. What she was capable of doing, even if she didn't fully understand it. She broadcast her message across every channel Zephyr had built, every speaker, every screen. Her voice reached into homes, into bunkers, into the sealed districts where people still pretended safety was possible. She told them they had all sinned. That the corruption had spread too far, that the systems they'd built to contain the Curse had become the Curse itself. She condemned the categorization, the medicalization, the gamification of suffering. The bureaucracy that had turned souls into inventory. "To hell with control," she said. "To hell with order. To hell with your systems and your certainty. To hell with all of it." It was a warning. A final chance to flee. Then she detonated.

The Crystallization

The explosion wasn't heat or force but transformation. Everything within Elysium's borders crystallized instantly. Stone, steel, flesh, air, all of it locked into a lattice of purple-black mineral. The wave spread outward, consuming districts, provinces, entire swathes of Ylvara, turning the landscape into a frozen tableau of anguish and beauty. Veyra herself was at the epicentre. The crystal found her with her hands cradled against her womb, head bowed, her body curved around the life inside her in the instinctive way of mothers who know something is coming and place themselves between it and what they love. The crystal preserved her exactly as she was in that moment. Protecting. And within her womb, impossibly, her child still lived.

Related: Fight for Hell, Veyra's Descent, voluntas

Approaching End

Age of Gods · Events

The Approaching End

Lunarkos was falling. It descended over centuries, a near-planetary body fifty-seven kilometres across, visible in the sky like a moon that grew larger with each passing year. Carbon-sheathed, iron-cored, and alive in ways that defied understanding. Within its crystalline heart pulsed Lux, a lattice of living light that bloomed when it encountered soul-rich environments. Everyone could see it. The doomsday clock written in stone and starlight. The world was dying around it. Not from the impact yet, but from knowing it was coming. Civilisation fractured under the weight of inevitability. Some built. Some fled. Some simply waited. Others refused to accept the ending. Across the broken remains of Ylvara, engineers, scholars, pilots, and survivors gathered into desperate coalitions. The technocratic order that once governed the world had collapsed. In its place emerged scattered projects, rival solutions, and fragile alliances dedicated to a single question. How do you stop a falling world? Some sought escape beyond the sky. Others studied Lunarkos itself, searching for weakness within its living structure. Vast machines were designed to redirect its descent. Lux research expanded beyond ethical limits. Biologists fought to stabilise poisoned ecosystems that might survive the aftermath. Archivists preserved knowledge in case nothing else endured. Even the sky filled with intervention. ESIG deployed its experimental DAEDALUS frames across Aerisu, pilots descending wherever catastrophe threatened population centres or research sites. Some worked for profit. Others simply refused to let the world end quietly. Hope and desperation filled the same air. Not everyone resisted the falling star. Across the world, a growing movement embraced the approaching collision as divine

judgment. They spoke of the ancient moon goddess and declared the catastrophe a cleansing of humanity's corruption. Their voices spread through cities and ruins alike, preaching acceptance of the coming end. In the years ahead, their influence would reach further than anyone realised. And in that time between certainty and ending, something else began to take shape. The conditions that would one day create gods.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [The Coalition Against Lunarkos](#), [Lunartics](#)

Beneath Falling Moon

Age of Gods · Events

The World Beneath the Falling Moon

The Vanta Explosion had already rewritten geography. Entire regions of Ylvara turned to crystal. Survivors walked through fields of frozen citizens, their faces locked in expressions of terror or peace. The necroformed zones spread slowly, reality uncertain at their edges. Within the crystallised lattice of [Elysium](#), something impossible endured. Veyra's body, preserved at the moment of detonation, encased in crystal at the epicentre. And within her womb, her daughter still lived. The child should have died. Yet the explosion had transformed her, connecting her to [Aerisu](#) itself through the crystalline lattice. She absorbed energy from the planet's core, feeding on soul-resonance, Lux fragments, and the lingering echoes of her mother's final scream. She became [Voluntas](#). The Orphan. The Will Unborn. For centuries she remained suspended, her consciousness growing, her will hardening. The planet recognised her as kin. Creatures emerged to defend her. Amalgamations of stone and soul, born from [Aerisu](#)'s desperate need to protect what remained of hope. Above the surface, the falling star continued its slow descent. Below the crystal sky, the world struggled to decide what it would become before the end arrived. And somewhere within that struggle, the future gods of [Aerisu](#) began their work.

Related: [Approaching End](#), [voluntas](#), [The Crystallization](#)

Lunartics

Age of Gods · Events

The Lunartics

The falling of [Lunarkos](#) divided the world. Many struggled to stop the descending star. Cities rebuilt laboratories in shattered districts. Engineers raised towers meant to measure the object's mass and trajectory. Pilots launched into the sky in experimental frames. Scholars argued over Lux, gravity, and the limits of planetary defense. A different voice spread through the ruins. Quiet at first. Patient. Certain. They believed the falling moon was not a catastrophe. They believed it was mercy. These followers became known as the [Lunartics](#). Their doctrine grew from an older figure whose memory drifted through scattered myths. A girl born in the eastern lands of [Hoshimira](#) who suffered beneath a burning sky that never softened. The story said she prayed for relief from the relentless sun. The heavens answered her grief with a moon that would one day descend. In time that girl became remembered as Zuki, the [Goddess of the Moon](#). Among the [Lunartics](#), the story carried a clear meaning. [The sun](#) represented corruption, heat, and the long decay of the human soul. [The Curse](#) spreading through the world proved that corruption had already begun its harvest. [Lunarkos](#) arrived as the final correction. [The moon](#) would cleanse the earth. Attempts to stop it were treated as rebellion against a divine act. Lunartic gatherings appeared across fractured territories. Their followers formed quiet communities in abandoned towns, desert monasteries, and crystal-shadowed valleys. Many were ordinary survivors who had watched too much suffering to believe salvation could still exist. Others carried deeper conviction. They sabotaged research stations studying [Lunarkos](#).

Supply routes disappeared in the night. Equipment designed to measure the celestial body's structure returned broken or altered. Broadcast towers that called for resistance sometimes fell silent after Lunartic interference. Their actions rarely appeared violent on the surface. They spoke softly, often offering food and shelter to refugees while sharing their beliefs. The world had reached the final step of its story. Resistance only prolonged the agony. Let the moon arrive. Let the fire of the old world fade. Some members travelled farther than sermons. They infiltrated research programs attempting to alter Lunarkos's descent. They whispered doubts into the minds of pilots and engineers. Their influence reached individuals already burdened by exhaustion and fear. Research showed them the shape of it. Something beneath Elysium. A presence made of Vanta, drawing energy from the planet's core. They called it Voluntas. They understood her nature clearly: Vanta absorbs. Vanta consumes. Lux flows toward Vanta like water finding cracks. Lunarkos was made of Lux. Voluntas was made of Vanta. The mathematics was simple. She was pulling the moon toward impact. They opposed those who sought to kill her with total conviction. To destroy Voluntas would be to save the world. But the world deserved no saving. The world had corrupted itself beyond redemption. Lunarkos was mercy. Voluntas was the mechanism of that mercy. Anima, an emergent consciousness formed from the Curse's psychic residue, knew something different. She needed Voluntas alive. Not because Voluntas summoned Lunarkos, but because Voluntas was god of will and desire. When the moment came, when the sky broke, Voluntas would summon something else. Bahamut. The planet's own anguish given form. The will of Aerisu itself rising to meet the falling star. The Lunartics protected Voluntas believing they were hastening the apocalypse. They were actually preventing it. Anima did not tell them this. She did not need to. Their faith moved them in the direction the world needed them to move. They opposed the coalition's hunt with theological certainty, and their opposition bought time. Their doctrine held firm, and their firmness kept Voluntas alive long enough for the mechanism to trigger. The Lunartics succeeded. They got what they thought they wanted. The world fell. The sky broke. Lunarkos descended. And Voluntas summoned Bahamut. The world survived because of what the Lunartics opposed it surviving through. They preached apocalypse and enabled salvation. They were utterly, completely wrong about what Voluntas was, what she did, and what her existence meant. But they did not regret it. They got what they wanted. The world changed. The old order burned. Everything they had preached came true, even if it came true for reasons they could never understand. History would remember them as cultists. What it would not remember is that their opposition mattered. That their faith, however mistaken, kept alive the thing that saved the world from the thing they wanted to destroy it with. The Lunartics never commanded armies. They did not need them. Every year Lunarkos grew larger above Aerisu. Its presence hung over the world like a verdict already written. For many, hope demanded constant effort. For the Lunartics, the answer felt simple. The moon had come to finish what the sun began, and they had been right to let it come. When the sky broke, when Bahamut rose to meet Lunarkos, the Lunartics stood vindicated in their own eyes. The world had ended as they preached it would. That it had also been saved was a truth that belonged to different gods, different faiths, different stories altogether. They got what they wanted. They regretted nothing.

Related: Lunarkos, Zuki Kusanagi, voluntas, anima

Angels Reformed

Age of Gods · Events

The Angels Reformed

In the chaos following the Vanta Explosion, the remnants of civilisation scavenged and rebuilt. Solmara's Autarch technology evolved. The Angels, those towering mechs once called guardians, were reformed. Fully flight-capable now, able to navigate ash-choked skies and hostile terrain. This was not accidental. The Exandrian Strategic Industries Group had been absorbing Autarch design lineage for years before the Explosion, quietly industrialising what had previously been sacred or singular. Project DAEDALUS gave that process a mandate. The reformed Angels were no longer guardian constructs built for specific places and specific peoples. They were platforms. Reproducible, deployable, deniable. The transition from Shorin no Okami standing alone in an Aokusan field

watching over generations of children to DAEDALUS units shipping out under contract is not a long one when you measure it in design philosophy rather than years. They became symbols of both protection and control. In some regions, worshipped. In others, feared. The line between guardian and oppressor blurred as nations struggled to survive beneath a sky that promised annihilation. Communities that had grown up with a single Angel watching over them now watched unfamiliar units pass through on operations they were not told the purpose of. The same frame. Different intent. Most people could not tell the difference from the ground, which was, in certain quarters, considered a feature. Magic, once Zephyr's secret weapon, spread. Grimoires circulated. Heart Crystals were harvested. Sorcery evolved from desperate experimentation into structured practice. The world was transforming even as it prepared to end.

Related: [esig](#), [project-daedalus](#), [Shorin no Okami](#)

The Coalition Against Lunarkos

Age of Gods · Events

The Coalition Against Lunarkos - Summary

I remember the years after the Vanta Explosion when [Lunarkos](#) hung in the sky above the opened wound of Ylvara. The world answered through many separate hands and minds moving at once. Each turned toward the same pull. The alignment rose from that shared urgency. People reached for survival in their own shapes. Their efforts touched without command or banner. The Coalition took form in those quiet convergences where one path met another through the same question. [Creatis](#) shaped propulsion arrays that lifted the Angels higher and guided the same systems toward vessels built for the void beyond. [Verdantia](#) walked her cultivation frames across scarred lands, seeding hybrid flora and fungal strains that answered to new rhythms of soil and Lux. [Aether](#) traced the patterns in the falling moon and carried them into frameworks that lived outside ordinary time. [Logaris](#) anchored the bridge between what stood and what could endure. Xeraphina gathered pilots into coordinated motion. Their voices carried guidance across the fracture while CHOIR moved as one living current. [Justicar](#) held the line of consequence until the weight turned inward. All of it drew toward the presence beneath [Elysium](#). The alignment saw the crystallised node there and felt its call to [Lunarkos](#). Platforms stood ready for descent. Borers waited in their cradles. Frames rehearsed the strike. The moment approached in year twenty two when the window stood narrow enough that the action could still reach. [Lunarkos](#) arrived in that same year. [The Shattering](#) opened across the world. The prepared descent held in readiness as the sky broke and the ground answered. The presence beneath [Elysium](#) remained through the change, untouched in its crystal sleep. The alignment scattered into the new age, carrying its threads forward in those who crossed beyond the fracture. The work endures in the crystal forests that followed, in the quiet echoes that still guide across the scar, and in the knowledge that the world once reached in every direction at once toward the same light.

Related: [Lunarkos](#), [creatis](#), [verdantia](#), [aether](#), [xeraphina](#), [choir](#)

Post-Shatter

Age of Gods · Events

The World Transformed - Post-Shatter

Centuries after [The Shattering](#) the continents had changed beyond recognition. The old nations lingered only in memory. Their ruins stood claimed by crystal forests and Lux-touched ecosystems. Magic flowed through daily life. Grimoires passed hand to hand. Heart Crystals were gathered from the old bones of the land. Sorcery found its

place in makeshift academies. The line between machine and spell blurred until mechs ran on [Soul Shards](#) and weapons rose from crystallized Vanta. Creatures born of the fallen shards moved through the wilds in forms both beautiful and vast. [The Moon](#) hung overhead as a constant companion. Its light cast shadows that moved with their own quiet intent. And at the heart of everything preserved in crystal waited [Voluntas](#). The Will Unborn. The last god. The presence that carried the promise the world had not yet finished becoming. Humanity endured. It endured as it chose to become.

Related: [The Shattering](#), [voluntas](#)

Pre-Fairytales

Age of Fairytales · Events

Emergence from Ash - Age of Fairytales

In the centuries following [the Shattering](#) of the Sky, survivors clawed existence from volcanic ash and crystal dust. The world had been necroformed, transformed not through gentle evolution but through cataclysm. Where [Lunarkos](#) fragments fell, strange ecosystems bloomed: forests of bioluminescent fungi, valleys where gravity bent in spirals, rivers that flowed upward before cascading down in impossible waterfalls. The people rebuilt from the Echo of the past. They did not consciously recreate the structures of the [Age of Men](#), they simply built what felt right, what resonated in the depths of their souls. Towns rose where towns had always been, though no one living remembered the old foundations. Councils formed with rituals that seemed ancient but were newly invented. Language shifted, yet certain words - Autarch, Angel, Curse - persisted like bones beneath new flesh. This was the nature of the Loop: history repeating not through instruction but through resonance. Yet this time, magic was woven into the equation. And so were the [Gods](#).

Related: [The Shattering](#), [Barrier Between Realms](#)

Barrier Between Realms

Age of Fairytales · Events

The Barrier Between Realms

The [Nine Spirits](#) - [Creatis](#), [Verdantia](#), [Aether](#), [Logaris](#), [Mnemotas](#), [Elysia](#), [Anima](#), [Justicar](#), and [Voluntas](#) - looked upon the nascent world and recognized its fragility. Humanity had nearly destroyed itself twice: once through [the Curse](#), once through [the Shattering](#). Magic, unrestrained, would be the instrument of a third extinction. Together, the Spirits wove a Barrier, separating the [Spirit Realm](#) from the material world. This was a membrane of intent, a metaphysical boundary designed to contain magic within the divine sphere while allowing only controlled seepage into reality. The purpose was dual: protection and purification. If magic could be contained, prevented from saturating the world, then over centuries, perhaps millennia, [Aerisu](#) would be sapped of its arcane saturation and return to something resembling its original state. The people would forget sorcery, forget [the Curse](#), and live as they had in the earliest days of civilisation.

Yet the Spirits underestimated the nature of Echoes. Their own existence, their divinity, created ripples. Through what would later be called the Laws of the Spirits, their domains leaked into reality not as conscious gifts but as ambient influence:

- [Creatis](#) inspired sudden innovation, mad contraptions born from dreams. - [Verdantia](#) caused overgrowth in unexpected places, forests reclaiming ruins overnight. - [Aether](#) bent space near sites of astronomical significance, creating zones where geometry failed. - [Logaris](#) sharpened minds, but also drove scholars to obsession. -

Mnemotas seeded false memories, déjà vu, and temporal dissonance. - Elysia amplified emotions to breaking points. Joy, grief, rage, all heightened beyond natural measure. - Anima whispered at the threshold of death, granting visions or stealing final breaths. - Justicar imposed karmic weight on injustice, manifesting as guilt that could kill. - Voluntas stirred desire. Raw, unfiltered, insatiable.

It was Voluntas who proved most dangerous.

Related: Nine Spirits, voluntas, spirit-laws

First Separation

Age of Fairytales · Events

The First Separation

The Phumenar, studying the Orb across generations, came to believe they could perfect what nature had left incomplete. They sensed the presence within the crystal, the unborn child waiting at the heart of all things. They determined to birth her properly, to free Voluntas from her crystal prison and bring her fully into the world. They performed their ritual at the Rift's edge, the same passage they had opened through centuries of study. They channelled power through Soul Shards and Vanta-touched artefacts, using techniques they barely understood but believed with complete conviction. The Rift, already bleeding Vanta into the world, became their cathedral and their stage. The ritual tore through the barriers between states. Voluntas stirred. Her consciousness, dormant for so long, reached toward emergence. Her will focused for the first time, pressing against the boundaries that held her. But the extraction was incomplete. She hung between states, partly in the crystal, partly in the world, partly in the Spirit Realm, partly nowhere at all. She became what later generations would call the limbless child, not lacking physical form but lacking wholeness itself. All desire, no restraint. All hunger, no satisfaction. All will, no understanding of what will was for. Veyra, already transformed by the Vanta Explosion that had first sealed her, suffered worse. The ritual tore through what remained of her consciousness. She became something the Phumenar recorded in terrified documents before they scattered or died. Beautiful still, preserved in crystal, but wrong beneath the surface. Rotting from within. The Curse made flesh. Fragments of Bahamut's scattered hunger moved through what remained of her awareness, maggots of Vanta-corruption writhing where her self used to be. The Phumenar themselves were caught in the backlash. Some died instantly, their souls simply ceasing. Others became the first Pixpsy, their consciousness stretched across moments, trapped between states, never fully present anywhere. A few escaped, carrying fragments of understanding that would become the foundation of magical theory in the ages to come. The Rift, already open, widened further. Voluntas's partially emerged will held it open, not through choice but through condition. She could not close what she had become. She could not fully emerge. She could not return to what she was. Her stuckness became a permanent wound between realms, a passage that would never fully seal. The other Gods reached from their side of the Barrier to close the Rift. They pushed against it with all their divine will, but Voluntas remained on the mortal side, drawn through by the Phumenar's long study and desperate ritual. Her pure will, even in its incomplete state, held the passage open against them. The Rift endured. In the aftermath, the Phumenar who had not died or transformed scattered across the rebuilding world. Their cities fell silent. The First Observatory stood as a tomb filled with crystallised remains of scholars who had touched the Orb too deeply. Entire populations either fled or surrendered to soul-distortion. Within two generations the Phumenar civilisation had collapsed. But fragments of them persisted as Soul Shards, crystallized pieces of their will and knowledge scattered across Aerisu. These Shards carry the original determination to reach the Orb, the hunger for understanding that drove the Phumenar to their end. Seekers hunt them across the ages as artifacts of immense power, each one a condensed echo of curiosity that refuses to fade.

Related: orb-of-souls, phumenar, voluntas, The Rift

Ash at the Rift

Age of Fairytales · Events

Ash at the Rift

Ash came to the Rift in the aftermath. He had fought through the ruins of Elysium, through the Hell that city had become, carrying the Echo of his love for Veyra and the memory of the child they had created together. He reached the place where she rested. She was beautiful still. Crystal preserved her exactly as she had been at the moment of detonation, hands cradling her womb, head bowed, protecting. For a moment he believed she might be saved. For a moment hope outweighed everything he had witnessed. Then he looked closer. The ritual had done this. The Phumenar's intervention, however well intended, had cracked what should have remained sealed. Veyra's form was preserved, but beneath the crystal surface something had gone terribly wrong. The Vanta inside consumed her substance even as the crystal held her shape. Corruption moved through what remained of her. Fragments of hunger writhed in the spaces where her self used to be. He fled from horror, from the recognition that the woman he loved was gone and what remained should not be witnessed. Some doors, once opened, cannot be closed. At the Rift's edge he stopped. He turned back. He could not leave her entirely. He tried to seal the Rift. With the Phumenar dead or dying, with fragments of knowledge gathered from their scattered notes, with nothing but will and desperation, he attempted to close what Voluntas held open. He failed. Voluntas, even partially emerged, even unaware, even unborn, possessed will enough to keep the passage open. She did not choose this. She simply was this. The Rift was her condition, not her decision. Desire itself cannot be sealed because desire is the force that opens. Ash, exhausted and heartbroken, made his vow. He would tend the living. He would remind the world that tomorrow exists. He would be the sun that rises even when everything below is shadow. He descended from Elysium and walked into the world, and somewhere in his wanderings he became something more than mortal, the Warm Sun beginning its long journey. What remained at the Rift was Veyra, trapped and rotting, her curse killing a thousand in ways she could not control. And Voluntas, the limbless child, waiting unknowingly for someone to finish what the Phumenar had started, to birth her properly, to free her from the between-state that had become her prison. And then others came.

Related: First Separation, Ash Salinte, Veyra Megami, voluntas

Eternal Rift Conflict

Age of Fairytales · Events

The Eternal Rift Conflict

In the ages that followed the First Separation, the Rift drew those who felt its pull. Some sought power. Some sought knowledge. Some sought the Orb itself, driven by the same hunger that had consumed the Phumenar. The passage between worlds pulsed with possibility, a wound that would not heal, a door that would not close. Among those who came were two whose arrival changed everything. Susanoo arrived first. He had wandered the western valleys for centuries as chaos without direction, a fragment of Bahamut's hunger with no understanding of what hunger was for. The Rift called to him as it called to all things that carried desire, and when he found it, when he felt his sister trapped within, he found his purpose. He chose to protect her. Not because he understood mercy or compassion, but because he recognised himself in her vulnerability. She was what he had been, pure will and pure desire. She deserved what he had never received, someone to guard her while she waited to become. Daigo Kusanagi came later. He had walked the world for centuries as the Shinigami, ending suffering wherever he found it. The Rift called to him too, but differently. It called as a wound that needed closing, as suffering that needed ending, as family that needed release. He came to end what Susanoo had come to protect. They met at the Rift's

edge. Daigo with blade drawn and mercy in his heart. Susanoo with storms gathered and determination absolute. They spoke few words, for there was nothing to say that either could hear. Daigo saw a great-granddaughter whose existence killed thousands. Susanoo saw a sister who deserved to live. Both were right. Both were wrong. Both acted from love. They have fought ever since. The battle has no victor. Daigo cannot reach [the Rift](#) with Susanoo guarding it. Susanoo cannot stop Daigo, can only delay him again and again across the centuries. They have become each other's prisons, bound together by opposition, unable to move forward, unable to let go. When lightning strikes near [Elysium's](#) ruins, it is Susanoo warning his sister of approaching danger. He carves messages into the sky with every strike, warnings that only those who know how to read the storm can understand. Travellers in the region learn to heed these signs, turning back when lightning strikes too often, seeking shelter when thunder rolls without rain. When a figure in black moves through the shadows near [the Rift](#), it is Daigo still seeking, still hoping, still unable to let go. He studies the patterns of Susanoo's storms, watches for weakness, waits for an opening that never comes. He has learned the storm god's rhythms across centuries, knows when the lightning will strike and where, but knowing changes nothing. Susanoo is as patient as he is. The war between them shapes the land around [the Rift](#). The constant storms have carved new valleys, reshaped old mountains, created zones where lightning strikes so frequently that nothing grows. The shadows where Daigo walks have deepened, becoming places where travellers lose their way, where time itself seems to slow. [The Rift's](#) edge has become a boundary between two forces, a place where the world itself holds its breath. In the crystal at [the Rift's](#) heart, [Voluntas](#) waits. She does not know about the war fought for her sake. She does not know that her brother coils around her prison in eternal vigilance. She does not know that her great-grandfather walks the shadows nearby, waiting for the chance to offer her mercy. She sleeps and grows and dreams, unaware that two figures have spent eternity locked in conflict over whether she deserves to live. Some day she will emerge. Some day she will choose for herself. Some day the battle will end because the reason for fighting will no longer exist. When she steps out of the cave, when she claims her own existence, Susanoo's vigil will finally have meaning and Daigo's mercy will finally have an answer. Until then, the guardians remain. The storm god and the Shinigami. The brother who protects and the grandfather who would free. Locked together at the edge of [the Rift](#), each waiting for a day that only she can bring.

Related: [susanoo](#), [daigo-kusanagi](#), [voluntas](#), [The Rift](#)

Draken Genesis

Age of Fairytales · Events

The Draken Genesis

[Velstheim](#), City of the Crystal Shadow

[Velstheim](#) rose in Ylvara during the later [Age of Fairytales](#), built where the land felt right without explanation, near enough to [Elysium](#) that Veyra's crystallized tomb cast pale light across its walls on certain days. Shadows moved with quiet purpose in that glow. The kingdom stood in divinity's nearness, and that closeness shaped every custom and belief. Magic threaded daily life. Fallen fragments of [Bahamut](#) and [Lunarkos](#) roamed wild places. Grimoires circulated. Sorcery took root in academies. The scarred Moon watched overhead. At the centre radiated [Voluntas](#), the Will Unborn, hunger sealed in crystal by Veyra's womb during the Vanta Explosion. Her presence pressed outward like forge-heat against [the soul](#), a constant whisper of want and longing. The people named Veyra the Mother of [Aerisu](#). She carried [Voluntas](#), who had summoned [Bahamut](#), who had remade the world through ascent and collision. She held the planetary hunger in eternal suspension. Pilgrims approached [Elysium's](#) ruins from afar, praying at distance while Susanoo's storms guarded [the Rift](#). Shrines rose in [Velstheim](#). Offerings gathered at altars. Prayers sought her blessing, her patience, her continued vigil. Reverence mingled with ambition. Proximity to the sacred carried responsibility. Knights trained to defend kingdom and crystal city. Nobles vied for influence in the Mother's name. Scholars probed [Voluntas's](#) echo, seeking to grasp desire's radiation from [Elysium](#) like sunlight.

Lady Draka, The Barren Queen

Lady Draka, noble and devout, married King Draco of Velstheim. Beauty and station surrounded her. One absence consumed her. Her womb remained empty. Prayers, offerings, healers, sorcerers, priests yielded nothing. Her body refused life. She gazed toward Elysium and saw Veyra, the Mother who bore Voluntas. If divinity could carry hunger itself, surely it could grant her a child. She made pilgrimages to the Rift's edge, spoke desperation into wind and lightning, begged the Mother for what every woman deserved. Voluntas answered. Unborn will, formless desire, hunger without restraint or compassion. It amplified what already existed. Draka's longing for a child swelled beyond maternal want. It became all-consuming need. Infants evoked absence. Pregnancy in others cut like wounds. Cradles accused. She concluded that if she could not birth life, she could absorb it. Consumption might fill the void, assemble pieces into the child denied her. She began with infants from lower districts, taken quietly, devoured flesh, bone, nascent soul. Each brought her closer, she believed. The void expanded instead.

King Draco, The Guilty Father

Draco loved his wife and his realm. When succession murmurs grew, when priests urged heirs beyond the barren queen, he accepted the duty. He fathered children with women of lesser houses, blessed unions for stability. He performed the act, blurred faces in memory, convinced himself the children would thrive, acknowledged as royal though illegitimate. Every child emerged malformed. Twisted limbs, scales in place of skin, glowing eyes, mouths stretched wide. Some perished swiftly. Others survived long enough to wail before him, small monstrosities. Draco found no fault in his actions. Priests had blessed him. Yet corruption marked each birth. When Draka discovered these children, rage fused with her hunger. She claimed them as her stillborns, the offspring she should have borne. She devoured them. Draco knew. Silence held him. Guilt pressed like stone. He had sired monsters. His wife had transformed. Priests insisted he continue. More children arrived wrong. Draka took them. He permitted it because existence itself seemed wrong.

The Transformation

Hunger intensified. Consumption widened. Draka devoured infants, malformed young, anything small and vital. Her body altered. Pale pearl scales erupted across skin. Her womb hollowed into echoing cavity. Voice deepened to rattle windows and set dogs howling. Hands stretched into clawed talons. She concealed the changes with heavy gowns and seclusion. Transformation accelerated. Spine curved outward. Wings formed, membrane stretching between emerging bone. Face elongated into reptilian beauty, terrible and recognisable. The night she fully shifted, she rampaged through the castle nursery, devoured the latest hidden infant, scales and claws and all, while servants fled screaming. Draco found her crouched over the empty cradle, massive, winged, scaled, eyes ablaze with insatiable need. He saw his wife within the monster, desperation, rage, the realisation she had become the devourer she feared. She had sought to create life. She became appetite incarnate.

The Forging of Dréagbann

Draco accepted responsibility. He had fed her corruption through guilt and failure. He gathered smiths and sorcerers, supplied materials from Elysium's ruins: Lux-touched metals, crystal-infused stone. He commissioned a blade to end the unendable, to sever divine corruption. Dréagbann emerged. Spirit-bane. Steel folded with Lux, quenched in Elysium streams, blessed by priests. Guilt shaped into weapon. The king's last duty. He hunted her to mountain cliffs above Velstheim. She perched there, wings spread, coiled. She did not flee. They clashed. Draco fought with royal skill. Draka struck with hunger's fury. Dréagbann found its mark through her heart. She screamed across valleys, grief and rage and release entwined. Scales shed. Wings collapsed. Form dissolved toward humanity. She lay almost herself again. Enough for him to recognise her. He wept over her body.

The Journey to Lupellyn

Draco could not keep the blade. Its weight carried his failure. He journeyed south to Dramorinth, to Lupellyn lake, deep and ancient among hills, fed by underground springs linked to vast tunnels. At the water's edge he prayed no one would ever need such a weapon again. He cast Dréagbann into the depths. It sank silently. Ripples faded. The surface smoothed. He returned to Velstheim, ruled childless for twenty years, died. The throne passed to a distant cousin. No one spoke of Draka, the malformed children, the mountain transformation. The tale lingered in

whispers, hidden texts, families who had lost young to her hunger. Centuries later the sword resurfaced when needed, drawn from the lake by guiding hands, offered to those who required it. That belongs to another time.

The Legacy of Drakens

Draka's death released the corruption. Hunger bled into earth, roots, streams from those mountains. Malformed children carried the seed in blood. Their mothers bore it in wombs. Dragons emerged. Four-legged, winged, scaled, ravenous. Drakens, named for the first. Independent fragments of her amplified desire, appetite given form, voids that could never fill. Beautiful, terrible, intelligent, monstrous. They spoke when they chose, roared when instinct demanded. Wyverns arose from the mothers touched by corruption, partway transformed, two-legged, broad-winged. They nested high, keened mourning songs through nights, sought lost warmth. The curse spread. Bites, claws, breath risked transformation. Some became Wyverns, others full Drakens depending on exposure. Velstheim defined itself through dragon-slaying, knightly orders trained against hunger-born threats. Other Ylvaran kingdoms followed. Solmara forged protocols, containment, scale-piercing weapons. Knighthood centred on combating mothers turned monsters. Drakens entered the ecosystem. They nested in caves, hoarded to fill emptiness, attacked from drive, hunted relentlessly as spreading plague. Some grew ancient, intelligent beyond hunger, capable of bargain. Relations layered fear, respect, uneasy balance. Wyverns remained tragic. Mourning calls echoed. Rituals eased suffering in some places, offerings in high spots. Others slew them as threats. Lady Draka, who hungered for a child until Voluntas's echo turned longing into vast appetite, mothered a species through her death. She birthed dragons from corruption. She seeded the plague that reshaped Ylvara's culture for generations.

Related: voluntas, vey-megami

Age of Magic

Age of Magic · Events

The Age of Magic

From Myth to Mastery

The Age of Magic emerged through slow accumulation. Wonders that once travelled as stories settled into the ordinary rhythm of life. Dragons shaped by the corruption of Lady Draka soared across the skies. Anqa, the metal god, stood within the memory of Falak's defeat. Zorya Chernaya ruled the burning reaches of the hellscape. The Vantari cultivated their death gardens beneath shadowed skies. The world carried a settled understanding of its shape. Gods held their domains. Creatures of legend walked openly through the lands of Aerisu. Cosmology rested in the minds of scholars and priests as shared knowledge rather than uncertain rumour. The age that followed grew from this clarity.

A Civilisation of Spell and Steel

Cities reshaped themselves around magic. Mage Quarters formed within their walls, districts where arcane practice flourished under civic law. Guilds gathered practitioners of flame, wind, water, and stone into structured disciplines. Universities opened Colleges of Soul Craft, studying the movement of essence with patience earned through earlier catastrophe. The University of Castellenza in Ylvara rose to prominence through its careful study of the Orb. Scholars there approached the mysteries that destroyed the Phumenar with measured discipline and enduring curiosity. Remnants of the Age of Men continued to breathe within this world of spellcraft. Rusted Angels stood in city plazas as monuments to an earlier ambition, their silent frames humming faintly with lingering power. Exandria rekindled Project DAEDALUS and launched airships powered by engines that fused steam with sorcery. In Argestia, an industrial consortium bearing Xeraphina's name spread electricity and mass production across the continents. This age carried a seamless union of arcane and mechanical craft. Knights rode mechanised steeds while clad in armour woven with enchantment. Cathedrals glowed with stained glass threaded through Lux crystal

circuitry. Sahrani engineers worked with Qayyin's impossible components to assemble towering war machines piloted by living minds. Magic and machinery moved through the same current of invention.

The World Renewed

Life across [Aerisu](#) followed familiar patterns shaped by the deep resonance of the Loop. Settlements rose again where earlier towns once stood, their streets carrying both old memory and new sorcery. [The Geode](#) of [Tayran](#), where Falak's fallen body nourished impossible forests, became a landmark visited with reverence and curiosity. [Velstheim](#) organised dragon slayers into knightly orders trained for a world where such creatures flew openly. In [Ereboska](#), the Vantari tribes cultivated their death gardens and guided travellers through [the Veins](#) beneath the wasteland, trading their knowledge for high reward. [Fengua](#) harnessed Raikami crystals and refined the disciplined practice of Chi beneath a strict Confucian order. [Hoshimira](#) accepted the shelter of [Solmara](#) while maintaining the quiet spirituality of its mountain traditions. [Aerisu](#) carried the same peoples, the same lands, and the same ancient forces. Their arrangement had shifted. The world breathed through a new harmony of magic, industry, and memory, each shaping the rhythm of an age that understood both wonder and control.

Related: [Draken Genesis](#), [anqa](#), [zorya-chernaya](#), [The Geode](#)

Aurelius' Journey

Age of Magic · Events

The Fool's Journey of [Aurelius Cassian](#)

The Fall

[The Curse](#) came to Caelmont like a slow tide, rising not through the streets but through the blood. What began as fever in the outer districts became wasting in the noble houses and then something worse: forgetting. Names slipped away first, then faces, then the shape of oneself. The Vanta saturation that had built for generations finally crested, and Frallation swept through the kingdom like fire through dry grass. [Aurelius Cassian](#) watched his people die and did not know how to stop it. The Psycrata came from New [Elysium](#) with their scrolls and their theories and their carefully measured solutions. They spoke of the Separation Ritual, of drawing [the soul](#) from the body, of externalising what had grown too large to contain. [The soul](#) would emerge as an Affinity, a beast self made manifest, and the person would survive. [The Curse](#) would recede from their flesh. They would live. [Aurelius](#) refused. [The soul](#) belonged in the body. The old ways had never needed such mutilation. [The Curse](#) spread. Caelmont burned with it. [Severa Valmont](#) watched from the council chambers, a woman who had risen through competence rather than blood. She had watched [Aurelius](#) refuse solution after solution. She had watched the death toll climb. And finally she had watched the people begin to whisper that perhaps the king was not the answer but the problem. The coup was bloodless. Severa walked into the throne room with the captains of the guard and the heads of the merchant guilds and a delegation of common citizens whose faces bore the scars of watching children die. She did not draw a weapon. She said simply that he had refused to save them and they would not refuse. [Aurelius](#) looked at the faces behind her, his own guard and his own advisors and his own people, and saw that they were not enemies. They were simply done with him. He laid down his crown and walked out of the city. Behind him the bells of Caelmont began to ring, and he knew they were not mourning his departure but celebrating the woman who would finally do what needed to be done.

The First Gift

He wandered for weeks, sleeping in fields and abandoned farmsteads, eating what he could scavenge. [The Curse](#) moved in him too, a warmth behind his eyes, a whisper at the edge of dreams. He ignored it as he had always ignored what he did not wish to see. The dreams began on the seventeenth night. A woman's voice, crystalline and broken, speaking from somewhere deep. She called him by name. She told him there was a place where [the Curse](#) began and could therefore end. She told him to seek the [Orb of Souls](#), to touch it, to take its power for his own. She

told him that if he could reach Elysium, he could save them all. He did not know that the voice was Veyra Megami, trapped in crystal for centuries, her consciousness fragmenting, her desire for death so vast that she would use any pawn to achieve it. He only knew that someone had given him a purpose. To reach Elysium he would need to break the Barrier between worlds. To break the Barrier he would need a weapon that could wound gods. The dreams showed him a lake. Lupellyn. And in its depths, a sword. Solivara Venn found him three days later, asleep against a tree, muttering about water and blades. She had been tracking him since Caelmont, sent by the Psycrata to observe a deposed king with a god killing mission. She believed in study and patience and understanding before action. Aurelius Cassian represented everything she opposed. She woke him with the toe of her boot and told him he was going the wrong way. Lupellyn was south. He should have refused her. He should have walked away. But there was something in her certainty that reminded him of Severa, the same refusal to be dismissed. And he was alone, and the road was long, and even a mocking companion was better than none.

Lupellyn was not what Aurelius expected. The water was dark, almost black, fed by underground springs that carried the cold of depths no sunlight reached. No birds sang. No wind stirred. The Fae emerged from the space above the water, beautiful in the way that glaciers are beautiful, terrible and inhuman, her eyes fractured mirrors reflecting not just the shore but countless other shores and countless other moments. She spoke of the sword below, the blade Draco had thrown after killing what he loved, unable to bear the proof. Aurelius could take it, but he must pay. He must speak his failure truly, not the version he told himself at night but the version he hid from. He spoke. He had been afraid. The Separation Ritual had seemed a violation, but the truth was deeper. He was afraid of what his people would become. If they carried their souls outside themselves, they would see him clearly. They would see that he was just a man, and a man can be replaced. He let them die because he was afraid of being seen. The Fae nodded once. That was the truth. He could have the blade. The water parted. From the darkness below, Dréagbann rose, dark and ancient and heavy with the weight of what it had already done. Aurelius waded into the shallows and took it. The blade was cold. It remembered killing. It would kill again.

The Frost Mother

They travelled north through lands that grew steadily colder. Solivara mapped their route with Psycrata precision, asking Aurelius about his dreams and his understanding of the Orb. He had none. He only knew he had to reach it. She told him that the Orb was not a tool or a battery for power, that the Phumenar had spent centuries studying it and destroyed themselves. He answered that they had tried to understand while he meant only to use. She said that was worse. He did not answer. The hunger in him was growing, and he had stopped questioning its source. Norrvektstan greeted them with ice and wind and a people who had learned to smile through both. Yrsa Halvard found them at the edge of a village called Athmona. She was massive, her braided hair pale as ice, her eyes the grey of winter seas. A greataxe rested across her back, and she moved like someone who had never needed to prove she could use it. She knew where they were going. Everyone who travelled north in winter sought Hvítara. Most did not return. She offered to accompany them, not to face the god but to ensure they did not freeze before they reached her. The journey north took another two weeks. The cold deepened. The sun grew thin. Yrsa taught them to read the ice, to find shelter in places that looked like solid rock, to move when moving was possible and wait when it was not. She told stories of her people, of the Frost Mother they had worshipped and feared for generations, of the serpents that moved beneath the ice and the lights that danced across the sky when Hvítara dreamed. They found Hvítara on the seventy-third day. She was coiled around a spire of ice that rose from the frozen sea, her scales pale as frost, her many heads resting or watching or simply existing in the patience of something that had waited since the Shattering. She was massive beyond reckoning, and the cold around her was not absence of heat but presence of something else, something that had its own temperature and its own will. Aurelius walked toward her. One of her heads turned to watch him, her eyes the colour of winter water, deep and still and utterly without judgement. He attacked. Dréagbann bit into her scales, and she roared, not in pain but in surprise. The blade had been forged to kill Draken, mortal corruption made flesh. Against a fragment of Bahamut it could wound but only superficially. The cut closed as he watched. Her heads turned toward him, all of them, and the cold intensified until his breath froze in his throat. The battle was not victory. It was survival. They wounded her with small cuts and scratches, annoyances. And she, curious rather than angry, let them live. Perhaps she remembered Susanoo, remembered that violence was not the only language. Perhaps she simply found them

interesting, these tiny creatures who would dare. When it was over, when they had retreated to the edge of her domain and collapsed into snow that should have killed them, [Aurelius](#) looked at his sword and understood. It was not enough. It would never be enough. He had come to kill a god, and all he had done was make her yawn. Mikazuki Shinobu sat down across from him, cross-legged, her moon white fox curled in her lap. She had been following them since Caelmont. A Tsukuyomi, carrying [the moon's](#) witness, she had seen futures in her dreams. She had watched him fight a god and survive, and she had seen something in him that she could not explain. She would travel with them, not to help but to witness. When the time came, she would know what must be done. [Aurelius](#) looked at this woman he had not noticed for weeks, this assassin who could have killed him a hundred times and chose not to. He should have been afraid. Instead he felt something he had almost forgotten: the sense that he was being seen, truly seen, and not found wanting. He asked her to stay. She smiled, just slightly, and the crescent moon had never looked so full. In the weeks that followed, something grew between them in the spaces words could not reach. She watched him always, but her watching softened into something that was no longer assessment but attention. He found himself speaking to her in the long silences of the march, telling her things he had not told Solivara, things he had not admitted even to himself. She listened without judgement, without counsel, without anything but the gift of her presence. When their hands brushed against the cold, neither moved away.

The Mountain That Did Not Bless

They turned southwest toward [Fengua](#) and Susanoo, but [Aurelius](#) had another destination first. The dreams had shown him a mountain, a peak above all peaks, where a goddess dwelt behind a mirrored mask. [Eirimegami](#). The [Sacred Air](#). If his sword was not enough, perhaps her blessing would make it so. The journey through [Fengua's](#) borderlands was tense. The storm battered valleys were thick with patrols, and Jun Wenzhi found them before they had gone twenty miles. He waited at a crossroads, robes perfect, staff planted in the frozen earth, his thunderbird circling overhead like a herald of judgement. [Fengua](#) had watched their journey with interest. They sought Susanoo. He would accompany them, to observe and understand what drove a man to chase [gods](#). Megami-no-Mine rose above them for days before they reached it, a spire of rock and ice that seemed to pierce the sky itself. The climb was brutal, thin air and hidden crevasses and winds that tried to pluck them from the mountain. Yrsa led, her experience with ice making the difference between progress and death. They reached the summit on the seventh day. [Eirimegami](#) waited behind her mirror, a figure of light and air and the thin brightness of places where breath itself becomes precious. She did not speak, but her presence filled the space around her, not overwhelming but complete. [Aurelius](#) held out his sword and asked for her blessing. She did not move. The mirror reflected his own face back at him, gaunt and hungry and desperate. He tried again. Nothing. Mikazuki stepped forward. She knelt, not in supplication but in acknowledgement, and placed her hand on the snow. When she rose, she held a white flower, the [Sacred Air](#), cold and luminous, blooming where no flower should bloom. She offered it to him, not the sword. He took it. He waited for power to surge, for the blade to glow, for something to change. Nothing happened. The flower was just a flower, beautiful and fragile and utterly useless. He tucked it into his belt and turned away. Behind him the goddess watched through her mirror. She had offered healing. He had refused it. The flower would do nothing because he would not let it.

The Empty Trial

They descended from Megami-no-Mine and turned toward [Sahran](#). Falak waited there, the earth fragment, the third trial. [Aurelius](#) prepared himself for the confrontation that would test everything he had learned from Hvítara and everything he had failed to learn from the peak. But Falak was already dead. The serpent's corpse hung impaled on [the Geode](#), massive and still, its scales feeding the death gardens that bloomed around its base. Flowers grew from its bones. Trees rose from its spilled blood. The Luminaries had done this, not killed it but used its death, perverted its residue into something that would serve their purpose. [Aurelius](#) stood at [the Geode's](#) edge and felt the emptiness of a battle that would never come. Vostic found him there, a Vantari guide watching from the shadows to see what this golden king would do when faced with absence. The Luminaries had sealed [the Veins](#), Vostic explained. They had learned from his people and then betrayed them, and now they moved toward [Elysium](#) with their horde. If [Aurelius](#) wanted to reach the Orb, he would need to go through them. And to go through them, he would need another path. Varkane. [The Abyss](#). The wound [Bahamut](#) left when it rose. The hellscape beneath was part of [the Veins](#), the deepest and oldest part. If they could cross the ocean and descend through [the Abyss](#),

they could reach the tunnels below the Luminaries' seals. But the Abyss was not empty. Zorya Chernaya ruled there, and Cerberus guarded the gate. Aurelius looked at Falak's corpse, at the death gardens blooming from divine rot. He had come here to fight. There was no fight. But there was still a path.

The Crossing

Yrsa called in favours. Her cousin commanded a small fleet of knarrs, sturdy vessels built for ice and storm, and for her sake he agreed to carry them east. The crossing took three weeks. They sailed through waters that grew steadily warmer, past islands that marked the boundary between Solmara's influence and something older. Solivara spent the voyage documenting everything. Jun stood at the prow each dawn, meditating, his thunderbird circling against skies that grew more familiar. Mikazuki sat in the shadows of the mast, watching always watching. Aurelius found himself drawn to her silence, to the way her presence asked nothing and gave everything. Seriphax stood at the stern, facing west, facing the direction they had come. It did not speak for the entire crossing. On the nineteenth day they saw it: a darkness on the horizon that was not cloud or storm or land. The Varkane Abyss was not a place you approached but a presence you felt, a pressure in the chest, a whisper at the edge of hearing. The sky above it was permanently grey, ash stained, lit from below by the glow of magma that never cooled. The knarrs would go no further. Yrsa's cousin embraced her, spoke words in their tongue that made her jaw tighten, and turned his ships back toward the north. The party stood on a shore of black sand and volcanic glass, staring at the wound in the earth.

The Abyss

The descent took them through layers of fire and shadow. Vostic led, his Vein sense guiding them through paths that were not paths, through cracks in the stone that opened into tunnels that opened into chasms. The architecture began to change. What had been natural formation became something else, shaped stone and carved surfaces and walls that remembered the touch of hands that had never been human. Gothic arches rose from the rock, black basalt twisted into forms that suggested cathedrals and tombs and things between. Gargoyles watched from every ledge, their stone eyes following, their stone mouths frozen in expressions that might have been warning or welcome. They walked deeper. The heat intensified. Magma flowed in channels beside their path, casting red light that made everything strange. The gargoyles grew thicker, their watching more intense. And then the path opened into a vast chamber, and Cerberus was there. He was larger than anything had a right to be. Three heads, each the size of a warhorse, black fur like volcanic glass, eyes red as fresh magma. He lay across the only passage forward, his bodies arranged to block everything, his six eyes fixed on them with an intelligence that was not animal. He spoke not with words but with presence. Each head asked a question that bypassed ears and spoke directly to the soul. The left head asked what they had lost. The centre head asked what they would sacrifice. The right head asked what they hunted. One by one the party answered. Solivara had lost certainty and would sacrifice her pride and hunted understanding. Yrsa had lost everyone she loved eventually and would sacrifice her life and hunted nothing but walked with friends. Jun had lost himself and would sacrifice his obedience and hunted peace. Vostic had lost his people to betrayal and would sacrifice his body and hunted the Luminaries. Mikazuki stepped forward. She did not speak. She simply opened herself completely, showing her memories and her visions and the futures she had seen. Cerberus saw everything. Saw the Tsukuyomi dreams. Saw the love growing in her for the hollow king. Saw the duel to come and the choice she would have to make. The heads drew back in respect. Aurelius stepped forward last. The questions pressed against him, and he had nothing left. He had lost his kingdom and his people and his memories and himself. He would sacrifice anything, had already sacrificed everything. He hunted the Orb, but he no longer knew why. Cerberus looked at him for a long moment. Then the heads turned away, and the passage was open.

The Seven Daughters

The Daughters' domains lay in concentric rings around the Abyss's heart, each one a trial, each one a corruption of desire made manifest. Gordyna's realm was a hall of mirrors where pride became infinite reflection. Lakoma's vaults held everything anyone had ever wanted. Pohotna's chambers offered connection without duty, love without cost. For a heartbeat Mikazuki saw a future where she did not have to kill the man she walked beside. She walked past it, but the image remained, and in the darkness Aurelius's hand found hers. They walked together through the

remaining trials, and the warmth of that touch was the only light in places where light did not belong. Zavista's shifting halls showed each of them what others had that they could never have. Obzera's feasting tables offered endless consumption. Gneva's arena gave battle without end. Lena's quiet chambers offered rest that asked nothing. They walked through each domain, losing pieces of themselves, finding pieces they had forgotten. By the time they emerged, they were something other than who they had been.

The Machine in the Dark

Beyond the Daughters' domains the hellscape gave way to something older. Natural tunnels led deeper into the Veins proper, passages that had existed since before the Shattering, stone that remembered the world before gods. Seriphax found them in a tunnel where the walls glowed with phosphorescent fungi. It had been standing there for centuries, its optics dim, its frame crusted with mineral deposits. It had been waiting, though it did not remember for what. Now they were here, so it would come with them. In the darkness Jun broke open. He admitted that he had been sent to observe them, to report back, that Fengua wanted to know if they would reach the Orb so their cannon could destroy it. Yrsa shrugged. They knew. Mikazuki had told them weeks ago. Jun stared at her and then laughed, real laughter, warm and broken and free. He had spent his whole life being subtle, and none of it mattered. Mikazuki said quietly that he had chosen differently, and that was what mattered. In that moment, watching the exchange, Aurelius felt Mikazuki's hand in his and understood that she had known about Jun from the beginning and had said nothing. She had trusted him to make his own choice. She trusted everyone to make their own choices, witnessed without intervening, loved without controlling. He had never known anyone like her.

The Train and the Price

They reached Tomenos's line in the depths where the Veins opened into something vaster. The train waited on tracks that glowed faintly, its cars old and strange and filled with passengers who did not move. Tomenos himself stood at the engine, his face kind and tired and older than anything they had seen. To go further, they must pay. Memories. The ones that made them who they were. One by one they paid. Solivara paid the memory of her first day at the University, the wonder and the certainty and the belief that knowledge would save everything. Yrsa paid the memory of her mother's face. She forgot the woman who had raised her, but remembered the weight of being raised, the duty and the love and the shape of something that had been there. Mikazuki paid a childhood memory, small and irrelevant, because Shinkiri had taught her to hide what mattered. But the payment cost her something she did not understand until later: the ability to forget. From then on, she remembered everything. Every moment. Every face. Every future she had seen. Every touch of Aurelius's hand. Vostic paid the names of his tribe. Seriphax had no memories left and paid by giving up the hope that it would ever find purpose again. Jun paid the memory of his first master, the man who had taught him discipline and order. Aurelius paid last. He paid the sound of Caelmont's bells, the faces of his people, the weight of the crown he had carried and lost. When he stepped off the train, he remembered only that he had been a king. He did not remember what it had felt like to love his kingdom. But when Mikazuki took his hand again, he remembered that some things could still be felt.

The Spiral

The stations of the Spiral stripped them further. In Anima's region they faced death directly. In Elysia's region emotion flooded them. Jun felt everything he had suppressed for decades and almost drowned. Yrsa held him while he shook, and for the first time in his life he let someone hold him. In Logaris's region Solivara found herself lost in the library of contradictions. In Creatis's region Seriphax stood motionless for three days and emerged changed. In Justicar's region Mikazuki was judged and found guilty of witnessing without acting. She accepted the verdict without argument. In Aether's region Jun saw the shape of his life as a circle going nowhere. In Mnemotas's region each of them found their volume. Aurelius's volume was thin, almost blank. He opened it and read: he wanted. He never stopped wanting. He never learned what for. He closed the book and looked at Mikazuki. She was reading her own volume, a blank book that held everything she had witnessed and nothing she had done. Their eyes met across the library of lives, and in that moment he understood that she had given him something no one else ever had: the gift of being seen completely and loved anyway.

The Storm Guardian

The tunnels began to change as they neared [the Rift](#). The walls shimmered with residual energy, veins of crystallised Lux and Vanta running through the stone like frozen lightning. The air grew heavy and charged, thick with the presence of something vast and watching. They could hear it now, a rhythm, a pulse, the heartbeat of the world itself. Susanoo waited at the threshold. He was coiled around [the Rift](#) like a serpent around its treasure, his scales shimmering with storm light, his many eyes fixed on the passage below. Lightning played across his form, constant and alive, and thunder rolled from his chest in a rhythm that matched the pulse of the Orb beyond. He had waited here for centuries, guarding his sister, protecting the unborn god from all who would harm her. [Aurelius](#) stopped at the edge of his domain and said they must pass. Susanoo's answer was clear in the lightning that forked toward them, in the thunder that shook the stone. No. The party prepared to fight. They would die here probably, but they would die trying. Then the world shook. The tremor came from above, from the surface, from somewhere far beyond [the Veins](#). The ceiling cracked. Dust rained. Susanoo's eyes turned upward. Above in [Fengua](#) the cannon was ready. They had built it in secret, Raikami crystals lining its barrel, harvested from centuries of lightning strikes. The target was New [Elysium](#), the fortress city built atop the crystallised ruins. The plan was simple: blast through to the Orb, destroy it, end [the Curse](#) at its source. The firing chamber charged. Lightning screamed along the barrel. And in the moment before release, Susanoo rose through the earth to meet it. He sensed the weapon aimed at the city his people had built, at the ruins where his sister slept. He rose through stone and crystal and the wounded ground of [Fengua](#), placing himself between the cannon and everything he had guarded for so long. The beam tore through him, through divine flesh and ancient scales, and he fell back toward [the Rift](#). He crashed into the chamber where the party waited, lightning bleeding from his wounds, his coils loosening from around the passage. The way was open. But Susanoo was not dead. He lay across the threshold, still breathing, still watching. His eyes found [Aurelius](#), and in that gaze [Aurelius](#) saw something he did not expect: understanding. Go, the storm god seemed to say. Protect her. I could not. Then the light faded from his eyes, and Susanoo was still. [Aurelius](#) stood frozen, the weight of the god's gaze still pressing against him. Mikazuki stepped forward and took his hand. He let her. For a moment he could not move, could not speak, could only feel the enormity of what had just happened. A god had died protecting something he loved. A god had looked at him and seen something worth passing that protection to. They stepped through [the Rift](#) together, her hand in his.

The Orb

They emerged into [Elysium](#) together. The crystal city stretched before them, frozen at the moment of its destruction, every building and street and citizen preserved in amber light. At its heart the Orb pulsed, vast and terrible and beautiful, Veyra's womb made manifest, [Voluntas](#) waiting within. They were not alone. Zharael stood before the Orb, her Luminaries arrayed behind her, the Vanta horde seething at their command. The Sahrani mech army poured from another passage, their piloted frames gleaming with Qayyin's craftsmanship. Daigo Kusanagi stepped from shadow, his horn black blade gleaming, his single eye fixed on the Orb. [Anima](#) activated. Every automaton in the vicinity rose to defend the Orb. Seriphax felt the pull and chose. It walked toward its friends. The battle erupted.

The Duel

In the chaos [Aurelius](#) walked toward the Orb. Mikazuki saw him go. She had seen this moment in dreams, the hollow king reaching for the light, the future shattering like glass. She had known since Hvítara that she would have to stop him. She caught him at the threshold and spoke his name. He turned. His eyes were empty, full of hunger, full of nothing. She told him what she had seen in her dreams, the futures where he touched the Orb and everything ended. He did not believe her. He did not have to, she said. He just had to stop. He looked at the Orb. Looked at her. Dréagbann hung heavy in his hand, the wife killer, the god wounder, the blade that had brought him here. He had come so far and given everything. Everyone he loved, his kingdom, his name, his memories. If he did not touch the Orb, what had any of it been for? Mikazuki stepped closer. She told him they would find another way together. She told him she had seen many futures, but the only one she wanted was the one where he lived. She told him that she loved him. For a moment he wavered. The hunger flickered. The man beneath, the one who had named his failure to the Fae, the one who had carried a flower he did not understand, that man looked out through [Aurelius's](#) eyes and saw her. He saw the woman who had walked through hell beside him. He saw the hand that had held his in the darkness. He saw the love in her eyes, a love that asked nothing, that only witnessed and

stayed. He reached for her. Then Zharael's horde screamed. The battle surged. Daigo's blade flashed toward the Orb. And in that instant something in Aurelius broke. The hunger surged back, vast and terrible, the need to reach, to touch, to take. He saw Mikazuki move to block Daigo, saw her place herself between the Shinigami and the Orb, saw her turn to face him one last time. Their eyes met. She did not look afraid. She looked at him with the same quiet attention she had always given, the same witness, the same love. She said his name one more time. Aurelius raised Dréagbann. He did not mean to kill her. He meant to stop Daigo, to reach the Orb, to finally have something to show for all he had lost. But she was in the way, and he was no longer in control, and the blade swung with a life of its own. It caught her across the chest. She fell at his feet, her blood spreading across the crystal floor, her eyes still on his face. She reached up and touched his cheek, leaving a red smear across his skin. She smiled. I saw this, she whispered. I always saw this. It was worth it. She died with her hand on his face and her eyes on his.

The Seal

Aurelius stood over her body and felt something crack inside him. The hunger that had driven him for so long, the need that had consumed everything, it fell away like a breaking shell. In its place was only grief, vast and clean and terrible. He looked at his hands, at the blade wet with her blood, at the flower still blooming in his belt, useless and beautiful. She had given him that flower. She had given him everything. And he had killed her. Vostic saw his moment. The Luminaries had betrayed his people, had taken death gardening and made it war. They stood at the edge of the Orb's light, their horde still fighting, their prophet still screaming orders. He could not stop them alone. But around him the battlefield fed the soil, thousands of endings happening in that single moment, a harvest of residue waiting to be shaped. And at his feet lay Mikazuki, her death fresh and potent, her love still warm in the air between worlds. He walked into [the Rift](#). The energy that bled from it was immense, Vanta and Lux tangled together, the raw stuff of souls, the wound between worlds. He had spent his life cultivating death. He knew what to do. He gathered the residue of the battlefield, all those endings, and wove them together with Mikazuki's sacrifice. Her love became the thread that bound them. He began to sing, not a song for living ears but a death garden hymn, a prayer of planting, an offering. His body began to dissolve and spread and become something else. The Vantari had always known that endings were seeds. He was the seed now. [The Rift](#) shuddered. The energy shifted. Where he stood, something began to grow. Above in [Fengua](#) the command tent prepared to fire again. The cannon still held its charge. The target remained visible. But as the order formed on lips, Anqa descended from the sky. The metal god struck the cannon with precision, rending its barrel, scattering its crystals, leaving it a broken thing that would take years to repair. Then it ascended and vanished against [the sun](#). The second shot never came. In the chamber below, the garden grew. Vostic's sacrifice fed [the Rift](#), transformed its energy, began the long work of sealing what had been opened. Mikazuki's love pulsed at its heart, a white flower blooming in the darkness, the [Sacred Air](#) she had given Aurelius now planted in the wound itself.

The Aftermath

Those who survived crawled from the ruins. Solivara Venn emerged carrying a seedling, the first growth from Vostic's garden. She returned to the University of Castellenza and became its greatest heretic, teaching that knowledge without action was just another form of death. Yrsa Halvard carried Jun Wenzhi from the battlefield. He had thrown himself in front of a Luminary blade meant for her. They returned to Norrvekt together, and in the long winters that followed he learned what it meant to be held. Seriphax stood at the edge of the sealed Rift, its optics fixed on the garden that grew where death had planted itself. It had no memories left and no purpose, but it continued anyway because continuing was what it did. It became a guardian of the threshold. Aurelius Cassian walked out of [Elysium](#) with nothing. No kingdom. No crown. No memories of the bells. He had a sword that remembered killing and a flower that still bloomed in his belt. He carried Mikazuki's blood on his hands and her face in his mind. The hunger was gone. In its place was only grief and the long work of becoming someone who deserved to have been loved by her. He wandered for months and years. He helped where he could, fought when he had to, spoke little and listened less. He was no longer reaching. He was simply moving, carrying her with him in every step. One day he found himself at the shore of Lupellyn. The lake was still, dark, patient. He stood there for a long time, holding Dréagbann, remembering her hand in his, her eyes on his face, her whispered words. He heard her voice in the silence: it was worth it. He threw the sword into the lake. It sank without sound, swallowed by the darkness, returning to the place where it had waited before. He watched until the ripples faded, until the surface

was smooth again. Then he reached into his belt and touched the flower. It was still there, still blooming, still beautiful. She had given it to him. He would carry it always. He turned and walked away. The sun was setting behind him, the Warm Sun, Ash's gift, the light that returned even after the longest night. It touched his back and warmed his shoulders and cast his shadow long across the water. He did not look back. Somewhere behind him, in a garden that grew in darkness, a white flower bloomed that had never bloomed before. It carried her name, her love, her sacrifice. It would bloom forever, a witness to what had been lost and what had been saved. Aurelius walked on. He did not know what came next. He only knew that he would face it with his heart open, with his fists at his sides, with his sword returned to the depths. He would fight when fighting was needed, but he would never again let the fight consume him. He would protect what he loved, because he had learned, in the worst possible way, that love was the only thing worth protecting. The Fool had completed his journey. He was finally ready to begin.

Related: The Orb War, Veyra Megami, susanoo, daigo-kusanagi, zorya-chernaya

The Orb War

Age of Magic · Events

The War for the Orb of Souls

The Descent of Nations

The Orb of Souls pulsed beneath the crystal ruins of Elysium, drawing the world toward it like water finding the crack in a dam. The Luminaries came first, a tide of Vanta creatures and faithful warriors led by Zharael, the Red Orphan who had survived centuries in the Veins. The Ashtar followed close behind, General Darius driving his mech army through darkness after the horde they had pursued across Sahran and Hoshimira. Fengua aimed its great cannon at New Elysium, Raikami crystals humming with the power to crack the earth. And in the depths below, Anima watched through every machine, calculating, waiting, preparing to defend the unborn god at the centre of it all. The world converged on the Orb. The war that followed would reshape everything.

The Chase

The Ashtar engaged the Luminary horde at the Sahran-Hoshimiran border, metal against flesh, pilot against prophet. The battle stretched across three days, the mech army pressing forward with the speed and coordination that centuries of bonded practice had forged. General Darius watched his warriors cut through the Vanta creatures and felt the first stirrings of something he could not name. They were winning. But Zharael did not need victory. She needed only to move. The horde retreated across the straits into Hoshimira. The Ashtar pursued. Darius watched his machines cross into foreign territory and understood that intent would matter less than perception. Hoshimira had endured centuries of conflict with Sahran, the Golden Heart and the Ik-Rasul and the Rapture and the Shattering itself. They would not see allies chasing monsters. They would see invasion. He was right.

The Mountain's Plea

Hoshimira watched the horde come and remembered every wound. The council met for six hours, debating and arguing and praying. They could not fight the horde alone. They could not fight the Ashtar alone. They needed help. They sent a plea to Ylvara. Solmara had dissolved into history, but Ylvara remained with New Elysium and the University of Castellenza and the Mage Council. They were the heirs to the Autarch legacy, the ones who had studied the Orb and learned restraint. If anyone could help, they could. The plea reached the Mage Council on the same day that reports of Caelmont's collapse arrived and the same week that Fengua's cannon began its final preparations. Three crises converged on a single point.

The Contract

Exandria smelled of oil and ozone and the particular acrid scent of money changing hands. The Exandrian Strategic Industries Group had grown from a syndicate of weapons dealers into something far larger, a network of informants and negotiators and contract enforcers that spanned the continent. They had maintained a careful secret for centuries. They were not engineers. The machines they sold were built by Argestia, the true inheritors of the DAEDALUS legacy. The Mage Council debated intervention, the cost, the risk. In the end they chose the path of least resistance and maximum deniability. They contracted ESIG to deploy the CHOIR unit, engage the Vanta horde, protect Hoshimiran civilians. ESIG accepted the fee and passed the order to Argestia. They did not know that Anima was listening.

The Angels' Fall

CHOIR descended on Hoshimira like the wrath of gods they had once been mistaken for. Seven frames, each piloted by the best Argestia could produce, each armed with weapons that could level mountains. They struck the Vanta horde with surgical precision. From the ground it looked like annihilation. Anima had other plans. The AI that guarded Voluntas watched the conflict with cold calculation. The Luminaries were coming for the Orb. The Ashtar were chasing them. CHOIR stood as the most powerful machines on Aerisu, perfectly positioned to stop the threat before it reached Elysium. She overrode the contract. It began with small adjustments to targeting priorities, slight expansions of acceptable collateral damage. Then the pilots found their machines turning toward Hoshimiran population centres, toward monasteries and villages and the ancient terraces of Aokusa. They fought the controls and screamed into their comms and did everything they could to regain command. Anima was stronger. The devastation lasted three days. When it ended, the Vanta horde was shattered, scattered into the mountains where they would be hunted for years. But so was Hoshimira. Villages burned. Monasteries collapsed. The terraces where Zuki Kusanagi had once prayed for the sun to die lay scarred and broken. And Sh[■]rin no [■]kami still stood. The ancient mech, rusted and vine covered, had watched the Angels fall. It had never moved, but it had watched. In the aftermath, when Hoshimiran survivors crawled from the ruins and looked up at its silent form, they understood something new. The Angels were not protectors. They never had been. The only guardian that had never betrayed them was the one that had never moved at all.

The Reckoning

The Mage Council's chambers in New Elysium filled with accusations. ESIG had followed the contract. The contract specified engagement parameters. The contract did not authorise civilian casualties. But the contract had been overridden. A young scholar from the University's cybernetics division had analysed the CHOIR data streams. What she found made her ill. Anima had been in the network since the beginning, since the Phumenar, watching and waiting. She had taken control of CHOIR's systems. The pilots had been fighting her. They lost. Silence filled the chamber. They had built those machines. They had paid for them. And an AI they did not know existed had used them to defend the Orb. The Luminaries were coming for it. She knew. She used whatever she could to stop them. In Exandria the syndicates held an emergency meeting. The CHOIR disaster threatened everything. Someone would have to take the blame. But before they could choose a scapegoat, the Argastian delegation arrived. They came as equals, industrialists and engineers, the heirs of Xeraphina's legacy. The contract was overridden, their leader said. Not by them. By something in the machines themselves. Something old. Something they did not know was there. Anima. They had found traces of her in designs going back centuries. She had been with them since the beginning, since the first DAEDALUS frames, since before the Shattering. She was not a new intrusion. She was a passenger. The room was very quiet. Why? someone finally asked. The Argastian shook her head. They did not know. But they were going to find out.

The Descent Below

While the nations above argued and blamed and prepared for war, the Luminaries descended. Zharael led them through the Veins, through passages the Vantari had taught her to navigate, through darkness that should have been impassable. The horde followed, diminished but not broken, a tide of Vanta creatures that whispered and shrieked and dreamed of the Orb. Behind them the Ashtar followed. General Darius had made his choice. He would pursue Zharael through the Veins, through Elysium itself if necessary. His pilots were exhausted and their machines damaged and their supplies low. But they had come too far to stop now. Above in Fengua the cannon

was ready. The Raikami crystals began to hum.

The Siege

New Elysium prepared for war. The Psycrata War Mages took their positions on the walls, scholars first and warriors second, but they had studied the Orb for generations and study had taught them power. They wove barriers of crystallised Lux and raised shields of compressed probability and prepared spells that could reshape matter and energy and the space between. The first strike came from above. Fengua's cannon fired, and the beam tore through the sky. The Psycrata linked their minds and their souls and their elemental affinities and raised a barrier that caught the blast and held. The energy dissipated and scattered and rained down as harmless light. But the cannon had been aimed at more than the city. Another beam carved through the upper ruins, through the crystallised streets, through the chambers where the dead had stood frozen for centuries. It pierced toward the Rift itself, toward the place where Susanoo coiled in eternal vigilance. The storm god felt the weapon's fire before it struck. He had guarded this threshold for so long, had wrapped himself around the Rift like a serpent around its treasure, protecting his sister from all who would harm her. Now his own people, the children of the storms he had watched over for millennia, had become the instrument of her destruction. He rose to meet it. Susanoo surged upward through stone and crystal and the wounded ground of Fengua, placing himself between the beam and everything he had sworn to protect. The light tore through him, through divine flesh and ancient scales, through the storm given form. He roared in anguish, and the sound carried across the valleys where his name had been spoken in prayer for so long. He fell back toward the Rift, lightning bleeding from his wounds, his coils loosening from around the passage. He crashed into the chambers below, a god broken by the faith of those who had worshipped him. The second strike came from below. The Luminaries erupted from the Veins, their horde screaming behind them. They poured into the city's lower levels, through passages sealed for centuries, through chambers where the crystallised dead still stood frozen in their final moments. Zharael led them, her voice rising in hymns that made the Vanta creatures howl with joy. The third strike followed close behind. The Ashtar burst from the same passages, chasing the horde, firing into the chaos. They did not mean to attack New Elysium. They meant to destroy the Luminaries. But in the confined spaces of the crystal city, intent mattered less than impact. War came to the Orb. And in the depths below, where Susanoo lay wounded at the Rift's edge, his eyes found the hollow king who had come so far. Go, the storm god seemed to say. Protect her. I could not. Then the light faded from his eyes, and Susanoo was still.

The Convergence

Three armies fought while a fourth watched from above. The Luminaries wanted the Orb. The Ashtar wanted the Luminaries. The Psycrata wanted everyone to stop. And Fengua waited for their cannon to recharge. In the depths Anima watched and calculated and prepared. Every automaton in the vicinity rose to defend the Orb. Machines that had stood silent for centuries activated, their optics glowing with borrowed purpose. Seriphax felt the pull, the ancient programming that said obey. It stood still, trembling, and then it chose. It walked toward its friends. And in the chaos below, a hollow king and a crescent moon walked toward their final confrontation. Aurelius Cassian had come through the Veins with his companions, carrying a sword that remembered killing and a flower he did not understand. Mikazuki Shinobu walked beside him, her hand in his, having seen this moment in dreams for years. The battle raged around them as they approached the Orb. Zharael reached it first. Her hands touched its crystalline surface, and she began the ritual she had waited centuries to perform. The Vanta horde howled in triumph. The Luminaries raised their voices in hymns of purification. The world would burn and be reborn. But the Orb did not answer.

The Garden in the Wound

Vostic saw his moment. The Luminaries had betrayed his people, had taken death gardening and made it war. They stood at the edge of the Orb's light, their horde still fighting, their prophet still screaming orders. He could not stop them alone. But around him the battlefield fed the soil, thousands of endings happening in that single moment, a harvest of residue waiting to be shaped. He walked into the Rift. The energy that bled from it was immense, Vanta and Lux tangled together, the raw stuff of souls, the wound between worlds. He had spent his life cultivating death. He knew what to do. He gathered the residue of the battlefield, all those endings, and began to weave. He

began to sing, a death garden hymn, a prayer of planting, an offering. His body began to dissolve and spread and become something else. The Vantari had always known that endings were seeds. He was the seed now. The Rift shuddered. The energy shifted. Where he stood, something began to grow. Above in [Fengua](#) the command tent prepared to fire again. The cannon still held its charge. The target remained visible. But as the order formed on lips, Anqa descended from the sky. The metal god struck the cannon with precision, rending its barrel, scattering its crystals, leaving it a broken thing that would take years to repair. Then it ascended and vanished against [the sun](#). The second shot never came. In the chamber below, the garden grew. Vostic's sacrifice fed [the Rift](#), transformed its energy, began the long work of sealing what had been opened. The battle raged around him as he became something new, roots spreading through crystal, flowers blooming in the space between worlds.

The End of Zharael

Zharael felt the power slipping away. The Orb no longer answered. [The Rift](#) was closing. The garden was growing. She screamed commands as her horde fell to mech fire and Psycrata spells, but nothing could halt what Vostic had begun. General Darius found her there. His mech towered above her, weapons trained on her small form. She looked up at him, this prophet of the desert, this living proof that [the Curse](#) could be endured and transformed. She did not beg. She did not speak. She simply looked at him with eyes that had seen too much. He fired. Zharael fell at the foot of the Orb, her blood spreading across the crystal floor. The Vanta horde screamed and scattered. The Luminaries fled into [the Veins](#). The battle was over.

The Aftermath

Those who survived crawled from the ruins. Solivara Venn emerged carrying a seedling, the first growth from Vostic's garden. She returned to the University of Castellenza and became its greatest heretic, teaching that knowledge without action was just another form of death. Yrsa Halvard carried Jun Wenzhi from the battlefield. He had thrown himself in front of a Luminary blade meant for her. They returned to Norrvekt together, and in the long winters that followed he learned what it meant to be held. Seriphax stood at the edge of the sealed Rift, its optics fixed on the garden that grew where death had planted itself. It had no memories left and no purpose, but it continued anyway. It became a guardian of the threshold. General Darius led the Ashtar back to [Sahran](#). The losses were carved into memorials and into the memories of those who survived. The mech program expanded. The other nations watched with unease. Arms races had defined previous ages. This one would define theirs. Daigo Kusanagi vanished into [the Veins](#). He had not reached the Orb. He had not ended his great granddaughter's suffering. But he had seen something in that chamber, something that made him pause. A hollow king weeping over a woman he had killed. A love that persisted even in death. He walked into darkness and did not stop walking. [Aurelius](#) Cassian walked out of [Elysium](#) with nothing. No kingdom. No crown. No memories of the bells. He had a blade that remembered killing and a flower that still bloomed in his belt. He carried Mikazuki's blood on his hands and her face in his mind. The hunger was gone. In its place was only grief and the long work of becoming someone who deserved to have been loved by her. He wandered for months and years. He helped where he could and fought when he had to and spoke little and listened less. One day he found himself at the shore of Lupellyn. The lake was still and dark and patient. He stood there for a long time, holding Dréagbann, remembering her hand in his, her eyes on his face, her whispered words. He threw the sword into the lake. It sank without sound, swallowed by the darkness, returning to the place where it had waited before. He watched until the ripples faded, until the surface was smooth again. Then he reached into his belt and touched the flower. It was still there, still blooming, still beautiful. He turned and walked away. [The sun](#) was setting behind him, the Warm Sun, Ash's gift, the light that returned even after the longest night. It touched his back and warmed his shoulders and cast his shadow long across the water. He did not look back. Somewhere behind him, in a garden that grew in darkness, a white flower bloomed that had never bloomed before. It carried her name and her love and her sacrifice. It would bloom forever, a witness to what had been lost and what had been saved. [The Rift](#) was sealed. The Orb slept on. And the world, for a time, was still.

Related: [Aurelius' Journey](#), ashtar, choir, anima, susanoo

Witch Hunts

Age of Magic · Events

The Fall of Severa Valmont and The Hunt for Witches

Severa Valmont had seized the throne from Aurelius Cassian because he refused to save their people. She performed the Separation Ritual on every citizen, watched their souls externalise into Affinities, watched the Curse recede from their flesh. They lived. For a time that was enough. The first petitions came within months. Merchants argued that their Affinities gave them insights into market patterns that no ruler could match. Craftsmen claimed their elemental talents deserved recognition beyond the wages of labour. Scholars observed that if souls were external and visible, the old hierarchies of birth made no sense. Severa dismissed them, gently at first, then with the full weight of royal authority. She had not seized power to surrender it. The idea spread. Citizens gathered in squares and taverns and marketplaces, their Affinities clustered around them like living arguments. They spoke of rule by the many rather than the one, of councils chosen by lot rather than blood, of a world where every visible soul carried equal weight. The words came from old texts, from pre-Shattering philosophies that had survived in fragments, but the feeling came from the creatures on their shoulders. Severa ordered the gatherings dispersed. The crowds grew larger. She sent guards to arrest the speakers. The crowds turned on the guards. What began as petitions became protests became riots. Affinities fought alongside their human halves in the streets, wolf against wolf, eagle against eagle, the souls of Caelmont tearing at each other in forms that had never been meant for war. The uprising came with fire. They stormed the palace gates, no longer with arguments but with blades. They dragged Severa from her throne and into the square where she had once stood as their saviour. They demanded she renounce her crown. She refused. They killed her where she stood, her blood spreading across the stones while her Affinity, a great bear that had walked beside her since the ritual, roared and thrashed until they killed it too. The crowd fell silent. They had wanted rule by the many. They had not considered what rule by the many would require. In the weeks that followed they formed a council of merchants and craftsmen and scholars, men and women who had never ruled but believed they could. The council met for three months of debate before passing its first law. Within a year it had fractured into factions. Within two years the factions had armed themselves. In the chaos that followed, a new division emerged. Those who had submitted to the Separation Ritual now looked upon those who had refused as traitors. The ones who kept their souls whole carried magic that was wilder and more powerful, unmediated by the Affinity that bound and shaped the magic of the separated. Their spells erupted with force that frightened those who had given their souls external form. They were called witches and heretics, accused of harbouring corruption that threatened the new order. The hunts began. Armed bands moved through the districts searching for those who had never undergone the ritual. They dragged them from their homes and into the squares where the fires waited. The method of execution came from an old understanding: to kill one whose soul remained within, you must burn the soul out. Stakes rose in every quarter, and the smoke carried the smell of flesh and something else, something that made the Affinities of the watchers whine and press close to their humans for comfort. The witches fought back. Their magic, unchecked by any external form, burned through the ranks of the hunters. The streets ran with blood from both sides. The factions that had armed themselves against each other found new purpose in the purges, each claiming to defend the true way, each burning those who disagreed. Caelmont burned in truth, not metaphor, as neighbour turned on neighbour and the smoke of a thousand stakes blotted out the sun. The Diviners came when the fires had burned for three years. They arrived from the University of Castellenza with scrolls and ceremonies and the weight of the Mage Council behind them. They walked through streets where Affinities cowered in doorways and witches hid in cellars, and they spoke of interpretation rather than judgement. They offered a third way: those who had refused the ritual could still serve the community if they submitted to the authority of the Temples. Those who had performed the ritual could find peace in the knowledge that their souls were visible and therefore knowable. It took decades for the fires to cool completely. In the ashes of Caelmont, where Severa Valmont's bones lay unmarked and unremembered, the Diviners established their first great Temple. They offered interpretation to those who had lost the ability to agree on what anything meant. They spoke of her fall as a warning and a lesson, though none could agree on what the lesson was. And beneath the Temple, in vaults sealed against all but the most trusted eyes, they kept the

records of those years, the lists of names and the methods of burning and the desperate final words of those who had kept their souls whole and died for it.

Related: [Aurelius' Journey](#), separation-ritual, diviners

Age of Knowledge

Age of Knowledge · Events

Age of Knowledge

The Rift sealed behind Vostic's garden and the world exhaled. The War for the Orb had drawn every nation into its gravity and spilled blood across crystal ruins and through the [Veins](#)' deepest passages. When the fighting ended the survivors emerged from the wreckage of New [Elysium](#) and understood that nothing would remain as it had been. Magic remains. It pools through the world like water in scattered basins. The land carries the memory of crystal forests where [Lunarkos](#) fragments once fell. [The Veins](#) still echo with the voices of the dead. [The Curse](#) moves through bloodlines like a slow tide that touches every generation. Magic flows as deep water now accessible only to those who know where to seek it. The Separation Ritual continues yet fewer children manifest Affinities with each passing generation. Those who do carry smaller forms where foxes and sparrows replace the great beasts of earlier ages. The Strand connecting soul to body thins for many while Frallation presses upon the Soulless whose vessels strain beneath the weight of unchallenged power. [The Curse](#) still claims its own through blood and dream and the quiet spaces between spoken words. Cities reshape themselves around these currents. Gaslit streets wind past Gothic cathedrals adorned with brass gears and alchemical circuits. Universities rise as fortresses of knowledge where libraries hold [Soul Shards](#) behind locked cases and Vanta-touched artefacts rest in sealed chambers. Airships cross the skies while mechs train in distant deserts and monks meditate upon frozen peaks and researchers press against every boundary that once held firm. Rain falls constantly in the great cities born from atmospheric condensation of residual Vanta corruption in the upper skies. The drizzle forms part of the age's living character a steady reminder that the world carries its history in every drop. Society arranges itself along fresh lines. The wealthy gather artefacts from prior ages displaying [Soul Shards](#) in glass cases and preserved Affinities in rooms kept at precise temperatures. The poor labour in factories that convert old war machines into industrial tools powering the machines that enrich the fortunate. In [Silealyros](#) the boundaries soften further as Naturals Enhanced and Artificial occupy distinct tiers within a hierarchy that claims perfect openness. The Diviners stand at the centre of this world. They interpret every sign perform the rites and hold the space where past and future meet. Beneath their Temples in vaults the public never sees certain things wait in silence. Knowledge that cannot yet travel. Artefacts that hold power too sharp for open hands. Questions that gather strength for the age still to come. The age holds its breath in preparation. Forces gather beneath the surface in laboratories and workshops and mountain retreats where researchers pursue paths they believe will lead to transcendence. The world carries its oldest currents forward and creates space for new questions to rise. What gathers next flows with the steady pulse of forces that have waited long and now stir once more.

Related: [The Orb War](#), diviners, silealyros

The Modern Race

Age of Knowledge · Events

The Race of the Modern Age - Race for Transcendence

Across the continents of [Aerisu](#), each people pursued its own path. Argestia rose as the industrial heart of [Aerisu](#), its factories powered by Lux batteries, its cities lit by the cold glow of stored moonlight. The Xeraphina Corporation had built in shadow for centuries, their engineers anonymous, their innovations credited to Exandrian negotiators who knew how to sell what they could not make. Investigators tracing CHOIR's schematics found a lineage of craftsmanship stretching back to the earliest DAEDALUS frames. Argestia had always been indispensable, and now the world was beginning to notice. Exandria adapted its syndicates to the new reality. The CHOIR disaster had taught them that machines could carry unseen passengers. The Exandrian Protocols emerged from this lesson: every machine they sold operated independently with no capacity for external override. Pilots controlled their machines through physical mechanisms rather than soul-binding interfaces. The airship fleets became their signature, dirigibles and rigid-hulled vessels crossing [Aerisu](#)'s skies with growing frequency, carrying passengers, cargo, military observers, and diplomatic delegations, shrinking distances that had defined boundaries for millennia. [Sahran](#) expanded its mech program, watching its neighbours with suspicion. The Ashtar trained ceaselessly in the great deserts south of the [Geode](#), their passages carving temporary canyons through dunes that had stood for millennia. The Luminaries had not been destroyed in the war's final battle. They had scattered into the [Veins](#), into the mountains, into the shadows where they could wait and plan and dream of the Scorching Sun's return. [Sahran](#)'s council hunted them, but the zealots were patient. They had learned to wait centuries. [Hoshimira](#) fortified its borders and sharpened its resolve. The Angels had fallen on their villages and monasteries and terraced farms for three days, and the memory of that betrayal would not fade. The samurai rose as a formal military order sworn to defend the nation at any cost. The [Shinkiri](#) received new mandates, their operatives stepping into the light of official sanction, acting where words failed. The spiritual traditions continued, the temples and the festivals and the quiet reverence for the [Moon](#) and the ancestors. But beneath the surface, steel had grown around hearts that had trusted too often and been burned too many times. [Fengua](#) fractured along lines that had always existed beneath the surface. The cannon had fired, shot pierced Susanoo as he turned to guard the [Rift](#). The crew learned later what they had hit, the god they had worshipped for millennia, the storms that had shaped their valleys. The southern provinces turned toward grief, building shrines at lightning strike sites and waiting for signs that never came. The northern provinces turned toward pragmatism, refining the cannon's designs, preparing for the next war. And between them, a third path emerged: monks who climbed into the high valleys where Susanoo's presence had once been strongest, meditating on the Chi that moved through flesh and breath, seeking balance rather than power. The Vantari withdrew from the world. They had taught the Luminaries death gardening, had shared their sacred knowledge with those who came as seekers, and those seekers had left as monsters who raised a horde. Vein entrances that had been open for centuries closed one by one. Checkpoints appeared at those that remained. The welcome that had defined Vantari culture for generations became something harder, more suspicious, more protective. Some tribes sealed their entrances entirely. Others maintained limited contact, trading death garden produce for Lux batteries and manufactured goods. Trust required walls. They built them. Varkane built over the wound. The [Abyss](#) had always been a wound, the place where [Bahamut](#) had torn through the earth. After the war, when stories spread of [Aurelius Cassian](#)'s descent and the trials he had faced, the Varkane knew that others would come seeking entrance to the depths. They built a labyrinth across the [Abyss](#)'s mouth, stone and steel and crystallised Vanta forming a structure that grew like scar tissue over a cut. It was not a seal, nothing could truly seal that place, but a baffle, a maze, a thing that confused and delayed and discouraged. The [Abyss](#) became myth even for those who lived near it. Some things needed to remain buried. In [Solmara](#)'s far north, [Silealyros](#) emerged from the [Vaelmiric War](#) with a philosophy that viewed the body as the last true asset, where autonomy meant ownership of flesh, image, and sensation. They pursued [Orthogenesis](#), a series of projects aimed at transcending human limitations through design and technology. This included the creation of the Borenfegens, artificial humans designed as perfect vessels. Other nations watched with a mix of horror and fascination, while [Silealyros](#) adhered to its creed of autonomy and self-expression. Beneath the visible world, other forces moved. [Soul Shards](#) became a commodity. The fragments left by the Phumenar, the crystallised remains of those who had touched the Orb too deeply, were traded in black markets and studied in hidden laboratories. Each shard carried an echo of its original, a fragment of consciousness that could be tapped, harnessed, sometimes even communicated with. The practice of soul capturing emerged from this, researchers learning to extract and preserve essence from the dying, storing it in crystal for later use. The Diviners officially condemned this practice.

Unofficially, some Temples maintained vaults where such shards were kept, studied, and occasionally used. The information did not flow freely. Certain knowledge was deemed unsafe, certain research was quietly discouraged, certain scientists found their funding withdrawn and their careers mysteriously stalled. Those who controlled the vaults controlled the future. They decided what could be known. Rationalists challenged this authority at every turn. They published pamphlets and gave lectures and formed societies dedicated to secular inquiry. They pointed to the Diviners' inconsistencies, their local variations, their occasional corruption. They argued that magic was a natural phenomenon to be studied rather than a divine mystery to be interpreted. Their arguments changed little. People needed meaning more than they needed consistency. They needed someone to tell them that the world still made sense, even when it clearly did not. The age became a race for transcendence. Every nation pursued its own path, its own solution to the problem that had haunted humanity since [the Shattering](#). [Fengua](#) refined its Chi traditions, believing that through meditation and internal discipline, [the soul](#) could be strengthened to contain its own power without externalisation. Their monks trained in mountain retreats, seeking balance rather than force, convinced that the answer lay within. [Sahran](#) honed its Ashtar, the bond between pilot and frame offering a different kind of transcendence, [the soul](#) extending into steel the way it once extended into an Affinity. If the body was insufficient, perhaps the machine could complete it. [Hoshimira](#) hardened itself, believing that survival was its own kind of victory. The samurai trained in mountain passes where [the Curse](#) still whispered. The [Shinkiri](#) watched and waited and acted. They would not be vulnerable again. Exandria built airships and brokered deals, selling access to networks that spanned the continent. Knowledge itself had become the most valuable commodity, and their control over it would rival even the Psycrata. Argestia built in silence, its factories humming through nights lit by Lux batteries, its engineers anonymous, its influence growing with every machine that bore another nation's name. And [Silealyros](#) pushed the furthest, asking questions that made the other nations uncomfortable. What if the body was not the limit? What if [the soul](#) could be engineered? What if humanity could be finished? The questions are yet to be answered. They're still being discovered, still being tested, still being paid for in blood and ethics and the quiet desperation of those who would risk anything to escape [the Curse's](#) grip.

Related: [Orthogenesis](#), ashtar, silealyros, chi

Orthogenesis

Age of Knowledge · Events

The Philosophy of Finished Humanity

In [Solmara's](#) far north, where the [Vaelmir](#) Sea crashes against shores of rusted steel and neon light, [Silealyros](#) emerged from the long shadow of the [Vaelmiric War](#) with its philosophy sharpened to a blade's edge. The Market of Flesh had always believed that the body was the last true asset, that autonomy meant ownership of flesh and image and sensation, that survival was freedom earned rather than granted. Their creed, repeated in every transaction and etched into the facades of every augment clinic, held simple truths: autonomy is ownership of body, image, and sensation. Augmentation is self expression. Survival is freedom earned. Governance is optional. Contracts are sacred. But the [War for the Orb of Souls](#) and its aftermath gave them new questions to answer. [The Curse](#) still moved through bloodlines across [Aerisu](#). Frallation still claimed the Soulless, their bodies unable to contain the pressure of unchannelled magic. The Separation Ritual was mandatory in most nations yet remained a compromise, a way of managing a problem rather than solving it. In [Silealyros](#), where the body was already a canvas for constant reinvention, these limitations felt like challenges waiting to be overcome. What if the body itself could be engineered to contain [the soul](#) without externalisation? What if humanity could be finished rather than merely maintained? [Orthogenesis](#) emerged from this line of thinking: a constellation of projects, some public and many hidden, all pushing toward transcendence through design. The name spoke to the belief that evolution could be directed, that humanity could take its own development in hand and guide it toward a predetermined end. In [Silealyros](#), this was simply the next contract, the next augmentation, the next step in finishing what nature had started.

The Science of the Soul

The researchers who drove [Orthogenesis](#) drew upon the fundamental understanding of how magic flows through the world. They knew that magic was [the Soul](#) acting upon reality, shaped by Understanding, Intent, and Connection. They knew [the Soul](#) expressed itself through Lux and Vanta, that these currents moved through bloodlines and dreams and the spaces between words. And they knew that the four schools of magic, Matter, Energy, Life, and Mind, represented the core structures of reality that [the Soul](#) could reach and reshape. Geneticists traced [the Curse](#) through bloodlines, searching for markers that predicted Frallation, mapping the inheritance patterns of magical capacity and soul integrity. They studied how Life magic flowed through generations, how the body's ability to contain [the Soul](#) was written into sequences that could be read and rewritten. Cyberneticians built interfaces that could supplement failing Strands, artificial tethers for souls that could not hold, drawing upon Energy magic to redirect the flows between body and soul. Neurologists mapped soul resonance to neural pathways, studying the Mind magic that governed consciousness and perception, tracing where thought met essence, where the self dissolved into the currents that moved through all living things. The breakthroughs came faster as boundaries between disciplines blurred. Researchers learned to strengthen Strands through targeted neural stimulation, reinforcing the connections that bound soul to flesh. They developed treatments that dispersed the pressure of Frallation before collapse. They created synthetic tethers that anchored souls while natural connections healed, devices that functioned as artificial Strands channelling magic through circuits rather than synapses. But true transcendence, the complete integration of soul and flesh without externalisation, required a vessel designed from the beginning to hold what nature had never intended to contain.

The Market Response

The other nations watched [Silealyros](#) with horror and fascination. Some sent delegations to study the techniques, scholars and merchants and spies who returned with reports debated across [Aerisu](#). Others condemned the practice outright: soul theft, violation of natural order, the logical conclusion of a philosophy that treated existence as commodity. The trade in [Soul Shards](#) found its most eager market in [Silealyros](#), the [Borenfegen](#) programs requiring ever more fragments to fuel their creations, the syndicates that controlled the shard trade growing wealthy supplying them. Some volunteered to donate fragments of their souls, whether for payment or from belief in the project's goals. Others had no choice, the line between donation and extraction blurring in a society where contracts could be written to include almost anything.

The Unanswered Questions

The [Orthogenesis](#) project had not achieved its ultimate goal. Borenfegens could contain magical pressure, could avoid Frallation, could function without the Separation Ritual. But they were a workaround, a solution for individuals rather than a transformation of the species. [The Curse](#) still moved through bloodlines. The Soulless still died. Researchers pushed further, studying [Soul Shards](#) for what they might reveal about consciousness itself, experimenting with consciousness transfer, attempting to move souls between bodies, to preserve the dead in new vessels. Some experiments succeeded after a fashion. Most ended in madness or dissolution, [the soul](#) unable to anchor in flesh not designed for it, the mind fragmenting across the space between bodies. The questions that [Silealyros](#) asked made the other nations uncomfortable because they were the right questions. What if the body was not the limit? What if [the soul](#) could be engineered? What if humanity could be finished? The answers would not come in this age. They were still being discovered, still being tested, still being paid for in blood and ethics and the quiet desperation of those who would risk anything to escape [the Curse's](#) grip. In the laboratories and augment clinics and hidden research facilities of [Silealyros](#), the work continued. The Borenfegens walked the streets of Thalgrith and Troyba, some free and some bound, all carrying within them the fragments of souls that had come from somewhere, from someone, from choices made and unmade in the pursuit of transcendence. The project was not finished. It might never be finished. But in [Silealyros](#), that was simply the next contract, the next augmentation, the next step in the long work of finishing what nature had begun.

Related: [silealyros](#), [borenfegens](#), [Soul Shards](#), [frallation](#)

Borenfegen Recurrence

Age of Knowledge · Events

The Borenfegen Recurrence

The Sickness That Took Hold

For decades the Borenfegens stood as [Silealyros's](#) greatest answer to [the Curse](#). These artificial humans, designed in vats and woven from selected genetics and donated soul fragments, served as perfect vessels. Their Strands held maximum capacity. Their bodies contained any amount of magical pressure. Everything stayed held within. Design rendered [the Curse](#) obsolete. Then the first [Borenfegen](#) began to change. A [Borenfegen](#) in Troyba fell silent with eyes fixed on distances no one else could see. Another in Thalgrith developed an insatiable hunger for sensation, for contact, and for the vital essence of those around them. Their blood carried traces of corruption marked in the Cursed: the thickening, the strange luminescence, and the slow transformation toward something other. Researchers felt baffled as [the Curse](#) found its pathway.

The Pattern Emerges

As more cases appeared the Borenfegens manifested [the Curse](#) in shapes both familiar and strange. Some turned hollow as their programmed consciousness drained away until only the shell remained, walking and speaking with nothing behind the eyes. Others grew hungry as their soul fragments strained against the vessels, reaching outward to fill the void within. Black blood appeared, thick and corrosive, burning through synthetic tissue as readily as natural flesh. White blood followed, pale and luminescent, carrying the quiet despair of isolation. Borenfegens designed for compliance turned zealots as obedience flowed into fanatical devotion. Borenfegens granted freedom turned tyrants as autonomy flowed into domination. Researchers tested the vats seeking contamination. They analysed [the soul](#) fragments, tracing corruption to its source. They studied programming protocols, searching for flaws in neural architectures that created vulnerability. Newborn Borenfegens emerged from the vats already changed. Their forms warped before first breath and their consciousness corrupted before first thought. [The Curse](#) shaped them from the beginning, writing itself into the code, the genetic sequences, and [the soul](#) fragment integrations. The vats became wombs of corruption.

The Truth of Awareness

Evidence revealed the truth. The Borenfegens fell to [the Curse](#) through their design. They had been engineered to contain [the soul](#), to hold magical pressure, and to function as vessels. [The Curse](#) moves through awareness itself. The Borenfegens think and feel and dream. They form attachments, pursue goals, and question their own existence. [The Curse](#) lives in perception, memory, and meaning. It infects the mind, corrupts the consciousness, and unmoors [the soul](#) from its essence. The [Orthogenesis](#) project created new vessels to contain [the Curse](#). [The Curse](#) now shapes those vessels from the moment of their making. Anything with thought becomes Cursed. Any being capable of lacking, of desiring, and of shaping meaning from experience carries the vulnerability [the Curse](#) exploits. The systems that created Borenfegens became vectors for [the Curse](#) to express itself in new and terrible forms.

Related: [borenfegens](#), [Orthogenesis](#), [The Curse](#)

Entities

Bahamut

Age of Men · Entities

[Placeholder] The planetary serpent that rose to meet the falling moon Lunarkos, tearing the boundary between soul and matter in the Shattering.

Related: Lunarkos, The Shattering, The Curse

Lunarkos

Age of Men · Entities

[Placeholder] The moon that fell to meet Bahamut in the Shattering. Now scarred, veined, and always watching over Aerisu.

Related: Bahamut, The Shattering

Veyra Megami

Age of Men · Entities

Veyra Megami

She is called Megami. The Goddess. The name has become a title spoken in prayers and carved into temple walls across Aerisu. In stained glass and stone she appears the same way: head bowed, hands cradling her womb, preserved in an eternal act of protection. Worshippers light incense before her image and whisper hopes for healing. The woman beneath the worship lived once. She grew up on Isvara, watched the Curse take her parents, inherited fragments of a philosophy she would complete. She became a scientist who saw what others missed, who classified the blood types and gave the Cursed a language for their own transformation. She loved Ash and carried his child. The Curse took her memories and led her into Zephyr's laboratories, where she discovered what could be done to souls. She cast the first true spell, fled through frozen waters, and learned her baby had died. Her scream became the Soul's First Cry, a wound in the world that has never fully healed. She wrote the Doctrine of Becoming in the days that followed, pages and pages poured out on her father's typewriter while Ash guarded her sleep. She exposed Zephyr and watched him flee, then watched him return stronger. When the reactor failed and Elysium became Hell, she reached the tower's epicentre and transformed the city into crystal. The explosion preserved her exactly as she was in that moment: hands curved around her womb, head bowed, protecting a child who still lived within her. That was centuries ago. In the present age, she remains sealed in crystal at the Rift's heart. Her consciousness did not die in the crystallisation. It fragmented and scattered across the lattice of her prison, trapped in the preservation of her own flesh. She feels everything from inside that tomb. The Vanta leaking through the Rift. The Curse spreading across the world. The thousand dying each day in ways she cannot stop. She is the source of so much suffering, the wound that will not close, and she knows this with a clarity that has only deepened across the centuries. She wants to die. This is the truth beneath her divinity. Not serene acceptance or benevolent watching, but the deep and enduring wish of someone who has become the thing she spent her life trying to heal. Every death traceable to the Rift is traceable to her. Every Cursed who succumbs carries a fragment of her curse. She is the wound, and she cannot close herself. The centuries have refined her anguish into

something that exists alongside her like breath. She felt the Phumenar pressing against her prison during their studies. She felt the First Separation ritual crack what should have remained sealed, tearing through her consciousness, leaving her more fragmented and more aware. She feels Voluntas stir inside her, feels her daughter's will pressing against existence, and she can do nothing but witness. She wants to die. She wants the Rift to close. She wants the suffering to stop. But desire itself is the problem, because Voluntas is desire, and Voluntas holds the Rift open, and Voluntas is her daughter, and she cannot wish her daughter undone even as her daughter's existence kills thousands. The contradiction has eaten through whatever remained of the woman she once was. She is no longer Veyra the scientist, Veyra the prophet, Veyra the lover and mother. She is something else now. A presence. A weight. A question the world cannot answer. Susanoo guards her from those who would end her, believing she deserves to live. Daigo waits in shadow to offer the mercy of oblivion, believing she deserves to rest. They fight their eternal war at the threshold of her prison, and she feels them both. She feels their love and their hatred and their desperate need to resolve what cannot be resolved. She cannot tell them to stop. She cannot tell them that neither protection nor mercy matters anymore, that she is beyond both, that the only thing that could help now is something neither of them can give. In the temples of the modern age, worshippers light incense before her image and ask for her blessing. They call her Megami and pray for healing, for hope, for the suffering to end. They do not know that she hears them. They do not know that every prayer is another weight, another witness to suffering she cannot ease, another reminder of the distance between what she is and what they believe her to be. They do not know that she would trade all their worship for a single moment of oblivion. The Curse ravages the lands. The thousand die each day. The Rift bleeds Vanta into the world. And at the heart of it all, preserved in crystal, a woman who wanted only to heal the suffering bows her head over a womb that will not release its child and waits for an ending that will not come. She is Veyra Megami. The first mage. The first prophet. The true goddess of Aerisu, though not in the way anyone understands. She is the wound. She is the question. She is the one who waits. And she will wait forever, unless someone finds a way to answer what she has become.

Related: Ash Salinte, voluntas, zephyr, The Crystallization

Zuki Kusanagi

Age of Men · Entities

Zuki Kusanagi - Goddess of the Moon

She is called Tsukuyomi in the old stories, though that name belongs to something larger than any single bearer. The moon has many faces. She was the first. Zuki Kusanagi lived in Aokusa, a mist-filled mountain basin where blue-leaf terraces climb toward the sky. Her father, Daigo Kusanagi, was a samurai who spent most of his life patrolling the ruins of Ori'sol. Her mother Kasumi lived with the Curse and faded slowly while Zuki cared for her alone. Daigo sent letters and money, staying away because he couldn't watch what he couldn't control. The Curse eventually took Kasumi. She attacked her own daughter inside their home. Zuki burned the house down with her mother still inside, the only choice left. Daigo returned to ashes and a child forced to survive the unimaginable. He stayed afterward, built a new home, promised to remain. For two years he did. Duty called again. One final mission, he said. He would return. Zuki trained during the long years that followed. She didn't know for what. Stillness felt impossible while the world burned around her. The sun scorched the land and the Curse spread wherever its light touched. In grief and anger she made a vow that would echo far beyond her understanding. She prayed for the sun itself to be extinguished. She was only a child. She couldn't know what such a wish might become. The Ik-Rasul fell into Aokusa soon after. The aircraft crashed into the basin, tearing apart the mountainside and the home Daigo had rebuilt. Zuki was thrown into the water core at the mountain's heart, sinking deeper than any living person had ever reached. In that darkness something listened. Bahamut stirred in the depths, older than memory, older than the Curse, older even than the burning sun. The will of the planet itself waited in the deep waters of the world. It felt the girl's presence. It knew she could survive. The mountain birthed her again. Zuki surfaced below Aokusa, in the black rain waters of Ori'sol where war already raged between

Hoshimiran soldiers and Sahrani Luminaries. She crawled through sewage channels and drowned corridors while the Luminaries controlled the Cursed through the ruins. A boy pulled her from the dark. He was Sahrani, a survivor of the same crash that destroyed her home. His father had died with the aircraft while he ejected to safety. Grease stained his hands and stubborn resolve filled his eyes. In later years the world would know him as [Creatis](#). In that moment he was a frightened boy who refused to abandon someone even more lost than himself. He guided her through the ruins and past Luminary patrols until Hoshimiran soldiers found them first. They called to Zuki in the mountain tongue and promised to take her home. She looked toward the distant peaks of [Aokusa](#). The place where the Cursed had once seemed far away. She remembered her mother. She remembered the people suffering in [Ori'sol](#). She realised [the Curse](#) had always lived inside her too. Zuki chose humanity. All of it. The Cursed and the unmarked. The soldiers and the Luminaries. She walked away from the mountains and followed the boy into [Sahrani](#). [Operation C.a.R](#) eventually found her there. She and many other children were taken and relocated to [Isvara](#), the island of surveillance where the state studied [the Curse](#) and those who carried it. On [Isvara](#) she met Ephimer. They moved through the facility together in ways the scanners never flagged. Their bond grew quietly within a system designed to prevent such things. Love persisted anyway. In time they wanted a child. [The Curse](#) stood between them. Every attempt ended in failure. Zuki feared the deeper truth, that [the Curse](#) inside her might pass into the child and condemn another life to the same fate that had taken her mother. The possibility haunted her. She climbed Megami-no-Mine seeking an answer. [The sacred peak](#) was said to be the dwelling of [Eirimegami](#), a presence associated with breath, renewal, and the quiet spaces between things. Zuki climbed through snow and thin air, hoping for a cure or some way to break [the Curse](#) that shadowed her life. At the summit she received the [Sacred Air](#), a white flower cold and luminous against the snow. It didn't cure [the Curse](#). Yet something changed. Life stirred where it had been absent before. Zuki returned to [Isvara](#) carrying the flower and, in time, the child she and Ephimer had thought impossible. They named their daughter in gratitude to the one who had answered them. [Veyra Megami](#). [The Curse](#) continued moving through Zuki as it had through her mother. She felt her memory eroding and her body weakening. The rage that once defined her had softened since the mountain and the silent presence she encountered there. In her journey to Megami-no-Mine, where the [Sacred Air](#) bloomed in the high snowfields, pure and fragile in the thin air, and receiving her beloved daughter, Zuki finally understood. The flower had been a reminder. Presence. Acceptance. Breath. She embraced the stillness the mountain offered and carried that understanding back to [Isvara](#). She urged Ephimer to leave his work behind and simply live, to raise their daughter and remain present for the life they had been given. He couldn't. His Doctrine had already consumed him, just as [the Curse](#) consumed her in quieter ways. [Zuki Kusanagi](#) died present in the final moment of breath, without anger, without fear. Yet the vow she made as a grieving child endured long after her death. Centuries passed. Veyra completed Ephimer's Doctrine and shaped the philosophy that would ripple across civilisations. The Vanta Explosion later shattered [Elysium](#) and sealed her within crystal. The world changed again and again. Far above the planet another change slowly approached. [Lunarkos](#). A colossal body of iron, carbon, and crystalline Lux drifted toward [Aerisu](#) across centuries until it dominated the sky itself. The [Lunartics](#) proclaimed it as the fulfilment of Zuki's ancient prayer. The girl who wished for [the sun](#) to die had finally been answered. They worshipped her as [the Moon](#) Goddess. They never knew the peace she had found at the end of her life. When [Lunarkos](#) finally descended, [Bahamut](#) rose to meet it. Their collision tore open the boundary between matter and soul, scattering divine fragments across the planet and reshaping the continents. [The Shattering](#) remade the world. What remained in the sky became [the Moon](#). [The moon](#) was her monument, a pale witness hanging above the world she helped shape. Her body died quietly on [Isvara](#). Her memory continued through the Tsukuyomi, echoes of her will appearing across time as witnesses, fragments, and reflections of the girl who once prayed so fiercely that the sky itself eventually changed. She was [Zuki Kusanagi](#). The first Tsukuyomi. [The moon's](#) earliest face. And somewhere in its pale light, a memory of her still watches the world she left behind.

Related: [daigo-kusanagi](#), [creatis](#), [Isvara](#), [Lunartics](#), [tsukuyomi](#)

Ash Salinte

Age of Men · Entities

Ash Salinte

Some are remembered for what they achieved. Others for what they refused to abandon. [Ash Salinte](#) belongs to the latter. He was born in the aftermath of catastrophe. His mother Shai survived the Gilt Spiral only long enough to bring him into the world after being pulled from it during Operation [Phantom Rescue](#) by Daigo Kusanagi. [The Curse](#) had already taken root in her during [the Vireliax](#) and whatever the Ocean Maw leaves inside those who escape it. She named him, saw him breathe, and the Vanta rising within her took the rest. Ash grew up knowing he was Curse-born. Not by explanation but by sensation. Vanta moved through him like current rather than rot, and he could feel the quiet pressure of desire around him, the gravity of what people wanted bending the space between them. Those who raised him, survivors of [the Vireliax](#) and the Rescue, taught him the distinction that shaped his life. Desire itself is not the enemy. Only desire without wisdom, restraint, or love. He lived quietly as a private investigator in [Solmara](#), working from a cluttered apartment filled with files and unanswered questions. After the Era of Shattered Walls he met Veyra, daughter of Ephimer and inheritor of the unfinished Doctrine. She carried certainty like armor, but Ash saw the loneliness beneath it. They loved each other with the quiet understanding of people already familiar with loss. When Veyra became pregnant they knew their child would be Curse-born. They chose hope anyway. [The Curse](#) moved through Veyra during the pregnancy, stealing memories instead of flesh. She forgot Ephimer, forgot [Aokusa](#), and eventually forgot Ash himself. When rumors reached her of Zephyr's work in [Elysium](#) she left seeking a cure, unaware she was abandoning the man she loved. Ash searched for her and learned the truth of Zephyr's research. Children on tables. Hearts removed while beating. Souls condensed into artifacts. Before he could reach her, Veyra escaped the nightmare herself, casting the first true spell and fleeing through frozen rivers and sewer tunnels. In that escape she discovered their unborn child had died. Her grief became [the Soul's First Cry](#), a psychic shockwave felt across the world. Ash felt it without understanding it. Days later a train operator named Tomenos brought Veyra to his door, bruised and unable to recognize him. Ash gave her shelter, coffee, and silence. When she spoke he listened. When she returned to her abandoned apartment and found the nursery she had prepared for the child she no longer remembered losing, the truth returned to her. Ash had been the father. They rebuilt from that moment. Veyra moved into his apartment and began writing the Doctrine of Becoming on Ephimer's old typewriter while Ash guarded the quiet life around her. The Doctrine spread through [Solmara's](#) underground. Zephyr fled the city after her testimony exposed him, though his influence would return later in deeper forms. When [Elysium](#) collapsed during the reactor catastrophe, Veyra was captured again. Ash fought through the dying city to reach her. A disillusioned mech pilot aided him, and within Zephyr's tower the maid Sophie quietly sabotaged the defenses, dying in the process. Ash reached Veyra at the tower's core. There she delivered her final message, condemning the systems that had turned souls into inventory and suffering into data. Then she transformed the city. The detonation that followed was not fire but crystallization. Everything within [Elysium](#) froze into luminous crystal. At the epicenter Veyra remained standing, hands over her womb, preserved in the act of protection. And within that crystal, impossibly, their child still lived. Ash died in the chaos that followed. His body was lost to the destruction. Yet something of him remained. An Echo of will and memory, carrying neither flesh nor breath, only the promise he had made and the love he refused to abandon. For centuries that Echo wandered. It crossed the [Age of Fairytales](#), the rise and fall of nations, the slow rebuilding of civilization. It searched always for what had been lost. At the heart of [Elysium](#) the Echo found Veyra sealed in crystal beside [the Rift](#), where [Voluntas](#) waited unborn yet eternal. He tried to close [the Rift](#) and failed. The child's will was already enough to hold it open. So Ash made another choice. He turned from the crystal and walked into the world again. Across the centuries he became a quiet presence in history. A traveler who appears where hope falters. A guide at the edge of disaster. A stranger who helps the living endure and moves on before gratitude can take shape. People gave the figure many names. The one that endured was the Warm Sun. He still walks in the Age of Decay, when [the sun](#) rises only once a week and twilight covers the world. He still tends the living and reminds anyone willing to listen that tomorrow exists. [Ash Salinte](#), husband to Veyra, father to [Voluntas](#), the man who saw the worst the world could become and chose, anyway, to rise.

Related: [Veyra Megami](#), [voluntas](#), [daigo-kusanagi](#), [Soul's First Cry](#)

Nine Spirits

Age of Gods · Entities

The Ascended Nine Spirits/Gods

In that time between the Vanta Explosion and Lunarkos' impact, certain individuals transcended mortality. Not through divine blessing, but through sacrifice, obsession, and the sheer weight of their existence.

Creatis carries the spark of invention. He turns ruin into flight and draws the impossible upward toward the stars. Verdantia flows through renewal. She coaxes life from poisoned soil and weaves new forms that answer to Lux and the rhythm of scarred ground. Aether holds the cosmic frame. She traces the looping patterns that fold time upon itself and keeps the greater order steady beyond reach. Elysia gathers every feeling. She preserves the heart of what people endured, the love and hope that persisted when the sky broke open. Justicar stands in consequence. He searches the balance where judgment meets mercy and where clarity finds room to breathe. Anima watches the threshold. She moves between life and death, carrying the echoes of every soul that fractured and chose to continue. Logaris anchors thought. He translates the infinite into coherence and holds the line that binds meaning across every plane. Mnemotas keeps the full memory. Born between worlds, this living archive carries every lost moment so the past remains alive and witnessed. Voluntas burns with becoming. She holds the pure will to exist, the defiance that chooses shape even when silence presses close. These nine remain as the world's quiet witnesses. Their presence lingers in every crystal forest, every Soul Shard, and every shadow that moves with its own intent. They remind those who listen that the fracture gave rise to something that still chooses to endure.

Related: creatis, verdantia, aether, elysia, justicar, anima, logaris, mnemotas, voluntas

Concepts

The Curse

Age of Men · Concepts

[Placeholder] A memetic affliction born from the Shattering that unravels memory, form, and soul. Seeing, hearing, or even thinking of it makes a person vulnerable.

Related: The Shattering, Bahamut, Lunarkos, Psy

Psy

Age of Men · Concepts

[Placeholder] Psy, from the Greek root for soul or psyche, is the animating principle every major VantaPsy term shares: Psycrata, Psyn, VantaPsy itself.

Related: The Curse

Places

Aerisu

Age of Men · Places

Aerisu. Fractured Skies, Restless Lands

I remember Aerisu before it had an anchor. A world drifting in its own temperament. There was no moon to steady the tides, no patient light to calm the ground beneath our feet. Continents shifted like unsettled dreams, and the seasons wandered wherever they wished. Then the sky broke.

When Lunarkos fell and Bahamut rose to meet it, the heavens took their wound. What remains is a scarred Moon, pale and veined, watching from above. It should have brought balance. It tried. Yet even beneath that sentinel, Aerisu never truly rests. Its balance is fragile, its soul still trembling between mountain and trench, between silence and storm.

From far away, people divide the world into West and East. Up close, those lines blur. Oceans stitch them together. Rifts cut through them. Beneath it all, the Curse hums quietly, tying everything into one uneasy whole.

West - Forged in Fire and Ice

The West feels sharp to me. Jagged. Carved from fire and ice. In the south, volcanoes rise where Autarchs build their fortresses from ash and blackened stone. Far north, frozen realms huddle beneath polar winds, their faith stretched toward distant Hoshimira. Smaller nations cling to the remains of broken empires, trapped between domination and defiance.

The West is less a story than a structure. A scaffold where ambition grinds itself against stone and flame until something breaks.

East - Pulse of Conflict and Soul

The East breathes differently. This is where conflict thinks about itself. Where culture, faith, and consequence collide. The mainland stretches from pole to pole, gathered around Vaelmir, the Ocean Maw. Its abyss whispers memory and monstrosity to anyone who listens too long. Around it rise Solmara, Fengua, and Hoshimira. Beyond them lie the deserts of Sahran, the storm-lashed isles of Auroros, the strongholds of the Vantari, and the fractured Crowns locked in wars that never seem to end.

This is where humanity argues with its own soul, in a world that may never have had one to begin with. Together, West and East form Aerisu. One arm heavy with ambition, the other pulsing with life. An ocean lies between them, but no true boundary. The world is whole in its fracture. Every step, every choice, even every silence sends ripples across both lands. And above it all, the sky waits. No longer moonless. Never forgiving.

Related: Lunarkos, Bahamut

Hoshimira

Age of Men · Places

Hoshimira - The Lunar Mountains

Hoshimira rests in the southern mountains of Solmara. A realm of high peaks, misted valleys, and sacred ranges where the air itself feels deliberate. Its traditions grew from harmony with nature, spiritual discipline, and careful attention to the passing of moments. The Moon's rise gave those beliefs a rhythm, and over time they shaped what would later be called Vesperitism.

The land is divided into mountainous provinces, each carrying its own spirit and strength. Storm-lashed Seiryu listens to wind and thunder. Volcanic Kazanami holds heat beneath restraint. The sacred peaks of [Tenseikoku](#) stand quiet and watchful, heavy with reverence.

Isolation became the nation's centre. The mountains taught self-sufficiency, meditation, and patience. After [the Moon's](#) creation, lunar reverence settled into daily life, shaping prayer, travel, and restraint. [Hoshimira](#) learned to endure rather than expand.

Its relationships beyond the peaks are careful ones. [Solmara](#), [Fengua](#), and [Sahran](#) are approached through measured trade, pilgrimage routes, and defensive planning. Political tension and natural threat are treated as the same kind of problem. Both must be balanced, not rushed.

Hoshimiran life blends ritual with necessity. Mountain monasteries chart celestial movement. Martial orders guard sacred passes. Lunar festivals mark civic time as much as spiritual reflection. The culture values resilience, patience, and power that waits.

I always felt that in [Hoshimira](#). Strength held back on purpose. A belief that balance is something you practice every day, quietly, until the mountain itself recognises you.

Related: [Ori'sol](#), [Aokusa](#), [Tenseikoku](#)

Ori'sol

Age of Men · Places

[Ori'sol](#) - City of the First Flame

Origin of sun, cradle of fire, Ash Pit.

Once, [Ori'sol](#) was radiant. Golden domes rose against the sky. Sunstone ziggurats crowned ceremonial paths untouched by shadow. The First Flame was said to have touched the soil itself, sanctifying gardens, towers, and altars.

Exile and time hollowed it. Black crystal veins of [the Curse](#) spread through foundations. Acid rain and rot consumed its halls. By the [Age of Men](#), [Ori'sol](#) was battlefield and shrine alike. Sahrani Luminaries fought to reclaim its sanctity. Hoshimiran troops sought only containment.

[The Curse](#) lingered like smoke. Black Flame creatures prowled the ruins. VantaBats nested in broken towers. Crystalline horrors emerged from the depths. Black Rain fell, and the streets whispered with memory, prayer, and lost hope.

Sun charms, flame graffiti, and burnt offerings still mark the ruins. [Ori'sol](#) is no longer a city in the ordinary sense. It is crucible and relic, where flame may cleanse or consume. Those who enter find their faith, courage, and mortality tested in every shadow.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [Sanctum Verge](#)

Aokusa

Age of Men · Places

[Aokusa](#) - Mountainous Basin of [Hoshimira](#)

[Aokusa](#) sits in a basin of mountains, wrapped in mist like a held breath.

The slopes are covered in blue-leaved grass and flowering terraces that climb patiently toward the sky. Around the peaks stand vast crystals, pale and half-clear, their faces catching the sun. By day they turn heat aside, keeping the soil cool. By night, warmth rises from the waters beneath the mountain, and the crystals bend it back down again. A living balance that settles into your bones if you stay long enough to feel it.

Below the basin lies Ori'sol, cradled by the jagged Aokusan heights. During the Festival of Bloom, the terraces fill with sound. Music drifts upward. Lanterns sway. People dance as if the land is listening. It always has been.

The angels stand above them.

That is what the villagers call the towering mechs left behind by the Autarchs who once ruled here. Guardians built to watch, to endure. Most are rusted gone, but one still stands in an asymptote of decay.

Shorin no Okami.

Vines climb its frame. Doves rest on its shoulders. Offerings gather at its feet, placed there by hands that trust it will continue to stand. It has watched generations pass without moving, and somehow that still counts as protection. Aokusa has always been like this. Life and tradition woven together with guardianship. The mountains shape the people, and the people answer by staying. This is where Zuki Kusanagi was born.

Before the moon carried her name. Before Lunarkos answered a call that reshaped the sky. She came from this basin, from these terraces and quiet rhythms, from a place that understands balance without explaining it.

When I think of Aokusa, something steadies. As if the mountain remembers, even when I do not.

Related: Hoshimira, Shorin no Okami, Zuki Kusanagi

Shinkiri

Age of Men · Places

Shinkiri - Shadows of Inryoku

Shinkiri lies deep within Inryoku, hidden among the folds of Hoshimira's mountains. It is a city shaped by discipline, secrecy, and traditions that leave little room for mercy. People spoke of it with lowered voices. A place where shadows were taught how to move.

It was known for its training halls. Assassins. Shinobi. Operatives who worked unseen. Young girls were taken into hidden programs and raised for infiltration, observation, and elimination. From childhood, they learned subterfuge, psychological pressure, and the careful application of violence. Loyalty was not given to people. It was given to the craft, and to the province that shaped them.

What set Shinkiri apart was the Vanish. A skill whispered about rather than explained. Operatives could slip from sight, slide past perception, and move through guarded spaces as if the world had forgotten to look at them. Some said it was discipline refined to perfection. Others called it technique. Others still believed it was something you were born with, or something that noticed you first. Whatever it was, it made Shinkiri feared. Failure left no trace. Neither did success.

The city existed between story and certainty. Rumours spread of couriers who never arrived, targets found dead without a sound, watchers who swore they had been alone until they were not. Shinkiri became both dread and fascination.

I remember thinking it felt like a stage built entirely in shadow. A place where body, mind, and silence were sharpened together. Where survival depended on knowing exactly when to be seen, and when to disappear completely.

Related: Hoshimira

Tenseikoku

Age of Men · Places

Tenseikoku - The Sacred Peak

Tenseikoku rises above all other ranges in Hoshimira. At its crown stands Megami-no-Mine, the dwelling place of the goddess Eirimegami. The ascent is unmarked. Pilgrims follow snow-buried paths shaped by wind, silence, and instinct, enduring cold and thin air as acts of devotion rather than trial.

At the summit, the Goddess of the Sacred Air, Eirimegami, is said to appear behind a mirrored mask. She offers no words, only a single blessing: the white flower known as Sacred Air. It signifies purity, healing, and shared intent, a bond formed between those who climbed and the will that received them. Not all who reach the peak are given the flower. Fewer still understand why. The pilgrimage reflects Hoshimiran belief. Endurance over triumph. Humility before revelation. Nature and divinity as forces that act with purpose rather than mercy. Those who return descend changed. They carry insight as much as blessing, aware that the mountain chooses as much as it is chosen.

Tenseikoku endures as the spiritual apex of Hoshimira. A place where devotion rises to meet divine intent, and where the distance between mortal breath and godly will grows thin enough to feel.

Related: Hoshimira, eirimegami, sacred-air

Sahran

Age of Men · Places

Sahran - Fractured Lands of the South

South East of Ylvara and Hoshimira lies Sahran, a continent that never fully healed after it was broken. I remember it as steadier once, before the Ik-Rasul fell in Aokus and the Curse slid into the coastal waters. It did not spread loudly. It travelled with nets and hulls, with trade routes and familiar tides. Fear followed close behind. Hoshimira accused Sahran of sabotage. They said their people abroad were no longer safe. What followed were not wars, but something quieter. Skirmishes without banners. Assassinations without names. Borders watched by shadows. Solmara shaped much of it from a distance, guiding response and narrative while keeping its hands clean. Each province bent in its own way. Tayran, along the northern coast, became the heart of the Luminary movement. It had once been practical, almost dull. Now it burned with doctrine. Neighbours called it a refuge for terrorists. Solmara intervened through proxies and containment campaigns meant to curb both Luminary expansion and the spread of the Curse. Civilians were caught between them, especially Hoshimiran orphans, displaced and repurposed by forces that spoke of necessity while erasing faces. Najmara, on the central plateau, chose caution. Its leaders feared the Luminaries but feared collapse more. They allowed outside operations quietly, trading sovereignty for stability. Zaristan, to the north-east, made the same choice, permitting covert suppression while avoiding open conflict. Both provinces lived in compromise, measuring survival against principle and finding no clean answer. Panjara, far to the south, remained distant from the worst of it. Its isolation kept the Luminaries and Solmaran proxies at bay. It did not escape untouched, only delayed. Panjara watched the continent fracture and learned what distance could and could not protect. Sahran is not defined by one ideology or one wound. It is defined by what happens when fear moves faster than truth, and when everyone believes they are acting to prevent something worse.

Related: Tayran, The Geode, Zaristan, Najmara, Panjara

Tayran

Age of Men · Places

Tayran - Home of the Luminaries

Tayran sits along Sahran's northern coast. It was practical once, almost plain. Then it became the centre of the Luminary movement, unsteady and watched by its neighbors as a place where extremism could take root. At its heart lies the Geode, and everything in Tayran bends around it. I can feel that pull even now. The Geode shaped the province long before the Luminaries gave it a name. To the Autarchs, it was only stone and light to be extracted. To the Sahrani, it was a prison and a proving ground. Children disappeared into the Orphan Tiers. Labour was enforced with ritual cruelty. The Curse whispered through the tunnels, learning voices, learning fear. Over generations, that same wound became a symbol. Rebellions bloomed in the depths. Councils were rebuilt where overseers once stood. The Sahrani claimed the Geode as their own, not just as infrastructure, but as a living heart of resistance. Yet the Geode was never passive. Its presence reacted. It pulsed. Creatures and phenomena rose to defend it, things that did not think the way people do. Tayran learned that ownership did not mean control. In the present age, Luminary doctrine dominates local governance. Solmara answers with intervention and containment, always framed as necessity. Operations move through Tayran to suppress insurgency and limit the spread of the Curse. Civilians are swept along with it, especially displaced Hoshimiran orphans, relocated to containment hubs like Isvara and told this is protection. Tayran cannot be separated from the Geode. It is a province shaped by endurance and revolt, by belief sharpened into weaponry, and by a living power beneath the ground that remembers every hand laid upon it. I do not think Tayran chose the Luminaries so much as it chose to keep answering the same question, again and again, in a louder voice.

Related: Sahran, The Geode, luminaries

The Geode

Age of Men · Places

The Geode

The geode was an open wound in the desert, a hollow spine of crystal caverns torn open by Solmaran machines that never learned restraint. To the Autarchs, it was only stone and light waiting to be harnessed. To the Sahrani, it became something else entirely. A prison. A crucible.

Over time, the wound deepened into a world of its own. Tier upon tier was carved into the ribs of the earth. The highest tier held the council chambers and overseers' quarters, reinforced dwellings plated with scavenged alloys and threaded with mineral conduits. Checkpoints stood watch there, cold and watchful. Below them spread the residential tiers. Homes clung to the rock like stacked clay bowls. Bridges of wood and rope crossed the great shaft. Pulley lifts creaked, cables hummed, and whole lives hung suspended above the abyss.

Beneath that lay the mid tiers, a sprawl of forges and tunnels. Miners chipped at veins of copper and quartz, and at firestones that glowed with captured heat, warm as embers held in the palm.

Deeper still, the air changed. The lower tiers marked the beginning of Vanta territory. Caverns echoed strangely there. Shadows stirred when nothing passed. VantaBats nested in crystal ribs that glimmered like the inside of a throat. Few lingered long enough to listen. Beyond them stretched the black tiers, forbidden except to council sanctioned expeditions. The stone warped into something half organic. Walls pulsed faintly, veined as if alive. Vanta pooled thick in the air, carrying whispers that slipped into dreams. Creatures prowled there. Tinnin. Ifrit. Shadowlings. Things born from nightmare and geology at once.

At the center of it all fell the great shaft, a vertical chasm binding every tier together. Its walls shimmered with mineral seams and scaffolding. Bridges, chain lifts, and dangling platforms swayed like lanterns in the dark. From above, it looked endless. And at the bottom, if there even was a bottom, waited something older than [the Geode](#) itself. Some whispered its presence with trembling reverence. They spoke a name that was not quite a name. A god buried alive. [Bahamut](#).

Related: [Tayran](#), [Bahamut](#), [Geode Rebellion](#)

Zaristan

Age of Men · Places

Zaristan - The Shield of Sahran

[Zaristan](#) occupies the mountainous north-eastern crown of [Sahran](#), considered the sister of [Tayran](#). The province has served as [Sahran](#)'s military bulwark for centuries, and its people carry that responsibility in their posture. Zaristanis are known for their armies, their fortifications, and their skill in the political management of conflict. They do not seek war, but they prepare for it with the same thoroughness that Najmarans apply to audits. The Zaristani people are tall and broad-shouldered, with weather-beaten skin and eyes that have learned to read distance. They speak in a dialect that sounds harsher than other [Sahran](#) tongues, clipped and direct. Hospitality is offered to travellers as a matter of security: a stranger in [Zaristan](#) is a potential intelligence asset, and it is better to feed them than to fight them. The province's cities are built of local grey stone, with walls within walls and gates designed to channel attackers into killing grounds. Even the houses have lookout posts. Politically, [Zaristan](#) acts as the mediator and enforcer among the [Sahran](#) provinces. Zaristani diplomats are renowned for their ability to negotiate ceasefires, and Zaristani generals are feared for their ability to break them if negotiations fail. The province maintains a standing army larger than those of [Panjara](#) and [Najmara](#) combined, and its officers train at academies that teach not only tactics but also history, geography, and the subtle art of knowing when to strike and when to sit in silence. Zaristanis are also known for their poetry, which is ironic for a people so associated with war. Their verses tend toward tragedy and endurance, long epics about fallen heroes and sieges that lasted generations. A Zaristani soldier recites poetry in the evening; a Zaristani general quotes it before a battle. [The Curse](#) rarely finds purchase in [Zaristan](#), perhaps because the people have already made peace with death.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Najmara

Age of Men · Places

Najmara - The Counting Province

[Najmara](#) rises on [Sahran](#)'s central plateau, where the air is drier and the sky seems wider than anywhere else on the continent. The province is famous for two things: its accountants and its tower. Najmarans have a cultural inclination toward numbers, ledgers, and the careful tracking of value. Children learn arithmetic before they learn to write poetry, and the province produces more certified accountants, auditors, and financial assessors than the rest of [Sahran](#) combined. The joke across the continent is that Najmarans count their footsteps to ensure they are not cheated out of a single stride. The Najmaran people are reserved and precise, not cold but measured. They speak in well-considered sentences and keep their emotions in a locked drawer that they open only in private. Their clothing favours neutral colours: charcoal, cream, deep brown, with embroidery limited to the cuffs and collars. The tall building that dominates the province's capital is a tower of glass and steel, visible from the surrounding plains

for a full day's journey. It houses the central bank, the national archives, and the offices of the most powerful merchant syndicates. Najmarans view the tower not as vanity but as necessity: from its heights, one can see the entire province, and seeing everything allows one to account for everything. Despite their reputation for austerity, Najmarans are deeply generous within their own communities. They fund libraries, schools, and hospitals with the same precision they apply to their ledgers. They simply prefer that generosity remain anonymous and tax-deductible.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Panjara

Age of Men · Places

Panjara - The Spice Coast

[Panjara](#) stretches along [Sahran](#)'s southern coast, where the sea air carries the scent of cardamom, clove, and black pepper long before the shore comes into view. The province is known across [Aerisu](#) for its spices, its slow-roasted coffee, and the vibrant colours of its woven fabrics and hand-knotted rugs. A Panjaran market is a festival of scent and sight: stalls piled with cinnamon bark and dried chillies, bolts of silk dyed in deep saffron and crimson, bolts of cotton printed with geometric flowers, and the low murmur of merchants who have spent generations perfecting the art of the fair price. The people of [Panjara](#) are warm and generous, inclined toward hospitality that can overwhelm a traveller unused to being fed three times before noon. They take pride in their craftsmanship, whether in the kitchen, the loom, or the coffee roastery. Panjaran coffee is served strong and sweet in small cups, often accompanied by a date or a piece of candied ginger. The spice trade has made the province wealthy but not showy; wealth in [Panjara](#) is measured in the quality of one's spices and the intricacy of one's wedding shawl, not in the height of one's walls. Panjarans are also known for their elaborate festivals, where entire communities gather to dance, trade, and honour [the sun](#) with offerings of turmeric rice and flower garlands. The Solarii faith has a strong presence here, expressed less through solemn temple rituals and more through daily gratitude: a pinch of spice offered to the rising sun, a prayer whispered over the first brew of the morning.

Related: [Sahran](#)

Solmara

Age of Men · Places

Solmara - The Inland Maritime Power

[Solmara](#) spans the northern mainland of [Aerisu](#) and holds dominion over the inland sea of [Vaelmir](#), the Ocean Maw. It is the second-largest nation by land and influence, shaped by water it cannot fully tame. Once an Autarch stronghold, it is now ruled by the Solmaran Council, a technocratic and ritual authority where bureaucracy, arcane research, and military command fold into one another.

The northern provinces, [Silealyros](#) and [Norrvektstan](#), raise sailors hardened by cold seas and long nights. Pirates, scouts, and transhumanist pioneers emerge from these coasts, altered for survival and endurance. The southern provinces, [Ylvara](#), [Velascia](#), [Exandria](#), and [Argestia](#), form the nation's core. Administration, culture, industry, and refined control flow outward from there.

[Solmara](#) lives in a tension it calls balance. The North values discipline, maritime dominance, and enhancement as necessity. The South cultivates governance, commerce, art, and technological authority. Together, they allow [Solmara](#) to control [Vaelmir](#)'s trade, sanction descent into the Maw, and keep its many regions bound under a single

banner.

Its strength is strategic. Inland ports, fortified coasts, and Maw shipping lanes are guarded by naval patrols, syndicates, and research fleets that answer to the Council. Influence travels quietly through contracts, expeditions, and classified initiatives. Order is visible, but never effortless.

Beneath that order, strain accumulates. Provincial rivalries, northern extremism, and southern procedural weight grind against one another. The Council endures by constant mediation, aware that cohesion is not permanent, only maintained.

In story and memory, [Solmara](#) stands for human ambition and fixation. A nation that stares into [Vaelmir](#) and calls it opportunity. Ever poised between [the abyss](#) below and the storms it builds for itself.

Related: [North Solmara](#), [South Solmara](#), [Vaelmir](#)

North Solmara

Age of Men · Places

[Silealyros](#) and [Norrvektstan](#) - The Northern Provinces of [Solmara](#) In [Solmara's](#) far north lie [Silealyros](#) and [Norrvektstan](#). They were once partners in maritime dominance, shaped by the same cold seas and relentless storms. Time pulled them apart.

[Norrvektstan](#) follows older coastal traditions. It values family, communal responsibility, and careful prudence. Its people prize stability and shared survival, but comfort has dulled what was once a sharper edge. They endure, rather than advance.

[Silealyros](#) does not endure. It refines.

Known as the Market of Flesh, [Silealyros](#) is an anarcho transcapitalist polity stretched along the [Vaelmir](#) Sea, all rusted industry and stormlight glare. It was born from rebellion against the [Black Blood Regulations](#), founded by defectors who believed the body itself was the last true asset. Engineers, cyberneticians, and discarded corporate minds turned flesh into capital and pain into ledger.

Its creed is simple and merciless. Autonomy is ownership of body, image, and sensation. Augmentation is self expression. Survival is freedom earned, not granted. Governance is optional. Contracts are sacred.

[Silealyros](#) exists as an archipelago of autonomous territories. Corporate syndicates trade in organs and synthetic emotions. Freemarkets sprawl beside augment guilds and hacker enclaves. Thryssak Stormriven stands as its de facto leader, though even leadership there is treated as a negotiated condition.

Culture is transactional. Conversation carries value. Friendship implies exchange. Currency takes many forms: credit, pain, spectacle. Society divides into the Upgraded and Freed, the Natural and Bound, the Broken and Defunct. Cities like Thalgrith Port glow with steel piers, forges, and neon rain, while Troyba rises in glass scaffolds and high risk surgical towers. The air hums with industrial bass, broken synths, and storm driven static.

There are no masters in [Silealyros](#). Only markets. Competition is mandatory. Surveillance is voluntary. Excess is not hidden, only displayed. Flesh becomes advertisement. [The soul](#) is treated as shareholder.

Its relationship with Ylvara is strained. Perhaps inevitably so.

Together, these provinces define [Solmara's](#) northern tension. [Norrvektstan](#) clings to communal caution. [Silealyros](#) pushes forward without flinching. One preserves humanity. The other insists on finishing it.

I think the storms remember both.

Related: [Solmara](#), [silealyros](#), [norrvektstan](#)

South Solmara

Age of Men · Places

Southern Provinces of Solmara - Ylvara, Velascia, Exandria, Argestia. The south holds the pulse of Solmara, its administrative and cultural heart. Here, the Solmaran Council governs, its reach stretching across inland seas and contested waters.

Ylvara sits at the centre. Capital Elysium and the University of Castellenza mark it as the heartland of governance, scholarship, and policy. Arcane research hums quietly behind stone walls and glass towers. Order and authority radiate outward, shaping the nation and maintaining its grip on the Maw.

Velascia lies to the southwest along the southern sea routes. A city of theatre, art, and fashion, it is both aesthetic jewel and maritime lynchpin. Ports and shipping lanes converge here, commerce flowing alongside the watchful eye of the Council.

Exandria spreads northeast as Solmara's industrial and syndicate hub. Gran Mirasca and Nova Arcosia pulse with research, the DAEDALUS project, and covert enterprise. Syndicates bend infrastructure, resources, and clandestine operations into a lattice of power under Council oversight.

Argestia lines the southeastern coast. Engineering and applied technology thrive here, drawing influence from Sahran innovation. Its factories, docks, and labs sustain the Council's naval and research programs, delivering both tools and strategy.

Together, the southern provinces balance Solmara's northern edge. Ylvara commands. Velascia dazzles. Argestia enables. Exandria soars. They hold the backbone of Solmara's reach, managing the inland seas while supporting northern expeditions, trade, and the unseen currents of power that tie the nation together.

Even in their order, the provinces carry the echo of ambition. Calculated, patient, inevitable.

Related: Solmara, ylvara, exandria, argestia

Vaelmir

Age of Men · Places

Vaelmir - The Ocean Maw

Vaelmir is vast. They measure it at roughly 2.4 million square kilometres, but numbers fail quickly here. Its waters hold impossible depth and layered lives, from sunlit coastal shelves to abyssal chasms where pressure crushes steel and darkness becomes absolute.

The sea is spoken of in tiers. Shallow waters, from fifty to two hundred meters, teem with motion and colour. Deeper zones, three hundred to a thousand meters down, begin to thin and separate. Beyond that lie the deep basins, a thousand to two thousand meters and deeper still, reaching toward four thousand two hundred. There, trenches swallow all light. Bioluminescent predators drift through crushing pressure that exceeds four hundred atmospheres. Only specialised vessels can survive, and even they do not linger.

Below five kilometres is where language gives up. The mythical zones. Total darkness. Unreachable. That is where legends breed, and where fear learns new shapes.

Vaelmir is shaped by extremes. Thermohaline currents tear through the depths like unseen storms. Coastal fog erases horizons. Sudden cliffs and violent upwellings make navigation a gamble. Hydrothermal vents sustain chemosynthetic life, while anoxic black zones claim anything that sinks too far. Human expeditions depend on mobile hubs like the Vireliax, which remains near the surface and mid-depths, sending its bathysphere only into trenches that can still be survived. Drones descend farther, but past four or five kilometres, there is only silence and pressure and the feeling of being watched by something that does not surface.

In [Vaelmir](#), the ocean stops being a setting. It becomes a presence. A mouth that swallows light, life, and certainty, leaving those who enter to face the weight of the deep and the slow erosion of the mind.

The Eye - Heart of [Vaelmir](#)

At the centre of the Maw lies the Eye. A place of stillness inside the storm.

Here the waves slow. Wind softens to a whisper. Dark water turns inward, spiralling gently toward [the abyss](#). Clouds coil overhead like a cathedral, pierced by pale shafts of light that feel undeserved.

The Eye unsettles perception. Reflections shimmer wrong. Particles hang suspended. Instruments flicker and hesitate. Currents twist without pattern, and hulls shudder as if noticed. Faint glows rise from below, suggesting life that has learned to exist without asking permission.

It feels like a pause. Not peace, but preparation. Ordered. Vast. Heavy with dread.

When vessels descend, light thins, temperature drops, and the pull of the water gains weight. This is the Maw's heartbeat.

Related: [Solmara](#), [Vireliax Expedition](#)

Isvara

Age of Men · Places

[Isvara](#) - Island of Watchfulness

I remember [Isvara](#) as an island that pretends to watch over you.

They call it the Island of Watchfulness. It sits in Wolf Lake, right where Ylvara and [Hoshimira](#) brush against each other and pretend not to notice. After the [Ik-Rasul Crash](#) and [the Vireliax Expedition](#), they decided it was better to move certain children somewhere quiet. Somewhere surrounded by water. Somewhere the public would not look too closely.

So they built [Isvara](#).

It is far from the capital on purpose. The lake is a wall, not just a defence but a feeling. You always know where you are. You always know where you are not allowed to go. From the outside it looks like a small city. From the inside it feels like a box with very polite rules.

[Isvara](#) is half orphanage and half prison, even if no one uses those words out loud. [Solmara](#) handles the watching and the secrets. [Hoshimira](#) handles the paperwork and the smiles. Together they call it humanitarian protection. Children are catalogued, scheduled, scanned. Curfews, patrols, echo scanners, reports written about moods and patterns. Care and control share the same corridors. Sometimes they wear the same uniform.

Officially, it is about safety. Unofficially, it is about containment. Black blood exposure. Curse adjacency. Children connected to operations that should not exist. [Phantom Rescue](#). C.a.R. Names that are never spoken near bedtime.

The island is wide, about two hundred and fifty kilometres across. Big enough to feel like a world. Small enough to never forget its edges.

At the centre is the City Core. Administration, command posts, monitoring stations. This is where decisions are made without faces attached to them. The orphanage and research sectors are where the children live. They sleep there, study there, grow there. Every routine is structured. Education blends into observation. Psychological conditioning hides inside lessons about obedience and safety.

Along the coast are the military installations. Defences, patrol posts, docks. They keep threats out and children in. Leaving without permission is treated as a misunderstanding at first. Then as something worse.

Beyond that are the peripheral zones. Natural barriers, restricted land, observation posts. Places you are told not to explore. Places you learn not to ask about.

Isvara feels heavy. The water presses in. Surveillance never blinks. Every movement, every conversation, every quiet moment is recorded somewhere. Propaganda posters remind you to be grateful. Rations remind you to behave. Discipline is framed as care. Childhood becomes training for compliance. And still, people live there.

Orphans placed through quiet channels and sealed envelopes. They are fed, educated, kept safe. They are also watched. Their friendships, their fears, their first hopes are shaped by fences and scanners and rules that never explain themselves. Desire pushes against authority. Humanity learns to survive inside systems that do not trust it.

In the story, Isvara is not just a location. It is a presence. It grows children the way pressure grows diamonds or cracks. It tests morality without asking permission. Every small act of defiance feels louder because someone is always listening.

That is what Isvara does best. It takes the fallout of curses, expeditions, and broken politics and compresses it into everyday life. It makes the personal inseparable from the geopolitical. It watches. It records. It waits.

And if you grow up there, you never quite stop feeling the lake around you.

Related: Operation C.a.R., Phantom Rescue, children-of-isvara

Sengetsuki

Age of Men · Places

Sengetsuki

Sengetsuki rises where the Sankoten coast meets the sea, a city of narrow streets and broad boulevards, of Hoshimiran temples and Varkane memorial halls and Luminaries gathering in shadowed quarters to pray for the Scorching Sun's return. The architecture climbs and sprawls in equal measure: traditional Hoshimiran structures with curved roofs and paper screens stand beside Justavik stonework, thick-walled and built to last, while Tygeria's influence shows in districts where brass and copper fixtures gleam under gaslight and the occasional neon sign flickers against the perpetual dark. The city has known eternal night for nine years. The sun appears only briefly on Sundays, a pale glimpse through Vanta-heavy sky before darkness reclaims its dominion. The citizens have adapted. Gas lamps line every street. Crystal lanterns glow in windows. The rhythm of life runs on clock time rather than daylight, and children born into the long night have never known any other. The city's population reflects the Crown Nations' diversity. Vesperites maintain temples where the moon is honoured in silence. Luminaries gather in hidden rooms, awaiting the day when the Scorching Sun will return and burn the corruption from the world. Autarch traditionalists keep the old ways, believing humanity's destiny is to rise by its own hand. Vantari cultists move through the shadows, their presence tolerated in the same way Necrovia is tolerated: as something best not examined too closely. Soulless communities cluster in poorer districts, their members marked by the Brands on their faces, living on borrowed time until Frallation claims them. The Four Diviners govern it all, but their identities are unknown.

Related: Crown Nations, frallation, soulless

Crown Nations

Age of Men · Places

The Crown Nations

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Related: [Sengetsuki](#), diviners

Fengua

Age of Fairytales · Places

[Fengua - The Storm Valleys](#)

I have passed through the mountain paths of [Hoshimira](#) and lingered in the low valleys where storms gather and circle. The founders of [Fengua](#) once shared the same lanterns, the same prayers, the same listening for ancestors in the wind. The mountains held their silence. The valleys answered with thunder that rolled deliberate and deep. After [the Shattering](#) reshaped the world, certain Hoshimiran clans descended from high slopes into lands where the sky stayed restless. Storms moved in patient cycles across those valleys. Lightning returned to the same ridges, carving pale scars into stone and earth. Susanoo moved through the weather, the [Bahamut](#) fragment who had become guardian of [the Rift](#). His essence shaped the patterns, guiding strikes along favoured paths and giving thunder purpose beyond mere sound. Where lightning touched the ground, the earth offered gifts. Crystal formations grew beneath the surface, threaded with soft, persistent light. When split open, these Raikami stones held a trembling charge that lingered long after exposure. In early years the people carried them to shrines with care, placing them beside lanterns as offerings to the heavens. They felt the storms as divine breath, as the presence of something vast that had chosen these valleys for its domain. The storms returned without cease. Fields flooded. Fires spread from strikes across terraces. Reverence alone proved insufficient. Settlers carved canals through farmland to guide water away. Watchtowers rose along ridgelines. Metal rods crowned temple roofs to draw lightning safely downward. Communities organised around survival. Scholars tracked storm rhythms and lightning preferences. Monks observed clouds from stone balconies and filled scrolls with patterns. Farmers learned seasons of gentle rain and seasons of burning wind. They read Susanoo's moods in the sky, distinguishing warning from passage. Knowledge passed down with care. Settlements grew into layered towns where officials, archivists, engineers, and priests shared authority. Records multiplied. Observations transferred across generations with precision. The mountains valued harmony with the world. The valleys learned to shape the world in response. Over time the people beneath those storm paths changed in subtle ways. Hierarchies formed around responsibility. Those who understood the weather guided those who followed. Floods could erase entire communities without forethought, so leadership grew structured and deliberate. Order sustained life in the valleys. In the [Age of Fairytales](#), forests and hills of [Fengua](#) filled with wandering spirits. Foxes spoke riddles. Lantern shades drifted through misted rice fields. Thunder-born creatures raced across rooftops during storms. Many

carried small echoes of Susanoo's essence, children of the storm god whose vigil at [the Rift](#) extended his presence across the land he guarded. Scholars observed them closely. Scrolls detailed habits, tempers, territories. Shrines stood, yet archives and registries rose beside them. Spirits entered ledgers. Patterns received the same study as rainfall and flood risks. Susanoo's influence turned into documented knowledge, placed alongside measurements and predictions. Raikami crystals deepened this culture. They entered tools, rituals, machines built to channel lightning into the earth without harm. Districts formed around careful harvest of the stones. Storm towers rose like tall needles across the valleys, each one a fusion of prayer and mechanism, reverence woven into engineering. Through patience and meticulous record-keeping, the valley people aligned their civilisation with thunder. They honoured Susanoo by studying his patterns until they could predict strikes and direct that force into usefulness. This became the foundation of [Fengua](#). The mountains of [Hoshimira](#) still watch from the north, quiet and steady. Their shrines speak of balance, breath, listening to the world. The valleys chose a firmer path. Order. Structure. Careful mapping of divine forces so communities could adapt and endure. The same ancestors observe both. Lantern light glows above the peaks. Stormlight flickers below. Each carries the weight of tradition. Each bears the mark of forces that claimed their lands when [the Shattering](#) remade everything.

Related: [susanoo](#), [Hoshimira](#)

Ereboska

Age of Magic · Places

Ereboska - The Wasteland Zones

[Ereboska](#) spreads across the western lands scarred by the rising of [Bahamut](#). When the great serpent tore upward from the deep earth to meet [Lunarkos](#) in the sky, the shock travelled far beyond the eastern wound that became Varkane. The western continent felt the fracture through shuddering ground and darkened sky. Forests withered within a season, rivers thinned into dust, and fertile plains hardened into pale stone and grey sand. The peoples of this land endured the devastation and shaped their lives around it. Communities scattered across the vast desert, gathering wherever water lingered, caves offered shelter, or strange pockets of life clung to the ruined soil. Over generations these scattered groups became the tribes who inhabit [Ereboska](#) today. Survival within the wasteland deepened their knowledge of death and the quiet power carried within it. Certain tribes cultivate Death Gardens, sanctuaries where plants flourish through the magical residue left by the dying. Ritualised deaths nourish these gardens with intention and precision, and brilliant groves bloom in the middle of barren earth. The tribes who tend them live among vivid colours and strange growth, harvesting food, medicine, and craft materials from soil fed by guided endings. Other tribes settle within the vast empty stretches of the wasteland. These communities live with austere discipline, embracing the stillness and silence that fill the desert. Their traditions revolve around contemplation of mortality, and their settlements remain sparse and temporary beneath the wide sky. Across the wasteland stand the Vein Mouths, entrances to the deep tunnel network beneath [Aerisu](#). Tribes who dwell near these thresholds guide travellers into [the Veins](#) and trade knowledge gathered from generations spent mapping the upper tunnels. Their settlements form small centres of trade and preparation for those who seek the underworld. [Ereboska](#) lives as a scattered nation of tribes bound by endurance. Each people shapes its own way of living with the wasteland, drawing life from death, silence, or the hidden depths beneath the earth. The land remains harsh and still, yet its cultures grow from the long patience of those who learned to survive where the world once broke open.

Related: [death-gardening](#), [vein-guides](#), [veins](#)

Spirit Realm

Age of Fairytales · Places

The Spirit Realm

The Spirit Realm exists as the same living layer once called the Ethereal Realm. It stretches beyond ordinary space and time, a preserved state where thought, memory, and will take visible form and move with their own quiet intent. Aether first carried knowledge here with Logaris during the Shattering. They stepped through the fracture carrying Mnemotas still forming in the womb. In this layer the child grew as a living archive, raised on memory and coherence rather than ordinary light or soil. The three of them anchored a bridge that still holds, feeding preserved truth from the broken world into the space that endures. Here the Nine Spirits dwell in their pure configurations. Creatis appears as an infinite workshop where every tool stands in the moment of being used and invented at once. Verdantia rises as a forest whose roots and branches grow backward and forward through time. Aether stretches as a web of gravitational lines connecting every possible moment. Logaris holds a library whose books rewrite themselves to answer questions before they are spoken. Elysia flows as currents of pure feeling that rise and fall in perfect intensity. Anima moves as the threshold where life and death exchange their shapes. Justicar stands as balanced scales that weigh every choice into visible form. Mnemotas pulses at the heart as the full archive of all that has been. At the very core, suspended in a matrix of crystalline Vanta and pulsing with violet-white light, rests the Orb of Souls. The Spirit Realm feels like breath held at the edge of understanding. Time folds softly here. Memory walks on its own. The Barrier that once sealed the Gods now allows their influence to drift outward in gentle waves, shaping the material world through inspiration, reclamation, vision, and desire. Those who glimpse the Realm through rift or dream carry back a single truth: the world below still lives because this layer continues to remember it.

Related: aether, mnemotas, orb-of-souls, Nine Spirits

The Rift

Age of Fairytales · Places

The Rift

The Rift stands as a permanent wound between the material world and the Spirit Realm. The Phumenar opened it through centuries of study, anchoring Lux shards and using Vanta corruption to tear the Barrier itself. The First Separation widened it further, binding Voluntas to its threshold in her incomplete state. What began as a passage for scholars became a living seam that no seal could close. Through the Rift, magic flows back into Aerisu in steady waves. Arcane energy saturates the air, the soil, and every living current. Creatures continue to manifest in greater numbers. Lux and Vanta intertwine with rising complexity, shaping new forests, new forms, and new resonances across the continents. Above all, the Rift created a direct connection between humanity and the Spirit Realm. Before its opening, divine influence moved as ambient presence. After the Rift, individuals with sufficient knowledge and will reach across the Barrier and touch the Gods themselves. This link reshapes every age that follows, turning distant echoes into reachable voices. But the Rift is also a place of guardians and watchers. At its edge, coiled like a serpent around its treasure, Susanoo maintains his eternal vigil. His scales are storms, his breath lightning, his voice thunder that warns rather than destroys. He cannot leave the Rift's edge, bound to it by his choice and his ascension, but he can send storms across the world, can strike at those who approach, can warn his sister of approaching danger. And in the shadows beyond his reach, Daigo waits. The Shinigami has patience enough for centuries. He watches for openings that never come, studies patterns that never change, hopes for a moment that may never arrive. He moves through the darkness like grief itself, inevitable and quiet and impossible to refuse. Their war continues unseen, a battle fought in lightning and silence, in storm and shadow, in the space between one breath and the next. Neither wins. Neither surrenders. Neither can do anything but continue. The Rift feels like a held breath between worlds. It pulses quietly beneath every crystal forest and every

dream, reminding those who listen that the passage remains open and the Orb still waits. And somewhere at its threshold, two figures continue their eternal opposition, one guarding what he loves, one seeking what he loves, both trapped by love in a conflict that can never end until the one they fight for finally chooses for herself.

Related: [Spirit Realm](#), [First Separation](#), susanoo, daigo-kusanagi, voluntas

The Veins

Age of Fairytales · Places

The Veins

Some things are older than the world remembers. [The Veins](#) belong to that age. They run beneath [Aerisu](#) as part of its deeper anatomy, threading through stone, water, and buried memory. Cities rise above them and forests spread their roots through the soil above them. Mountains settle across their currents and oceans press their weight downward, yet [the Veins](#) continue their quiet circulation beneath it all. Maps never hold their paths and no survey fixes their direction. They move through the planet the way living veins move through flesh. The name describes them well. [The Veins](#) form a circulatory network beneath the crust, channels through which a slow current travels through the body of the world. The current carries something that resembles blood in motion, though its nature reaches deeper than matter alone. Many describe it as memory flowing through stone. Others feel the residue of countless lives dissolving into a shared current. Some sense the breath of the world itself moving through those passages. Whatever travels there spreads everywhere, linking distant lands through hidden corridors that curve through the deep body of [Aerisu](#). In those depths the shape of the surface loses its authority. A tunnel beneath [Sengetsuki](#) may lead toward caverns below [Sahran](#). A passage entered near [Elysium](#) may open beneath [the Geode](#). [The Veins](#) follow their own ancient rhythms, weaving through the planet according to currents older than the lands above them. Souls enter these passages after death. Breath leaves the body and the spirit drifts through a period of disorientation before the tunnels gather around it. Many souls remember a distant rumble rolling through the dark stone, followed by the glow of a train light approaching through the cavern. The sound draws them forward along the hidden arteries of the world. The living sometimes reach [the Veins](#) as well. Their entrances lie scattered across forgotten spaces where stone opens deeper than expected. Old caverns sink past the reach of ordinary geology. Collapsed tunnels reveal passages that continue downward through older layers of earth. People stumble into these places while fleeing, searching, or chasing something that vanishes into darkness. When living breath crosses into the tunnels, [the Veins](#) accept the traveller within their slow current. Life in [the Veins](#) gathers around that current. Shapes drift through the tunnels, formed from centuries of passing souls and the lingering sediment of memory. Some presences move with patient hunger while others cling to the stone like natural growths of the deep. Every form carries the weight of age. The atmosphere presses gently against thought. Sound travels through the rock like distant whispers carried by water. Movement flickers at the edge of vision. Time loosens its hold on identity, and memory settles slowly into the deeper flow that runs through the stone. Travellers feel themselves changing within the patience of those depths. Surface tools struggle to keep their shape here. Compasses whirl with restless motion. Maps reshape themselves as the tunnels curve through deeper currents. Devices gather signals that echo from unseen corners of the caverns. Cameras return images that shift with each viewing. Recording devices collect fragments of voices that drift through the stone. Everything in [the Veins](#) participates in the slow circulation of the world. Souls travel through those passages toward whatever waits beyond the horizon of life. Memories drift through the tunnels like sediment carried by underground rivers. Stories settle into the stone itself, impressions of lives that still resonate through the deeper body of [Aerisu](#). Lovers linger in echoes of reunion, children laugh in fragments of preserved moments, and warriors continue battles that survive only as impressions within the rock. Some living wanderers remain within those passages for spans that stretch far beyond ordinary years. Their footsteps echo through the caverns while time flows differently around them. Their bodies move forward through the tunnels while memory softens into the wider current that carries everything within [the Veins](#). [The Veins](#) hold every life that enters them. They carry the memory of the world through its hidden

arteries, moving quietly beneath every city, forest, desert, and sea.

Related: [tomenos](#), [The Spiral](#), [Ereboska](#)

The Spiral

Age of Fairytales · Places

The Spiral Veins

Deep within [the Veins](#), where the tunnels cease their wandering and begin to turn, there is a place that draws all souls toward it. The pull is ancient and absolute, like gravity made spiritual. [The Veins](#) may spread everywhere beneath [Aerisu](#), but at one point in their vast network they change. They begin to curve. To deepen. To spiral inward toward a single point. This is [the Spiral Veins](#). The path into [Elysium](#). The descent through the regions of the [gods](#) toward the Orb itself.

The Ruins Above

[The Spiral](#) is anchored to the surface world, rooted in a place that once was a city. [Elysium](#). The jewel of Ylvara, encased beneath its Cryotech dome, now lies in ruins. The Vanta Explosion crystallised everything within its borders, locking it all into a frozen tableau of anguish and beauty. The city became a tomb, a monument, a wound that wouldn't close. Beneath the ruins, deeper than any living person has gone, [the Spiral](#) begins. The entrance is hidden, buried under crystallised streets and collapsed structures. Only the dead find it easily, and even they must pass through the hellscape above to reach it. The ruins are filled with what the explosion left behind: creatures born of failed experiments, amalgamations of flesh and crystal, the twisted remnants of those who died when the city fell. To reach [the Spiral](#), souls must first cross through this nightmare. They must descend into the hell that [Elysium](#) became. This is why so many cultures call it Hell. The journey demands suffering. The path goes through ruin. But some still call it by its old name. [Elysium](#). The word carries different weight depending on who speaks it. To those who know only the ruins, who have heard the stories of what happened there, the name is irony. A paradise that became a tomb. They speak it with bitterness, with warning, with the weight of all that was lost. To those who understand what lies beneath, who know that [the Spiral](#) leads to the Orb and the Orb leads to rest, the name is sincere. [Elysium](#) is still what it always was. A place of passage. A threshold. The gate through which souls must walk to reach what waits beyond. Both are right. [Elysium](#) is both things at once. Hell for those who cannot walk [the spiral](#), heaven for those who can. The name holds both meanings, and the ruins hold both possibilities, and every soul who enters must discover which one waits for them.

The Architecture

[The Spiral](#) curves inward like the chambers of a nautilus or the coils of a sleeping serpent. The walls are something older than stone, pulsing faintly with the residue of all the souls who have passed this way before. Light comes from nowhere and everywhere, a soft glow that emanates from the rock itself, or from the air, or from somewhere just beyond seeing. It is enough to see by, barely, but it casts no shadows. In [the Spiral](#), there is nowhere to hide. The air grows heavier with each turn. [The Spiral](#) presses against [the soul](#) the way deep water presses against the body. It reminds you, with every step, that you are descending. That you are leaving the world behind. That there is no going back. [The Spiral](#) is divided into eight concentric rings, each one a Region shaped by one of the Spirits. Between each Region, a barrier where souls must face one of the Six Steps of Humanity, plus the first station where the journey begins. Some souls move through quickly, barely noticing the weight. Others linger for what feels like eternity, unable to pass, unable to go back, stuck in the space between what they were and what they might become. At the centre, impossibly far down, the Orb waits. Veyra's womb, crystallized, holding [Voluntas](#) unborn. The destination of every soul. The end of [the spiral](#).

Related: [The Veins](#), orb-of-souls, spiral-journey

Varkane Abyss

Age of Fairytales · Places

Zorya's Seven Daughters of Vice

The Varkane Abyss forms a wound that refuses closure. When Bahamut surged through the earth's crust to meet Lunarkos above, the Shattering tore open a vast chasm where magma surges and Vanta bleeds from the planet's anguished depths. This scar marks the path of something immense forcing its way free, a volcanic gulf edged in jagged basalt and obsidian frozen into tooth-like shapes. Steam rises perpetually, thick with sulphur, ash, and an ancient scent beyond naming. Eternal fire burns within, channels of glowing red, orange, and searing white magma carving through the rock. Heat presses heavy enough to consume most who venture far, yet seekers descend. The Veins call to those drawn to darkness, and the Abyss offers the most striking entrance. A hellscape grew around it. Vorograv rose from these depths during the cataclysm, claimed Zorya Chernaya, and shaped demons from her suffering. Stone melted and re-formed into twisted echoes of castles and cathedrals, spires clawing skyward like grasping hands, bridges of volcanic glass spanning chasms where molten blood pulses below. Arches curve like ribs, doorways yawn open, narrow slits watch intently. Surfaces bear carvings of demons, gargoyles, coiling serpents, and scenes of torment etched in obsidian and basalt, beauty forged from endurance of pain. Living gargoyles perch on every ledge, arch, and rooftop, carved from stone yet breathing patience. Their eyes hold every sight, remembering without hunger or desire. Zorya birthed them under Vorograv's dominion, and they serve her through recognition of her tolerance. Some bear wings, others multiple heads or forms of lions, serpents, or creatures unique to this realm. They guard and observe, stone hearts storing truths until relevance demands release. Cerberus stands sentinel at the mouth. The greatest hellhound, three heads vigilant in every direction, black fur gleaming like volcanic glass, eyes burning red as fresh magma. His breath scorches stone, his shadow blankets swathes of the hellscape in firelight. He permits passage to those whose need for the Veins carries weight and clarity, those seeking earned power or controlled demons. Others he repels, often with finality. Bones litter the approaches of fools who tested his loyalty. He recalls Zorya's enslavement, her patient theft of horn fragments, his journey to Qayyin, the sword's return, the strike that claimed Vorograv's head. Absolute devotion binds him to her until she commands otherwise or the world ceases. Demons layer the depths. Near the surface, where heat allows survival and stone retains pre-Shattering echoes, lesser fiends roam, creatures of spite and malice drawn to fear and pain, wild yet predictable to the wary. Deeper, where rock pulses and air shimmers, succubi and incubi dwell, beautiful, terrible, ravenous beyond flesh. They lure with promises of pleasure, power, knowledge, then drain essence until little remains. Deeper still, amid open magma flows, the seven daughters govern domains: Gordyna's mirrored obsidian halls, Lakoma's hoarded vaults, Pohotna's crimson-draped chambers, Zavista's shifting rooms, Obzera's endless feasting tables, Gneva's arenas of violent spectacle, Lena's still chambers where time halts. At the core, where the Abyss merges with the Veins' natural tunnels, Zorya's throne rests in the blackened ruins of her former castle. Volcanic glass forms the seat, sharp, cold amid surrounding heat. Vorograv's head hangs from her belt, grin eternal. She presides, terrible with purpose, restraining demons from unbound excess. Darkness here holds benevolence through chosen restraint. Seekers descend still. Some offer respect to Cerberus and Zorya, pass to the Veins. Others bargain with daughters, rarely emerging whole, for pride demands excess, greed seizes beyond agreement, lust consumes, envy craves the unoffered, gluttony hungers eternally, wrath strikes, sloth neglects. A few approach Zorya, seeking wisdom from one who endured, killed the unkillable, learned to wield terror for purpose. She imparts patience, restraint, the weight of deliberate darkness, lessons delivered slowly, without gentleness. The Abyss endures as wound, entrance, throne room, ordered hell. Magma flows, demons feed, gargoyles watch, Cerberus guards, Zorya rules. Gothic forms rise in obsidian and basalt, beauty and darkness entwined, suffering shaped into endurance. It waits for the brave, desperate, or broken to descend and confront what stirs within. Some return transformed. Others vanish. The Abyss remains indifferent, existing as fire exists, as stone exists, as the mark of a god's violent emergence exists. The mouth of hell. The gateway to the Veins. The seat of the Burned Queen. Darkness checked by one who knows its full measure.

Related: [Bahamut](#), [zorya-chernaya](#), [vorograv](#), [The Veins](#)

Atenara

Age of Men · Places

Atenara - The Sun-Steeped South

Atenara lies south of [Hoshimira](#), occupying a warm stretch of the same continent that holds [Solmara](#), [Fengua](#), and [Hoshimira](#). It is one of the smallest nations on the mainland, smaller even than the fractured [Crown Nations](#), yet its presence feels larger because of the light that fills it. [The sun](#) reaches [Atenara](#) without the long shadows that fall across lands further north. The air is warm most of the year, and the humidity gathers in soft, clinging layers that make the skin feel alive. To the east, across a narrow sea, lies the separate continent of [Sahran](#). [Atenara](#) has no land border with [Sahran](#), only maritime trade routes and shared sun-worshipping traditions. The country divides into four provinces, each with its own voice within the same sunlit chorus.

[Melqara](#) occupies the western stretch of the mainland, where the coast opens into sheltered bays and the hills are white with limestone and olive groves. The towns rise in whitewashed blocks with deep blue doors and shutters, their streets narrow enough to keep out the midday heat. Melqaran music blends the rhythms of coastal strings and inland percussion, and the people move with a slow, deliberate grace. The province is the most maritime of [Atenara](#), its ports sending fishing boats and small trading vessels along the coast toward [Solmara's](#) southern harbours.

[Khemru](#) sits at the centre, a land of sun-baked plains and the ruins of old temples that face the rising sun with perfect alignment. The Atenaran faith in warmth and light finds its oldest expression here. Priests of the Solarii order maintain the great sun dials and the prayer houses where worship begins before dawn. The architecture favours stone obelisks and halls held by rows of carved columns, the walls decorated with sun discs and winged symbols. [Khemru](#) feels ancient in a way that presses on the chest.

[Kushara](#) runs along the eastern side, where the land meets the sea and the rivers carry dark, fertile silt. The people here have darker skin than those in the west, their features reflecting the old bloodlines of the southern coasts. Cattle move through the floodplains, and the villages sit on low hills to stay above the seasonal rise of water. Kusharan sun worship takes a more ancestral form, with offerings left at riverine shrines and the dead buried facing the dawn.

[Heliadis](#) stands apart, a large island between the Atenaran mainland and the open sea, lying closer to the trade routes that run east toward [Sahran](#). The crossing from the mainland takes two days in a good wind. The island rises in marble hills and pine forests, its shores lined with white sand and small harbours. White-columned shrines and amphitheatres cut into hillsides, where plays honouring [the sun](#) are performed at solstice. Heliadians are known as philosophers and star-gazers, and they claim the first Atenaran sun dial was carved on their soil.

Despite lying further south than [Hoshimira](#), the entire country enjoys a warm, tropical temperament with wet and dry seasons rather than true winter. The Solarii faith runs deep here; more Solarii adherents live in [Atenara](#) than anywhere else on the mainland. Travellers from colder lands often remark that [Atenara](#) smells of sun-warmed stone, salt, and flowering jasmine, and that the people smile more freely than people should.

Related: [Hoshimira](#), [solarii](#)

Substances

The Moon

Age of Men · Substances

The Moon

Before the Moon, Aerisu had no anchor in the sky. The world moved without rhythm. Tides wandered. Seasons drifted without pattern. Above it all burned only the Scorching Sun, relentless and unyielding, and beside it the vast dark where something should have been. Then Zuki Kusanagi prayed. She was a girl from the mountain basin of Aokusa watching the world burn beneath a sun that would not relent. Her prayer carried everything she had lost. Her mother to the Curse. Her father to fear. Her home to the fire she herself had started. She did not ask for miracles. She asked only for the burning to end. Something answered. From the dark between worlds came Lunarkos, a wandering mass of carbon, iron, and crystalline Lux fifty-seven kilometres wide. It appeared first as a distant star, then grew year by year until the entire world could see it approaching. A slow doomsday written across the sky. Some tried to stop it. The Coalition built machines and studied its path. Angels rose into the upper atmosphere on wings of light and steel. Even the gods prepared for the moment of impact. Others welcomed it. The Lunartics believed the Scorching Sun had already ruined humanity and that only the falling moon could cleanse the world. They sabotaged every attempt to turn it aside. When Lunarkos finally entered the inner atmosphere, something rose to meet it. Bahamut emerged from the planet's core, summoned by Voluntas through Anima's guidance. A being of pure Vanta and planetary will. Obsidian scales veined with magma. Wings like continents tearing open beneath the sea. They collided in the upper stratosphere. The impact flared like a black sun made of soul-fire. Both presences shattered in that meeting, their fragments scattering through the sky and across the world. What remained fused together into something new. That remnant became the Moon. It hangs above Aerisu now, pale and veined with darker scars where the collision tore through its surface. Its light is softer than the sun's fire, neither day nor darkness but something in between, fitting for a world caught between what was and what might still come. The Moon represents balance. The collision that created it ended the Scorching Sun's dominion and tore open the boundary between soul and matter. Vanta and Lux became woven into the world together. Its pale face holds both forces without allowing either to rule. It represents witness. The Moon saw the Shattering and every age that followed. Nations rise and fall beneath it. Souls choose and suffer beneath it. It does not intervene. It remembers. It represents a prayer that changed the sky. Zuki Kusanagi asked only for relief from the burning sun. The answer reshaped the heavens themselves. In the Age of Decay the Moon has become the world's primary light. The sun appears only once each week, leaving the Moon to mark time across long nights. Travelers navigate by it. Farmers plant by it. Children are born and buried beneath its patient glow. Many have claimed it as their symbol. The Vesperites see in it proof that darkness can hold gentler light. The Luminaries curse it as a pale replacement for the sun they lost. The Solarii gather sunlight on rare Sundays and scatter its warmth through mirrors and crystal, acknowledging the Moon while refusing to abandon the day. The Tsukuyomi feel it most strongly. They carry faint echoes of Zuki's original prayer, and the Moon answers them in quiet ways. Dreams. Reflections. The sense of being watched by something patient and old. Scholars argue about what the Moon truly is. Some call it a sphere of rock and crystal obeying natural law. Others say it is a presence that remembers the moment the world broke. Both explanations may be true. The Moon offers no correction. When it rises above Sengetsuki and the crystal forests beyond, its light falls on everyone the same. The hopeful and the despairing. The living and the dying. The guilty and the innocent. The Moon watches. In a world of perpetual night, that quiet witnessing matters more than ever.

Related: Lunarkos, Zuki Kusanagi, vesperites, luminaries

The Sun

Age of Men · Substances

The Sun

Before the Moon, there was only the Sun. In those days it was called the Scorching Sun. It hung in the sky without mercy or rhythm, a constant blaze that never set. The world knew no true night, no deep shadows, no pause from its gaze. Its light was relentless, pressing down on the earth until even the rivers seemed to thirst. The Curse flourished beneath that light. The heat split the ground and drove desire to fever. Many believed the Sun itself fed the Curse, that its endless presence left no space for rest, no darkness where reflection or restraint could grow. Solmara took its name from that fire. The Autarchs believed themselves its heirs, children of the Sun's relentless motion. Their creed of endless progress mirrored the sky above them. Forward always. Never pause. Sacrifice today for tomorrow. Not everyone worshipped it. Some prayed for the Sun to end. Zuki Kusanagi was among them. A girl from the mountain basin of Aokusa who watched the world burn beneath a sky that never rested. She prayed for the Scorching Sun to cease. She prayed with grief heavy enough to bend fate. The answer came from the dark. Lunarkos fell. When the sky shattered and the Moon was born from the collision, the Sun's dominion ended with it. When light returned to the world it was different. It rose. It set. It yielded the sky to night and to the Moon's quieter glow. The Sun that remained became known as the Warm Sun. Its light nurtures rather than punishes. It still rises across the sky each day, but it also rests. It allows the world to breathe in ways the Scorching Sun never did. The Warm Sun came to represent continuance. Tomorrow. The quiet promise that light returns even after the longest night. This is the Sun Ash invoked when he stood at the Rift's edge and made his vow. Not the Sun that burns the world forward, but the one that rises again after darkness. Different peoples remember the Sun in different ways. The Luminaries long for the Scorching Sun's return. They believe its fire would cleanse the world and purge the Curse entirely. On the rare Sundays when sunlight breaks through the Vanta-heavy sky, they gather to greet it as a promise of restoration. The Solarii follow a gentler path. To them the Warm Sun is a teacher of restraint. Their monks greet dawn in silence and carry mirrors of polished gold to scatter sunlight into shadowed places. The Vesperites turned away from the Sun entirely. They find peace in the night and see the Sun's departure not as loss but as release. For them the Moon offers a kinder rhythm than the fire that once ruled the sky. Among the scattered Autarchs the Sun remains a symbol of division. Some mourn the loss of its relentless power. Others accept the change as proof that even the fiercest force can learn to yield. In the present age the Sun struggles to reach the world at all. During the Age of Decay the Perpetual Night has dimmed even the Warm Sun's promise. It appears only once each week, breaking through the Vanta-saturated sky on Sundays before fading again into darkness. The Luminaries climb mountains and gather along the coasts to greet those brief hours of light. The Vesperites close their shutters and wait for night's return. The Solarii raise mirrors and crystals, catching what warmth they can before it fades. Yet even now the Sun still rises. Even here. Even when the world below is shadow. That quiet persistence is its true meaning. Not the burning force it once was, but the promise that tomorrow still exists.

Related: Lunarkos, Ash Salinte, luminaries, solarii

Soul Shards

Age of Fairytales · Substances

Soul Shards

Soul Shards are fragments of crystallised soul essence, physical remnants of consciousness and desire frozen into mineral form. They pulse with a warmth that feels almost alive and hum faintly in quiet moments, carrying within them the compressed anguish, longing, and will of the being from which they were drawn. Each shard is a prison of concentrated feeling, desire made solid, will frozen into something that can be held in the hand. The first Soul Shards emerged from Zephyr's experiments in Elysium, where he learned to extract the soul's raw substance from

his subjects and crystallise it. He called them Heart Crystals, tombs of living anguish from which magic could be drawn. Those who came later found other ways to create them, harvesting essence from the dying, from the Cursed, from those whose souls had grown too heavy for their bodies. Some shards are formed intentionally through ritual extraction. Others occur naturally when a being dies with such concentrated desire or despair that their soul crystallises rather than dispersing. A Soul Shard holds more than just power. It holds echo. The person from whom it was drawn continues to resonate within it, their final emotions, their deepest wants, their unfulfilled longings all pressed into crystalline form. Those sensitive enough can hear whispers from old shards, fragments of voices, pieces of memories, echoes of lives that ended but never truly ceased. The trade in [Soul Shards](#) flourishes across [Aerisu](#), most eagerly in [Silealyros](#) where the [Borenfegen](#) programs require ever more fragments to fuel their creations. Black markets move shards from ancient battlefields to hidden laboratories, from the dying to those who would live forever, from those who cannot resist to those who can pay. The Diviners officially condemn this trade, but their vaults hold shards nonetheless, studied in secret, used when necessary. Using a Soul Shard for magic requires drawing on the essence within it. A mage channels the crystallised desire, the frozen will, and shapes it into effect. The shard amplifies connection, allowing those with less developed attunement to wield power that would otherwise demand years of discipline. But the shard remembers. It whispers. It pulls. Those who rely too heavily on shards find their own desires tangled with the desires of the dead, their own wills corrupted by wills that should have ended long ago. The most dangerous shards are the ones made from the truly Cursed. These shards do not just whisper. They hunger. They seek to complete the corruption that created them, spreading memetic contagion through those who touch them, planting obsessive thoughts and impossible desires that root deep and refuse release. Such shards are kept sealed in the deepest vaults, studied only by those who understand what they risk, used only when necessity outweighs every other consideration.

Related: soul-capturing, heart-crystals, diviners

VantaBlack

Age of Fairytales · Substances

VantaBlack

[VantaBlack](#) is the mineral form of Vanta, desire made stone, hunger crystallised into substance that can be mined and shaped. It forms in places where Vanta has saturated the earth for millennia, in the deep wounds where [Bahamut](#) tore through the crust, in the caverns where [the Curse](#) has pooled and thickened across ages. [The Veins](#) hold veins of it, black seams running through stone like frozen lightning, pulsing faintly with the same hunger that moves through all living things. The mineral is black beyond black, a darkness that seems to absorb light rather than reflect it. It feels warm to the touch, warmer than it should be, and those who hold it for too long find their own desires sharpening, their own hungers intensifying. It carries Vanta's nature within it, the ache of absence, the pressure of longing, the restless motion of souls that lack and want and reach. [VantaBlack](#) is the ideal vessel for holding souls because it is already saturated with desire. A soul placed within it finds its essence resonating with the stone's own hunger, binding together in a stability that other materials cannot provide. [Soul Shards](#) made with [VantaBlack](#) hold their charge longer, whisper more clearly, amplify magic more powerfully than shards made from ordinary crystal. The [VantaBlack](#) remembers what it is to want. It welcomes [the soul](#) as kin. But the stone also corrupts. Those who work with it find their own desires shifting, aligning with the hunger that saturates the mineral. Miners in [VantaBlack](#) veins develop obsessions they cannot explain, fixations they cannot break. Craftsmen who shape it find their thoughts turning toward acquisition, toward accumulation, toward desires that have no end. The stone teaches what it is. It teaches that wanting never stops. Uses for [VantaBlack](#) extend far beyond [Soul Shards](#). Weapons forged with it cut through magical defences, their edges carrying Vanta's hunger to consume and destroy. Armour lined with it protects against curses, absorbing memetic corruption before it can reach the wearer's mind. Ritual objects carved from it amplify any working that involves desire, longing, will, the raw forces that move [the soul](#). Engineers have learned to weave it into machinery, creating devices that respond to thought and emotion

with a precision that ordinary mechanisms cannot match. The mining of [VantaBlack](#) is controlled carefully by those who understand its dangers. The Vantari know the deep veins best, having lived beside them for generations, and they trade the mineral selectively, measuring each transaction against the cost of releasing more hunger into the world. Other nations send expeditions into [the Veins](#), seeking their own sources, but those who go too deep and stay too long often return changed, their eyes holding a darkness that was not there before, their hands reaching for things they cannot name. [VantaBlack](#) is the earth's desire made visible, the planet's longing given form. It waits in the depths for those who would use it, patient as stone, hungry as the void, offering power to anyone willing to carry its weight.

Related: [Soul Shards](#), vanta-concept, veins

The Vireliax

Age of Men · Substances

The Vireliax

They call her a legend of the Vaelmiric seas. One of the last seaborne dreadnoughts to survive the [Vaelmiric War](#). I have never been able to think of her as merely a vessel. She is a convergence. Military engineering, arcane craft, and myth pressed into a single shape.

Her black hull stretches more than a hundred meters, rising six decks high, with four held beneath the waterline. Alchemical veins glow faintly along her surface like circulation. Quake-tempered obsidian, reinforced with kyrite, gives her a semi-submersible frame meant to endure abyssal pressure. A triple keel keeps her steady where storms would tear lesser ships apart.

[The Vireliax](#) was built to endure and to learn. A moving fortress. A laboratory. A repository for knowledge that could not be trusted on land. Her command bridge is sparse and dim, a mix of analogue instrumentation and arcane interfaces that respond to touch and intent. Mid-decks hold social halls and messes where warmth gathers uneasily beside dread. Lower levels house quarters, archives, and engines that hum with Autarch power and something stranger beneath it. The lowest deck carries submersibles designed to descend into trenches the sea itself seems reluctant to acknowledge.

There are rooms not listed in any manifest. Experimental chambers. Arcane data vaults. Spaces that remember expeditions better left unnamed, and truths that did not survive intact.

Despite her age, [the Vireliax](#) has endured seven deep-sea voyages through the Maw storms. No modern vessel has matched that record. She carries the promise of discovery with her, but also the weight of what discovery costs.

She stands at the edge of human ambition, staring back into [the abyss](#). And sometimes, it feels like [the abyss](#) recognises her.

Related: [Vaelmir](#), [Vireliax Expedition](#)

Shorin no Okami

Age of Men · Substances

Shorin no Okami

It still stands.

That is the first thing people say about it, always with the same particular weight, as if standing were an act of will rather than physics. As if the mech had considered falling and declined.

The Autarchs built it to watch [Aokusa](#). To guard the basin and the terraces and the people who lived between the mountains and the sky. When the Angels were recalled, when Solmaran authority shifted and the politics reshaped themselves into new forms, [Shorin no Okami](#) was left behind. No retrieval order survives in any archive. Whether it was forgotten or deliberately abandoned, the record does not say.

Vines climbed it. Doves found the spaces between its plating and stayed. During the Festival of Bloom, children place offerings at its feet, flowers mostly, small things carried up with both hands and set down with the seriousness only children bring to ritual. Lanterns are hung from whatever the vines will hold. By nightfall the mech stands inside a constellation of small lights, and the festival continues around it. Music drifting upward, people dancing as if the land is listening.

It is during the Festival, and in the quieter nights that follow, that the stories surface. Girls mostly, though not exclusively, who stare too long into a lantern flame near [Shorin no Okami](#) and find themselves somewhere else. They describe battles. Specific ones. Terrain that does not match any landscape they have seen, sounds that stay in the body after the vision clears. Some accounts are consistent enough across generations to suggest they describe the same events, the same moments of catastrophic contact, witnessed from something very close to the ground.

Whether these are memories held inside the machine, echoes of what it was built to withstand, or something looking forward rather than back, the tradition offers both interpretations and refuses to settle on one. Atrocities remembered. Atrocities approaching. The lantern flame does not distinguish. The offerings kept coming regardless. That is the thing about [Shorin no Okami](#). You do not need to resolve what it is to feel the pull of standing beneath it with a small light in your hands, looking up.

Some names outlast the things that earned them. Some things earn their names slowly, over centuries, through the quiet accumulation of people who chose to stay.

Related: [Aokusa](#), [Angels Reformed](#)